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DEMOCRATIZING WEALTH CREATION

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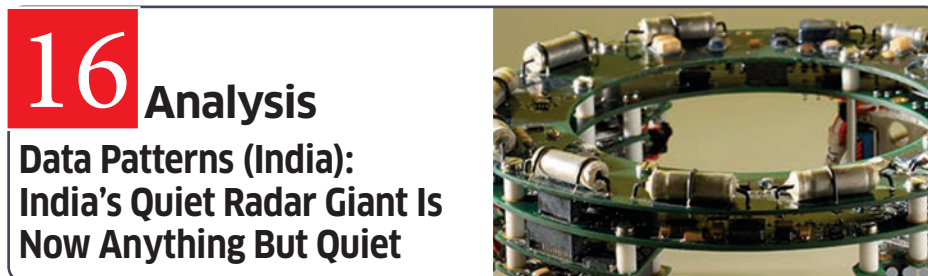
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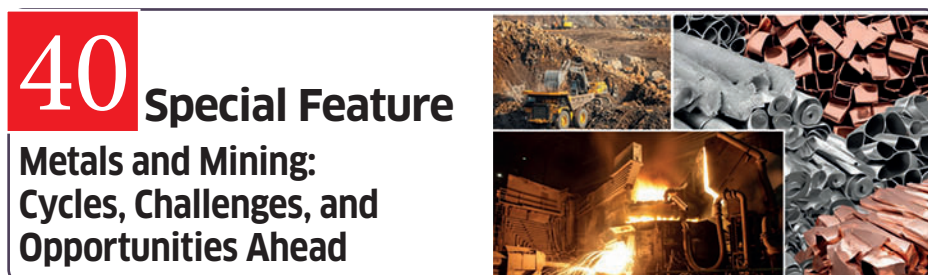
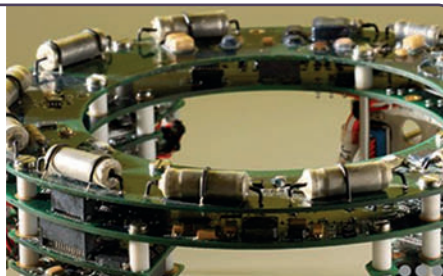
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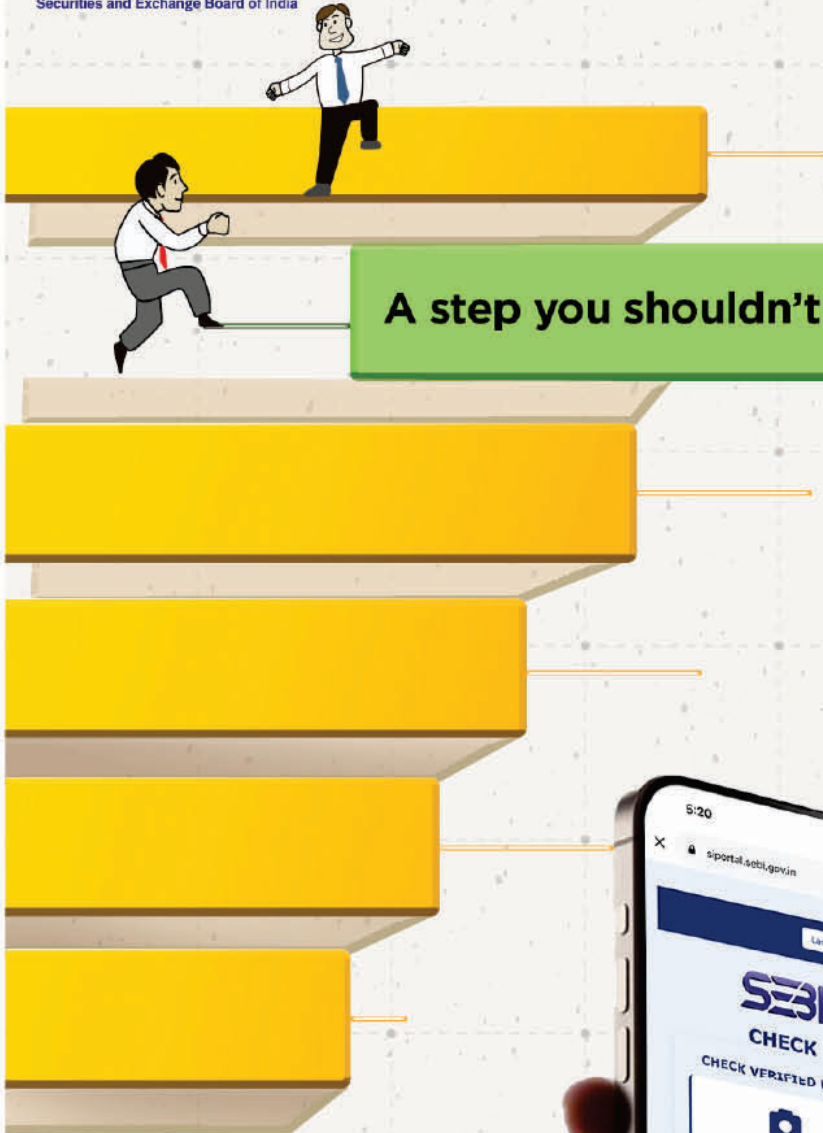
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The Great Accumulation Window

I have watched Indian markets through many budget cycles, a few major global financial crises, and more 'India is over' headlines than I care to count. Every single time, the noise eventually gave way to the numbers. And right now, the noise is exceptionally loud, which, in my experience, is precisely when you should be leaning in, not stepping back.

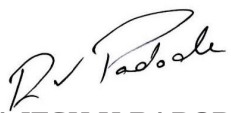
Let's start with what the bears are celebrating. The Nifty is down roughly 12 per cent from its recent peak in January, while the MSCI World Index is down by only two per cent, while Asia ex-Japan has surged by six per cent in the same period and 35 per cent in the last one year. Foreign institutional investors pulled out ₹64,000 crore in March (till March 16, 2024) alone from the Indian equity market, the rupee hit a record low, and geopolitical tension rattled risk appetite globally. On the surface, that looks like a damning report card. But peel back the narrative and you'll find something far more interesting, India didn't fall apart; it simply got left out of a rally fuelled largely by momentum and positioning. That's a very different thing.

Now here is where I want you to pay close attention, because the data makes a remarkably strong case. Historically, every time the Nifty 50's trailing P/E has crossed 24, whether it went to 25, 26, or even 28, the market has typically been near a short-term peak. We saw it in 2008, around 2018, and again at the end of 2021. A P/E above 24 has reliably been a warning sign, and if you were investing at those levels, you needed a 5-7 year horizon to absorb the inevitable pain. The flip side of that data, however, is far more compelling. Whenever the Nifty P/E has dropped to 20 or below, the subsequent 12-month returns have been striking, roughly 130 per cent in 2009-10, 42 per cent in 2013, 13 per cent in 2016, 38 per cent in 2020, and over 22 per cent through mid-2022. Market troughs, in most of these cycles, formed right around or below a P/E of 20. Today's normalised Nifty P/E sits at approximately 20.02x. The forward P/E is around 17.45x. These are historically the coordinates where bottoms are built, not where bull markets die.

What makes this moment psychologically treacherous, and therefore opportunity-rich, is the narrative that always accompanies these valuation levels. At peak P/Es of 24-25, everyone is euphoric: India is an infrastructure miracle, manufacturing is booming, jobs are multiplying. But the moment valuations compress below 20, the same commentators declare that everything is finished, no infrastructure, no jobs, politics will derail development. I have lived through enough of these sentiment cycles to tell you with confidence, the story changes, but the valuation band doesn't lie. Tune out the narrative. Watch the numbers.

The policy architecture being assembled around this moment gives me additional conviction. On the sector side, manufacturing's shift towards medium and high-technology industries, now nearly half of value added, signals something more durable than cheap-labour assembly. And the Nifty IT Index's 15.5 per cent single-month selloff on AI disruption fears is, in my reading, an overreaction worth exploiting. These firms are pivoting into AI integration, and their dollar revenues are a natural rupee hedge.

Yes, the market could fall another 2-5 per cent from here depending upon how the situation pans out in the Middle East. Nobody times the exact bottom. But here's what two decades have taught me, bear markets are not crises to survive, they are classrooms to exploit and entry points to cherish. India is a \$4.3 trillion economy on a credible path to \$7.5 trillion by 2030. The structural story is intact. Only the entry price has improved. Build systematically, use a staggered manner to invest to neutralise timing risk, and anchor to the Nifty 50. This window, like those before it, will eventually be remembered as the one most people missed but not you.


RAJESH V PADODE
 Managing Director & Editor

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Chief Operating Officer

Kaamini Padode

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Jayesh Dadia

DSIJ WEALTH ADVISORY PVT. LTD. (Formerly Known as DSIJ Private Limited)

 For Customer Service

 9240904925 OR  service@dsij.in

Mumbai Office

419-A, 4th Floor, Arun Chambers, Tardeo,

Next to AC Market, Mumbai - 400034

Pune Office

Office No. 409, 4th Floor, Solitaire Business Hub,

Kalyani Nagar, Pune - 411006

 For Enquiries

 9240904920 OR  enquiry@dsij.in

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Why Has the Super 50 List Changed?

I have been a long-time subscriber of your esteemed publication and closely follow the Super 50 and Top 150 lists published every March. On comparing the 2025 Super 50 with the latest list released last week, I noticed that only a few companies have been retained while many new names have appeared. Since the methodology remains unchanged, why have so many companies been replaced?

- Nandkumar J.

Editor Responds: Thank you for writing to us. The change in the list primarily reflects an update in our evaluation period. While the financial parameters and screening criteria remain exactly the same, we have shifted the analysis to the latest twelve months instead of relying on older financial data. This allows us to capture the most recent performance and financial strength of companies, which we believe is more relevant for investors when assessing current opportunities.

As business dynamics and earnings can change quickly, using the latest data naturally leads to some changes in the rankings and the companies that qualify for the list. This update in the evaluation period has been clearly mentioned in the methodology section.

Write to us at editorial@dsij.in

Recommendations

Company/Scheme	Reco.	Price (₹)	Column	Page No
Acutaas Chemicals	● Buy	2,163.15	Choice Scrip	10
Adani Power	● Buy	154.10	Hot Chips	13
Ajanta Pharma	● Buy	2952.1	Technicals	15
Astral	● Buy	1,620.10	Kerbside	51
Data Patterns (India)	● Hold	3,094.65	Analysis	16
Kronox Lab Sciences	● Buy	110.00	Low Priced Scrip	12
L&T Finance	● Buy	260.30	Hot Chips	13
Linde India	● Buy	7168.65	Technicals	15
MCX	● Buy	2,554.95	Kerbside	51
Torrent Pharmaceuticals	● Buy	4,263.05	Kerbside	51
Wheels India	● Buy	921.05	Kerbside	51

BP - Book Profit • BPP - Book Partial Profits • BL - Book Loss

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Market Watch

Conflict, Crude, and a Market Crash

The past fortnight has unsettled investors, with fear and pessimism dominating market sentiment. March began on a volatile note as geopolitical tensions in the Middle East escalated sharply following strikes by Israel and the United States on Iran. In retaliation, Iran intensified its response, disrupting the Strait of Hormuz and launching counterattacks across the region. This escalation sparked widespread concerns over a potential supply shock, pushing crude oil prices sharply higher.

As anticipated, crude oil prices surged to nearly USD 120 per barrel in the first week, raising alarm over inflationary pressures and the potential slowdown in global economic growth. The ripple effects were immediately visible across financial markets. The Indian rupee continued its downward trajectory, breaching the 92 mark against the U.S. dollar, its weakest level on record. Domestic equity markets mirrored the global turmoil.

The Nifty VIX, often referred to as the fear gauge, spiked nearly 65 per cent during the period, reflecting heightened uncertainty and risk aversion among investors. Benchmark indices witnessed a sharp correction, with both the BSE Sensex and Nifty 50 declining over 8 per cent within just nine trading sessions, one of the steepest short-term falls in recent times. The Nifty 50 breached key psychological levels of 25,000 and 24,000 before finding some support around the 23,000 level.

The broader markets were not spared, declining in tandem with frontline indices. Sectoral performance remained weak across the board, with most indices ending deep in the red. BSE Auto and

BSE Bankex emerged as the worst hit sectors, recording double digit losses, while oil and gas, real estate, and metals also witnessed significant selling pressure. Foreign institutional investors (FIIs) turned aggressive sellers once again, offloading equities worth approximately ₹56,900 crore during the fortnight.

In contrast, domestic institutional investors (DIIs) played a stabilising role, infusing nearly ₹70,500 crore and cushioning the downside to some extent. In such volatile phases, investors often fall prey to emotional decision making, exiting markets amid sharp declines. However, for long-term investors, such corrections can present meaningful

Rising crude, falling markets, and heightened volatility test investors. Those who stay patient can turn corrections into long-term opportunities.

opportunities to accumulate quality stocks at more attractive valuations. Timing the exact market bottom remains elusive, and those who remain on the sidelines risk missing the eventual recovery. As uncertainty persists, staying disciplined and focused on long-term fundamentals remains crucial. Investors should remain watchful and prepared to capitalise on opportunities that emerge during this phase of market weakness.



Performance Of Indices			
Indices	Mar. 02, 2026	Mar. 13, 2026	Gain/Loss (%)
Auto	62,236.87	53,876.79	-13.43
Bankex	68,139.54	60,462.88	-11.27
Oil & Gas	29,595.66	26,864.10	-9.23
Realty	6,067.58	5,521.21	-9.00
BSE Sensex	81,287.19	74,563.92	-8.27
Nifty 50	25,178.65	23,151.10	-8.05
Metal	40,424.48	37,268.72	-7.81
BSE 150 Midcap	16,007.94	14,843.66	-7.27
BSE 250 Smallcap	6,297.35	5,875.64	-6.70
FMCG	18,739.32	17,573.06	-6.22
IT	29,754.94	28,151.52	-5.39
Healthcare	43,917.47	42,787.59	-2.57
Power	6,967.06	6,922.20	-0.64

Net Investment In Equity Markets (₹/Cr)		
Date	FIIs	DIIs
Mar 13, 2026	-10,716.64	9,977.42
Mar 12, 2026	-7,049.87	7,449.77
Mar 11, 2026	-6,267.31	4,965.53
Mar 10, 2026	-4,672.64	6,333.26
Mar 9, 2026	-6,345.57	9,013.80
Mar 6, 2026	-6,030.38	6,971.51
Mar 5, 2026	-3,752.52	5,153.37
Mar 4, 2026	-8,752.65	12,068.17
Mar 2, 2026	-3,295.64	8,593.87
Total	-56,883.22	70,526.70



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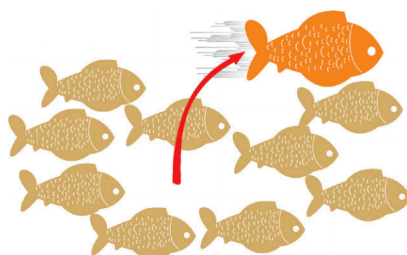
Strong growth driving earnings expansion

Entry into high value segments

Margin expansion from better mix

The global specialty chemicals industry continues to benefit from structural tailwinds such as supply chain diversification, increasing outsourcing by global innovators, and rising demand from end-user industries including pharmaceuticals, electronics, and electric vehicles. India is emerging as a key manufacturing hub under the China+1 strategy, supported by cost advantages and improving technical capabilities. Considering these factors, we recommend Acutaas Chemicals Ltd as our Choice Scrip.

Acutaas Chemicals is a leading specialty chemicals company with a strong presence in pharmaceutical intermediates and a growing footprint in specialty chemicals. The company operates across key segments including advanced pharmaceutical intermediates, CDMO (Contract Development and Manufacturing Organization), battery chemicals, and semiconductor chemicals. Over time, it has built a diversified product portfolio catering to global innovators and generic players. The company is strategically transitioning into a multi-vertical platform with three key growth engines, pharmaceutical intermediates (including CDMO),



CHOICE **SCRIP**
1 YEAR INVESTMENT HORIZON

battery chemicals, and semiconductor chemicals.

Acutaas reported a strong performance in Q3 FY26. Revenue from operations stood at ₹393 crore, registering a growth of 43 per cent YoY. PAT came in at ₹106.2 crore, up 133.7 per cent YoY, with PAT margin at 27 per cent, reflecting strong operating leverage and execution. Operationally, the company continues to strengthen its growth drivers across segments. The CDMO business remains a key contributor, supported by a strong pipeline with multiple products validated and expected to contribute meaningfully from FY27 onwards. The company has guided for CDMO revenue of ₹1,000 crore by FY28, indicating strong visibility in this segment.

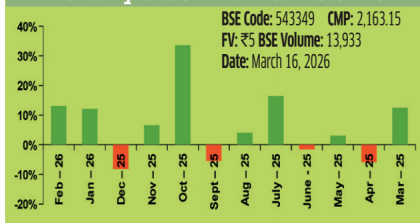
In battery chemicals, the company has inaugurated its electrolyte additives

facility, with commercial production expected to begin shortly and scale up from FY27. Additionally, expansion into semiconductor chemicals through its South Korea based joint venture provides access to high growth and high margin segments. The company is witnessing encouraging traction in both domestic and global markets for these new verticals. The ongoing capex cycle is likely to act as a key growth catalyst over the medium term. Management has revised its FY26 revenue growth guidance upward from 25 per cent to around 30 per cent, supported by strong order book and improving visibility.

On the financial front, the company maintains a strong balance sheet with negligible debt (debt-to-equity of 0.01) and healthy return ratios, with ROCE at 19.9 per cent and ROE at 16 per cent. Over the last three years, it has delivered a sales CAGR of 24.6 per cent and profit CAGR of 30.2 per cent, reflecting consistent growth and improving profitability. From a valuation perspective, the stock is currently trading at a P/E of 65.8x, significantly higher than the industry average of 27.5x and near its 3-year median P/E of 60.4x. The PEG ratio of 2.18 indicates that the stock is priced at a premium to its near-term growth, reflecting strong market expectations around future growth and margin expansion. Acutaas Chemicals is well positioned to benefit from structural tailwinds in specialty chemicals, supported by strong growth in CDMO, expansion into battery and semiconductor chemicals, and improving margin profile. While valuations remain elevated, sustained earnings growth, operating leverage, and execution in new verticals could support further re-rating. Considering these factors, we recommend a **BUY**.

BS

Monthly Stock Market Returns



Shareholding Pattern (%) as of December 2025

Promoters	32.66
Institutions	38.38
Public	28.96
Total	100.00

Last Five Quarters (₹/Cr) (Consolidated)

Particulars	Dec-24	Mar-25	June-25	Sept-25	Dec-25
Total Income	270.94	304.16	205.97	305.19	390.86
Other Income	2.17	5.69	16.02	8.97	6.34
Operating Profit	68.82	89.75	67.01	105.58	160.53
Interest	0.61	0.38	0.62	0.57	0.81
Net Profit	45.30	62.85	44.65	72.89	111.56
Equity	41.00	41.00	41.00	41.00	41.00

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Kronox Lab Sciences Ltd

BEYOND THE USUAL CHEMICAL

HERE IS WHY

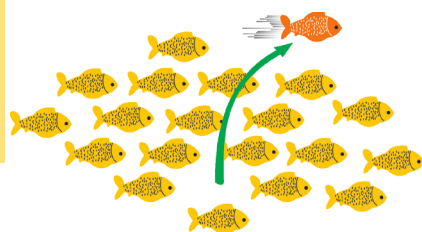
Debt-free, consistently profitable

Unit IV to unlock next growth phase

Purity-led moat, hard to replicate

In specialty chemicals, the strongest competitive edge is not built through aggressive capacity expansion or flashy acquisitions; it is built in the precision of the production process, in the uncompromising standards of purity that define a manufacturer's reputation, and in the steady discipline of serving industries where quality is non-negotiable. That is why Kronox Lab Sciences Limited (KLSL) deserves attention right now, a focused Gujarat-based manufacturer with a clear product niche and a balance sheet that most listed peers would envy, but more importantly, a company that has built its identity around doing one thing exceptionally well rather than many things adequately. In a market where specialty chemical businesses are being scrutinised more carefully for sustainability of margins and quality of earnings, KLSL's debt-free operations, consistent profitability, and niche positioning are no longer just reassuring footnotes; they are the very foundation of a business that has quietly, and convincingly, earned its place among India's most credible specialty chemical franchises.

Incorporated in 2008, its manufacturing operations span three fully operational units in Ekalbara village, Padra taluka,



LOW
PRICED SCIP

1 YEAR INVESTMENT HORIZON

Vadodara district. The company manufactures over 185 high-purity specialty fine chemicals, available in multiple grades and compliant with international standards. These products serve highly regulated industries spanning pharmaceuticals, nutraceuticals, biotech, agrochemicals, and beyond. In terms of revenue mix, approximately 75 per cent comes from the domestic market, with the remaining 25 per cent from exports, a split that has remained consistent over the last four fiscal years.

Therein lies KLSL's moat, the barrier to entry in this space is not merely capital, but years of accumulated technical expertise, multi-standard certifications, and the trust of quality-sensitive customers that take considerable time to build and are nearly impossible to replicate quickly. In an industry where a single deviation in purity can disqualify a supplier entirely, KLSL's consistency and

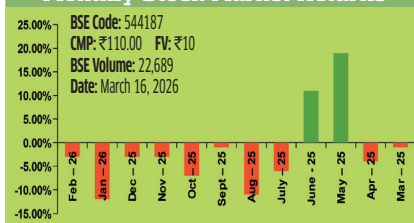
compliance credentials are, in themselves, a formidable and durable competitive advantage.

On the growth front, the most significant trigger is the upcoming Unit IV at GIDC Dahej; all state-level approvals are in place, with central environmental clearance pending, which will substantially expand capacity and introduce newer product families. Simultaneously, the global shift away from China-dependent supply chains is a structural tailwind, with international buyers increasingly seeking certified Indian manufacturers.

On financials, KLSL delivered a strong FY25 with revenue growing 11.5 per cent to ₹100.19 crore, EBITDA expanding 19.26 per cent to ₹35.65 crore, and net profit rising 19.29 per cent to ₹25.47 crore. Into Q3FY26, momentum has moderated, revenue grew 5.26 per cent year-on-year to ₹25.27 crore, EBITDA excluding other income contracted 4.08 per cent to ₹8.02 crore, and net profit grew a marginal 0.9 per cent to ₹6.59 crore. The near-term softness is largely attributable to elevated raw material costs and inventory adjustments, a transient phase rather than a structural concern.

From a valuation standpoint, the stock trades at a TTM PE of 15.63x, well below its three-year median PE of 24.6x; meaning it is available cheaper than what investors have historically paid for it. A PEG ratio of 0.69 signals an attractive entry point relative to growth, while a dividend yield of 0.45 per cent reflects a company sensibly reinvesting into expansion. With Unit IV on the horizon, rising export momentum, and a fundamentally sound business model, the overall outlook remains constructive over the medium to long term. We recommend a **BUY**.

Monthly Stock Market Returns



Shareholding Pattern (%) as of December 2025

Promoters	74.21
Institutions	2.05
Public	23.74
Total	100.00

Last Five Quarters (₹/Cr) (Standalone)

Particulars	Dec-25	Sept-25	June-25	Mar-25	Dec-24
Net Sales	25.28	25.54	24.29	26.14	24.01
Other Income	1.13	1.04	0.87	0.91	0.82
Operating Profit	9.16	9.69	8.84	8.66	9.18
Interest	0.04	0.04	0.00	0.00	0.00
Net Profit	6.59	6.68	6.28	6.32	6.53
Equity	37.10	37.10	37.10	37.10	37.10

**HOT
CHIPS**
15 DAYS INVESTMENT HORIZON

The scrips in this column have been recommended with a 15-day investment horizon in mind and carry high risk. Therefore, investors are advised to take into account their risk appetite before investing, as fundamentals may or may not back the recommendations.

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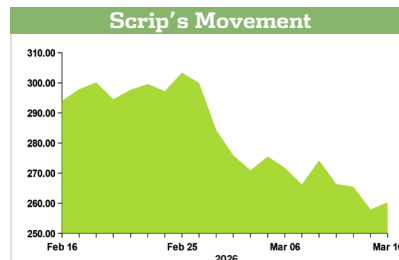
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Target	Stoploss
₹280 - ₹286	₹240 (CLS)

L&T Finance is a retail-focused NBFC offering a wide range of products under the L&T Finance brand, including rural business finance, farmer finance, two-wheeler loans, personal loans, home loans, LAP, SME finance and gold loans. The company has steadily transformed its portfolio, with retailisation rising to 98 per cent of the overall book, reflecting a sharper focus on granular, diversified lending.

Financially, the business looks strong. In Q3FY26, the retail book stood at ₹1,11,990 crore, up 21 per cent YoY, while the consolidated book reached ₹1,14,285 crore. Retail disbursements jumped 49 per cent YoY to ₹22,701 crore, showing strong demand momentum. Profitability remained healthy, with PAT at ₹739 crore, ROA at 2.31 per cent, and ROE at 11.07 per cent. Asset quality also remained comfortable, with NS3 at 0.92 per cent and



Last Seven Days' Volume Table (No. of Shares)

Days	Volume
Mar. 09, 2026	4,17,826
Mar. 10, 2026	1,30,952
Mar. 11, 2026	1,47,029
Mar. 12, 2026	91,762
Mar. 13, 2026	1,43,293
Mar. 16, 2026	99,343

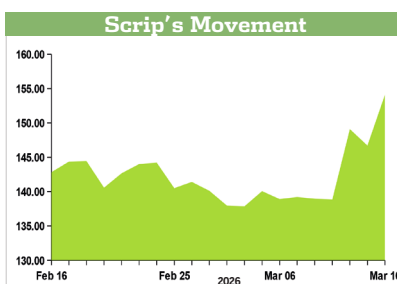
PCR at 72 per cent. With consistent growth and performance, we recommend **BUY**.

Adani power Ltd.

CMP - ₹154.10

BSE CODE	Volume	Face Value
533096	62,33,697	₹2

Target	Stoploss
₹166 - ₹170	₹143 (CLS)



Last Seven Days' Volume Table (No. of Shares)

Days	Volume
Mar 09, 2026	7,18,664
Mar 10, 2026	7,43,610
Mar 11, 2026	13,36,217
Mar 12, 2026	52,99,147
Mar 13, 2026	22,94,271
Mar 16, 2026	62,33,697

Adani Power Limited is India's largest private base-load power company and the country's largest private sector thermal IPP portfolio. The company has an operating capacity of 18,150 MW across 13 assets, with locked-in capacity of 23,720 MW and a target capacity of 41,870 MW, giving it strong long-term growth visibility. A key strength is that around 90 per cent of its operating assets are tied up under PPAs, which supports revenue stability and cash flow predictability.

Financially, the company remains robust despite softer demand conditions. In 9MFY26, revenue stood at ₹41,876 crore, continuing EBITDA at ₹15,713 crore, and PAT at ₹8,700 crore. Net debt to continuing TTM EBITDA was comfortable at 1.86x, while ROCE and ROE stood at 17 per cent and 19 per cent, respectively. Sustained profitability and a growing pipeline of contracted capacity provide strong visibility for future earnings. We recommend **BUY** based on the stock's proven track record and expanding market presence. 

(Closing price as of March 16, 2026)

NIFTY Index Chart Analysis

Death Cross on Nifty: Is More Downside Ahead?

The U.S.-Israel-Iran conflict has now entered its third week, with no visible signs of de-escalation. Crude oil prices have remained firm amid supply concerns arising from the conflict. At the same time, the rupee has slipped to a fresh low due to persistent foreign fund outflows triggered by geopolitical uncertainty. Against this backdrop, the Nifty 50 recorded its sharpest weekly decline since June 2022 and fell to nearly an 11-month low.

From a technical perspective, the Nifty 50 has entered a vulnerable phase. The index

Roadmap for the Next 15 Days			
Ideas	Nifty Levels	Action to be Initiated	Probable Targets
Resistance for the medium-term	23,492 — 23,556	Close above the level of 23,492 — 23,556 would be positive for Nifty	23,754 — 23,900
Support for the medium-term	23,250	Any slip below 23,250 on a closing basis would result into resumption of down move.	22,955 — 22,700

The index has corrected nearly 13 per cent from the all-time high recorded earlier this year and, in the process, has partially filled the upside gap formed on April 15, 2025. On the daily chart, the price action on March 16, 2026, led to the formation of a sizeable bullish candle with a long lower shadow and a small

The key question now is whether follow-up buying will emerge, enabling the index to sustain above the downside gap area of Friday, March 13. A sustained move above this zone is necessary to stabilise sentiment. Failing that, the index may remain exposed to further corrective pressure. On the downside, 23,250 is the immediate support, followed by Monday's low of 22,955, which remains a crucial support level.



has decisively breached its 100-week moving average, placed at 24,448, which had earlier acted as a strong intermediate support since the post-COVID recovery. This breakdown has weakened the medium-term structure and shifted the bias to the downside, unless the index quickly reclaims this level. On the daily chart, the index is now trading below all its key short-, medium-, and long-term moving averages. More importantly, the short-term moving average, the 50-DMA, has crossed below the long-term moving average, the 200-DMA, a formation known in technical parlance as a Death Cross. This is a negative signal for the index.

upper shadow. The long lower shadow, formed near the April 15, 2025 gap area, indicates buying interest emerging from an important support zone, as the Nifty 50 rebounded nearly 450 points from the day's low to close above 23,400.

Going ahead, the index is likely to encounter strong resistance in the downside gap area of March 13, which remains open in the 23,492-23,556 zone. If the Nifty manages to sustain above this band on weekly expiry, the pullback may extend towards 23,754, which coincides with the 23.6 per cent Fibonacci retracement of the decline from the all-time high to the recent low of 22,955.

The weekly MACD continues to trade below its signal line and remains in negative territory, indicating that bearish momentum is still in play. A study of the weekly chart shows that the index has slipped out of a broad consolidation zone that had formed near the peak levels and has subsequently failed to sustain above both the 50-week and 100-week moving averages. The Nifty has also ended below the lower Bollinger Band. While a short-term pullback within the band cannot be ruled out, the broader technical setup continues to appear weak.

In light of the breakdown of important support levels, market participants should maintain a cautious and defensive stance. Aggressive fresh buying should be avoided until the index displays convincing signs of stability above the recently violated support zones. Traders should prioritise capital protection, follow disciplined stop-losses, and remain focused on stock-specific opportunities rather than taking aggressive index-based bets. Until volatility eases and the Nifty regain the 100-week moving average, risk control and selective participation are likely to remain the most prudent strategy for the next fortnight.

STOCK RECOMMENDATIONS

LINDE INDIA LIMITED BUY CMP ₹7,168.65

BSE Code : 523457 | Target 1 ₹7,890 | Target 2 ₹8,040 | Stoploss....₹6,510 (CLS)



Linde India Limited has had a well-established presence in India since 1935 and has grown into one of the leading gases and engineering companies in the country. It offers one of the most comprehensive portfolios of industrial, specialty, and medical gases, along with one of the largest direct sales and distribution networks in India, serving a wide range of industry segments.

Recently, the stock touched a nine-month high, and with this move, it is now trading above its key short-term and long-term moving averages. Interestingly, the stock is on the verge of a Golden Cross formation, which means the short-term moving average, i.e., the 50-DMA, is about to cross above the 200-DMA, the longer-term moving average. This is considered a positive signal for the stock.

The stock is meeting most of the CANSLIM characteristics. It has an EPS Rank of 84, which is a good score indicating consistency in earnings, and an RS Rating of 84, which is also good and reflects outperformance compared with other stocks. Buyer Demand is rated A-, which is evident from the recent demand for the stock. A Group Rank of 20 indicates that it belongs to the strong Chemicals-Basic industry group, while a Master Score of B suggests that it is close to being among the best. The 14-period daily RSI has entered the bullish zone, and the MACD has given a bullish crossover, both of which are positive for the stock. Considering the above factors, we recommend buying the stock with a stop-loss at ₹6,510 and a target price of ₹7,890 to ₹8,040.

AJANTA PHARMA LTD. BUY CMP ₹2,952.10

BSE Code : 532331 | Target 1 ₹3,330 | Target 2 ₹3,370 | Stoploss....₹2,830 (CLS)



Aajanta Pharma is a global specialty pharmaceutical company focused on developing, manufacturing, and marketing high-quality finished dosages. The company has built a strong presence in high-growth specialty segments, including cardiology, dermatology, ophthalmology, and pain management. The stock has broken out of a seven-week cup base pattern. It is meeting most of the CANSLIM characteristics. The stock has an EPS Rank of 74, which is a fair score but indicates that earnings need improvement, and an RS Rating of 85, which is good and reflects outperformance compared with other stocks. Buyer Demand is rated A-, which is evident from the recent demand for the stock. A Group Rank of 29 indicates that it belongs to the strong Medical-Generic Drugs industry group, while a Master Score of B suggests that it

is close to being among the best. The weekly 14-period RSI is in bullish territory. The weekly MACD remains in a strong uptrend and is seen diverging from its nine-period average, thereby validating the positive bias. Considering the above factors, we recommend buying this stock with a stop-loss at ₹2,830 and an upside target of ₹3,330 to ₹3,370.

*LEGEND: ■ EMA - Exponential Moving Average. ■ MACD - Moving Average Convergence Divergence ■ RMI - Relative Momentum Index

■ ROC - Rate of Change ■ RSI - Relative Strength Index

(Closing price as of March 16, 2026)

Disclaimer : Above recommendations are based on various technical parameters and any fundamental input has not been considered for the recommendations. Follow strict stop loss for the recommendation.

DATA PATTERNS (INDIA)**India's Quiet Radar Giant Is Now Anything But Quiet**

A 34 per cent surge in stock value, an all-time high order book of ₹1,868 crore, a Union Budget aligned with its product portfolio, and a wave of investor excitement sounds like a recipe for success, right? But what exactly is driving the buzz surrounding Data Patterns in 2026?

In the opening months of this calendar year, Data Patterns (India) Limited has emerged as one of the most talked-about picks in the defence sector. Its stock climbed an impressive 34 per cent from 1 January to peak up to now on 9 March, powered by a combination of stellar quarterly numbers, a supportive government budget, and rising demand for the high-tech defence systems the company has spent nearly three decades quietly perfecting. With its strategic positioning in radars, electronic warfare, and avionics, the very categories that India's defence modernisation push is targeting, Data Patterns finds itself at the intersection of national policy and investor appetite. But this is more than a short-term trade. In the following pages, we will break down the business, the numbers, the risks, and the outlook for what is emerging as one of India's most strategically important defence electronics companies.

What Does Data Patterns Do?

Founded in 1998 and headquartered in Chennai's SIPCOT IT Park, Data Patterns is a defence and aerospace electronics company that designs, develops, and manufactures high-tech systems used by the Indian military. Its products form the 'brains' and 'nervous system' of modern defence platforms, helping military equipment detect targets, track threats, communicate securely, and respond in real time.

The company's domain expertise spans six key areas: Radars, Electronic Warfare (EW), Communication Systems, Avionics, Automatic Test Equipment (ATE), and Satellites and Naval systems. With 1,071 engineers on the payroll, 52 hired in Q3 FY26 alone, and senior personnel who have been with the company for over two decades, Data Patterns has built capabilities that take years to replicate.

This is backed by a fully operational, integrated manufacturing and test campus in Chennai spanning 10.28 acres and approximately 2,00,000 sq ft of built-up area. The facility

includes 20 dedicated mechanical assembly stations, 70 workstations for module and small systems testing, a 1,00,000 class clean room, an EMS assembly capacity of 600 boards per day, and the ability to handle complex boards with up to 22 layers, 6,000 components, and 21,000 solder points. Specialist infrastructure includes a Large Systems Integration Hangar, Complete Radar Integration bay, a Clean Room for Satellite Integration, Electronic Warfare Vehicle Integration space, and a fully operational EMI and EMC test facility.

What Makes It Different From Other Defence Companies?

While many defence contractors in India focus on assembling parts or using third-party technology, Data Patterns is more vertically integrated. It designs critical components and subsystems in-house, all the way from the first chip to the final certified product. This 'Design to Delivery' philosophy means the company captures far more value from each product, resulting in higher margins and significantly greater strategic independence. In short, it is not a vendor; it is an inventor.

This matters enormously in a sector where the government is actively pushing for Atmanirbhar (self-reliant) solutions. Import bans on several defence equipment categories are now mandating Indian-made procurement, and Data Patterns has been building the intellectual property to address exactly those categories for the better part of three decades.

Customer Base – Who Buys from Data Patterns?

The company serves a blue-chip roster of government customers: the Ministry of Defence (MoD), DRDO, and major Defence Public Sector Units including BEL, HAL, and ECIL. It has also made meaningful inroads in international markets, exporting to Europe and the UK.

The Q3 FY26 customer revenue breakdown is shown below:

Customer	Revenue Share – Q3 FY26
Ministry of Defence (MoD)	31.2%
HAL (Hindustan Aeronautics Limited)	26.9%
BEL (Bharat Electronics Limited)	15.6%
ECIL (Electronics Corporation of India)	15.6%
Exports (International – Europe & UK)	9.6%
DRDO	0.5%
Others	0.6%

The diversity of this customer mix, spanning all three armed forces through different procurement bodies, is a key reason we are confident that a delay in one programme will not derail the company's entire year.

Business Segments - Where the revenue comes from

Data Patterns operates across several high-value defence electronics segments. Here is a breakdown of each, along with their revenue contribution for Q3 FY26:

Product Segment (What It Does)	Revenue Share – Q3 FY26
Radar – Precision Approach, Fire Control, X-Band, Surveillance	31.1%
Avionics – Cockpit Systems, Flight Electronics for LCA, Helicopters	28.8%
Electronic Warfare (EW) – Jammers, Radar Warning, COMINT/ELINT	26.9%
Automatic Test Equipment (ATE) – Quality Testing for Military Systems	7.5%
Annual Maintenance Contracts (AMC) – Recurring Service Revenue	5.1%
Services & Others	0.6%

For context, the segment mix shifts quarter to quarter depending on which contracts are in the delivery phase. Across 9 months of FY26, Radar led at 59.9 per cent of total revenue, followed by EW at 15.5 per cent, AMC at 4.8 per cent, and Avionics at 15.3 per cent, reflecting the lumpy, project-based nature of defence revenues. Export revenue contributed 9.6 per cent of Q3 FY26 revenue, modest today, but the delivery of a Transportable Precision Approach Radar to a European country and its successful Site Acceptance Test marks a landmark moment for Indian private defence exports.

In-House vs. Outsourcing – Why It Matters

To understand why Data Patterns commands the margins it does, you need to understand the difference between building something and buying and assembling it. Most defence electronics companies, even respected global ones, rely on a supply chain of specialist vendors for key building blocks like signal processors, antenna modules, and transmit-receive units. They source these components, integrate them, and sell the finished system. It is a legitimate model, but it keeps gross margins thin because the value-add is modest.

Data Patterns does things differently. Every major building block in its systems, from signal processing firmware to antenna design to test equipment, is engineered in Chennai. The company has invested over ₹125 crore in new product development alone. When a product reaches mass production,

most of the cost base is just raw materials and labour, not bought-out components. This is why the company reported a remarkable gross margin of 77 per cent in Q3 FY26, a number that would be exceptional even for a software company, let alone a hardware manufacturer.

Technological Edge

By owning the entire product development cycle from first design to final testing and delivery, the company ensures greater precision, higher reliability, and cost effectiveness in a way that competitors who rely on third-party technology simply cannot match. In the defence world, owning the technology provides long-term pricing power and stickiness. Once a military platform has been qualified with a specific supplier's electronics, switching costs are enormous.

Growth drivers - What is fuelling the momentum?

Government Budget & Policy Support — The Union Budget for FY2026–27 has provided a strong policy tailwind for Data Patterns. The Ministry of Defence received a record allocation of ₹7.85 lakh crore, up 15.19 per cent over the FY2025–26 budget estimate. The budget also provided over ₹2.19 lakh crore under the capital head for the Defence Forces, including ₹1.85 lakh crore for capital acquisition, reinforcing the government's focus on modernisation, self-reliance, and domestic defence manufacturing. For companies like Data Patterns, which operate in advanced defence electronics, this strengthens the long-term opportunity backdrop.

Make in India & Import Bans — The progressive banning of defence equipment imports and the mandating of 'Make in India' procurement categories is a structural tailwind that will compound over years, not quarters. Military radars, radio relays, electronic warfare systems, and advanced sensors are now being procured exclusively from Indian companies. For a business that has spent 25 years building Intellectual Property (IP) in exactly these areas, this is like having a race track built specifically to suit the car you already drive.

Record Order Book and a Massive Pipeline — The most concrete near-term signal of Data Patterns' health is its order book. As of early February 2026, the confirmed order book stands at an all-time high of ₹1,868 crore, the largest in the company's history. This is 2.6 times its FY25 revenue, providing significant near-term visibility.

Moving Up the Value Chain: From Subsystems to Full Systems — A particularly exciting internal growth driver is the company's deliberate transition from being a subsystem supplier to a full-systems-and-solutions provider. By using its own reusable building blocks to assemble complete end products, Data Patterns can address a significantly larger total addressable market. Management estimates that products currently in development, including fire control radars and modern EW suites, could individually address markets worth

USD 2 million to USD 3 million.

Export Market: Still Early, But Genuine Momentum

— Exports contributed 9.6 per cent of Q3 FY26 revenue. While that is not large in absolute terms, the strategic significance is much bigger. The company has delivered and received formal Site Acceptance for a Transportable Precision Approach Radar (PAR) in a European country, proving that Indian private defence technology can clear rigorous Western procurement standards. The international order book stands at approximately ₹63 crore, with Europe, UK, and increasingly the U.S. in sight. Management has noted that European defence budgets are rising sharply due to the geopolitical environment, creating an opportunity that simply did not exist a few years ago.

Financials

The numbers tell a compelling story of sustained, profitable growth. Data Patterns has delivered a revenue CAGR of 33 per cent and an EBITDA CAGR of 31 per cent over FY21 to FY25, compounding at rates that most businesses would envy. The recent quarterly performance has been equally strong.

Revenue & Profitability Trend — For the full year FY25, revenue grew 36.3 per cent to ₹708 crore, EBITDA rose to ₹275 crore, and net profit reached ₹222 crore. In Q3 FY26, revenue climbed a further 47.9 per cent year-on-year to ₹173 crore, with EBITDA of ₹78 crore (up 43.6 per cent YoY) and a net profit of ₹58 crore (up 30.5 per cent YoY). On a 9-month basis, revenue surged 85.8 per cent YoY to ₹580 crore, a reflection of the accelerated production deliveries that characterised the first three quarters of FY26.

The Quarterly Pattern — One nuance worth noting is that quarterly revenue can be uneven. In 9MFY26, Q1 contributed 17.1 per cent of revenue, while Q2 and Q3 contributed 53.0 per cent and 29.9 per cent, respectively. This variation appears to be linked to the timing of execution, customer acceptance, and milestone-based billing, which are common in defence contracts. That is why this company is better understood through its trailing or full-year performance, rather than through any single quarter in isolation.

Balance Sheet — The company is entirely net debt free and carries zero bank borrowings. Cash, bank balances, and investments as of December 31, 2025, stand at ₹265 crore. The total shareholders' fund has grown from ₹207.9 crore in FY21 to ₹1,537.8 crore as of September 2025, a reflection of the consistent profitability and the QIP fund raise. While working capital days remain high (approximately 340 days as of December 2025, down from 428 in March 2025), management has guided for meaningful improvement over the next three to five years as the business mix shifts toward shorter-cycle production contracts.

Risks and Challenges

Data Patterns is a compelling story, but these risks deserve a fair hearing.

Execution Delays and Lumpy Revenue — Defence projects run on government timelines, which are notoriously unpredictable. A contract expected in Q1 may arrive in Q3. An acceptance test scheduled for March may slip to June. This creates significant quarter-to-quarter revenue volatility that can unnerve investors unfamiliar with the sector. The company acknowledged on the Q3 earnings call that some development contracts experienced delays due to process bottlenecks on the customer's side. This is a feature of government procurement, not operational weakness, but it demands patience from investors.

Working Capital and Cash Conversion Cycle — The company's working capital cycle is approximately 340 days as of December 2025, down from 428 days in March 2025. Cash can look uncomfortably low at quarter-ends even when the business is fundamentally healthy, because payments on complex development contracts arrive only after formal acceptance milestones.

Customer Concentration in Government — Effectively all of Data Patterns' revenue comes from Indian government entities or government-linked companies. Any slowdown in defence capital expenditure, policy reversal, or procurement preference shift could have an outsized impact. The company is actively diversifying into exports and civilian markets, but this remains a multi-year journey.

Valuation and Outlook

Data Patterns is currently trading at a TTM PE of 75x, slightly above its 3-year median PE of 73x, suggesting that the stock is fairly valued at present. While this may seem high compared to traditional manufacturing companies, it reflects the high-growth potential of the defence electronics space and Data Patterns' leadership in key segments. The stock also offers a dividend yield of 0.23 per cent, which is modest but adds a layer of income for investors. The company maintains a net debt-free status, ensuring financial stability as it continues to expand.

With strong financials in recent quarters, including significant revenue growth and high margins, Data Patterns looks well-positioned to capitalise on the defence sector's long-term growth. The company's transition from subsystems to complete systems, combined with strong demand for advanced electronics and indigenous technology, offers a clear growth trajectory. While short-term execution risks remain, particularly with project delays, Data Patterns' solid order book and high-tech product pipeline give it a strong foundation for continued growth. Its debt-free status and healthy ROCE of 21 per cent add to its attractiveness as a stable, long-term investment.

Considering these factors, we maintain a **HOLD** rating on the stock. While the growth story remains strong, the fair valuation and modest dividend yield indicate that the stock is already priced for much of its future growth. Investors should keep an eye on the company's execution of key orders and expansion into international markets, as these factors will determine whether the stock can continue its upward trajectory.



DALAL STREET INVESTMENT JOURNAL

DEMOCRATIZING WEALTH CREATION

P R E S E N T S

A large elephant is the central focus of the image, standing in a savanna landscape with green grass and dry patches. The elephant is facing right, with its trunk slightly curved. The background shows a clear blue sky with some white clouds. The text 'LARGE CAP 2026' is overlaid on the elephant's body in a large, bold, white font with a black outline.

LARGE CAP 2026

Betting On Large-Cap Stocks

When markets run hard for long enough, investors stop asking whether valuations make sense and start assuming momentum is a strategy. For four years, mid and small-cap stocks rewarded that assumption generously. In 2026, the bill has arrived. With the Nifty Smallcap 250 down nearly 18 per cent from its peak and large-caps trading at their deepest discount to historical valuations in years, the market is quietly signalling what disciplined investors already know: size, stability and liquidity matter most when the tide turns

There is a particular kind of investor confidence that builds slowly and then breaks all at once. Between 2021 and 2024, Indian equity markets delivered one of their most exhilarating multi-year runs in the broader segments. Mid-cap and small-cap stocks surged relentlessly, outpacing their large-cap counterparts by a wide margin. SIP inflows swelled. Retail participation reached record levels. Thematic funds multiplied. Every quarter seemed to validate the narrative that India's growth story was best captured not in the boardrooms of Nifty giants, but in the ambitions of smaller, faster-moving companies.

That confidence is now being tested. As of March 13, 2026, the Nifty Smallcap 250 has fallen 10.95 per cent year-to-date. The Nifty Midcap 150 is down 9.17 per cent. Even the correction from recent peaks tells a sharper story: the Nifty Smallcap 250 is trading 17.7 per cent below its 52-week high, while the Nifty Midcap 150 is 10.7 per cent off its peak. This is not a minor pullback. It is a recalibration one that is forcing investors to ask a question that felt unnecessary just twelve months ago: should portfolios be moving back toward large-cap stocks?

The answer, grounded in data, is increasingly yes. Not because large-caps promise spectacular short-term gains, but because the combination of relative valuation comfort, institutional support, earnings resilience and superior liquidity makes them better positioned for the environment that is now unfolding. Understanding why requires going back to the cycle that created the current situation.

The Broader Market Rally: When Size Did Not Matter

To appreciate the current moment, one must first understand the scale of what preceded it. From December 31, 2020 to March 13, 2026, Indian equity indices delivered a wide spectrum of outcomes depending on where capital was deployed.

Index	Return (Dec. 2020 - Mar. 2026)
Nifty 50	65.58%
Nifty 100	69.25%
Nifty Midcap 150	157.32%
Nifty Smallcap 250	144.52%

The divergence is staggering. The Nifty Midcap 150 delivered more than double the return of the Nifty 100 over this period. Small-caps also surged dramatically. The years 2021 and 2023 were particularly emphatic. In 2021, mid-caps returned 46.81 per cent and small-caps returned 61.94 per cent, compared to 25.04 per cent for the Nifty 100. In 2023, the gap repeated: mid-caps gained 43.68 per cent and small-caps 48.10 per cent, while large-caps delivered 20.05 per cent.

Year	Nifty 50	Nifty 100	Mid-Cap 150	Small-Cap 250
2021	24.12%	25.04%	46.81%	61.94%
2022	4.33%	3.63%	2.96%	-3.65%
2023	20.03%	20.05%	43.68%	48.10%
2024	8.80%	11.76%	23.80%	26.43%
2025	10.51%	8.96%	5.37%	-6.01%
2026 YTD (till Mar. 13)	-11.40%	-10.64%	-9.17%	-10.95%

This data tells two stories simultaneously. The first is the extraordinary wealth created in mid and small-caps during strong liquidity phases. The second, however, is equally important: when cycles turn, broader market stocks absorb disproportionate pain. In 2022, small-caps delivered -3.65 per cent while large-caps stayed positive.

In 2025, small-caps fell -6.01 per cent while the Nifty 100 still delivered 8.96 per cent. And in 2026 so far, despite a broad-based correction, small-caps are again underperforming on an absolute basis after five years of cumulative overperformance. Market leadership never remains permanent. Cycles rotate. The question is not whether the rotation is happening, but whether investors are positioned ahead of it.

The Drawdown Story: Where the Real Risk Sits

Percentage returns from a fixed base date can sometimes obscure what investors actually experience in real time. A more visceral measure of risk is the drawdown from recent peaks the distance between where an index stood at its best and where it stands today.

Index	52-Week High	Level on Mar. 13, 2026	Drawdown from Peak
Nifty 50	26,373	23,151	-12.2%
Nifty 100	26,975	23,849	-11.6%
Nifty Midcap 150	22,650	20,233	-10.7%
Nifty Smallcap 250	18,077	14,858	-17.7%

The Nifty Smallcap 250 is nearly 18 per cent below its 52-week high. For an investor who deployed capital at or near the peak which many retail investors did given the surge in SIP registrations and lump sum allocations during optimistic phases this represents a meaningful erosion of capital. The mid-cap drawdown of 10.7 per cent, while less severe, comes after a period of stretched valuations, which amplifies the psychological and financial impact.

Large-caps, despite also correcting, carry a critical structural advantage in such phases: depth of liquidity. An investor who needs to exit a small-cap position in a falling market faces a far steeper discount than one exiting a Nifty 100 stock. This liquidity premium is invisible during bull markets and painfully visible during corrections.

The Liquidity Illusion in Small-Caps

During bull markets, small-cap stocks appear liquid because volumes rise with prices. This creates a false sense of security. In corrections, liquidity evaporates rapidly. Bid-ask spreads widen. Exit prices fall sharply below market quotes. Institutional investors who set price discovery prioritise large-cap exits first. Small caps absorb residual selling at whatever price clears. This is not a market anomaly. It is a structural feature. Investors who ignore it during good times pay for the education during bad ones.

Valuations: The Most Compelling Argument for Large Caps Today

If the drawdown data makes a risk argument for large caps, the valuation data makes an opportunity argument. And it is, by any measure, a strong one.

Index	Current P/E	10-Year Median P/E	Premium / Discount to History (%)
Nifty 50	20.3x	23.4x	-13.2 (Discount)
Nifty 100	19.8x	24.1x	-17.8 (Discount)
Nifty Midcap 150	30.1x	29.8x	+1.0 (Premium)
Nifty Smallcap 250	24.5x	29.8x	-17.8 (Discount)

The numbers here deserve careful attention. The Nifty 100 is currently trading at 19.8 times earnings, against a 10-year median of 24.1 times. That is a discount of nearly 18 per cent to its own historical average. The Nifty 50 trades at 20.3 times against a median of 23.4 times — a discount of over 13 per cent. These are not trivial gaps. They suggest that India's largest, most liquid companies are available at valuations meaningfully below what investors have historically been willing to pay for them.

Mid caps, by contrast, trade at 30.1 times earnings against a 10-year median of 29.8 times. They are broadly in line with

historical averages, which may sound reasonable until one considers the context: they are at median valuations after a correction, having recently traded well above those levels during the rally. The valuation comfort that large caps offer is simply not available in the broader market at the same degree.

Valuation alone never guarantees returns in the short run. But over a medium to long horizon, buying assets at a discount to their historical averages is one of the most time tested principles in equity investing. Today, large caps offer that entry point. The broader market, despite its correction, does not offer the same margin of safety.

What a P/E Discount to History Actually Means

When the Nifty 100 trades at 19.8x against a 10-year median of 24.1x, it does not mean returns are guaranteed. What it does mean is that the market is pricing India's largest companies at a level of pessimism that has historically been a good entry point for patient investors.

P/E discounts to median tend to compress over time either through earnings growth, price appreciation, or both. Investors who entered Nifty 100 at similar or higher discounts to median in 2013 and 2020 saw meaningful medium-term returns in the years that followed. Valuation is not a timing tool. It is a risk management tool. And right now, it is firmly in favour of large caps.

Institutional Ownership: Where Smart Money Is Anchored

Ownership patterns across market segments reveal another structural advantage of large caps. The Nifty 50 and Nifty 100 collectively represent approximately 64.96 per cent of the total free-float market capitalisation of NSE-listed stocks. The Nifty Midcap 150 represents 17.27 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 250 represents just 5.20 per cent. This concentration of economic weight in large caps is mirrored in institutional holdings.

Segment	DII Holding	FII Holding	Total Institutional
Large-Caps (Nifty 100)	25% - 28%	22% - 25%	~47%-53%
Mid-Caps (Nifty Midcap 150)	16% - 18%	18% - 20%	~34%-38%
Small-Caps (Nifty Smallcap 250)	12% - 14%	14% - 16%	~26%-30%

Large-cap stocks attract roughly half their free float from institutional investors both domestic and foreign. This has a profound stabilising effect. Domestic institutional investors, fuelled by SIP inflows that now run consistently above ₹25,000 crore per month, provide a persistent bid under large-cap stocks even during foreign selling. The data confirms this dynamic: in recent quarters, as FIIs reduced exposure to large caps by 0.8 to 1.5 percentage points, DIIs increased their holdings by 0.5 to 1 percentage point, absorbing the selling pressure.

This DII-FII tug of war matters. In mid and small caps, where institutional ownership is lower and retail participation is higher, there is no comparable cushion. When sentiment turns and retail investors exit simultaneously, price discovery can

Special Report

become disorderly. Large caps, supported by institutional flows anchored in systematic investment programmes, are structurally less vulnerable to such dynamics.

Earnings Growth: Consistency vs. Speed

One of the most cited reasons for preferring mid and small caps is their superior earnings growth. The data broadly supports this historical observation.

Segment	Avg. Earnings Growth (YoY)	Key Drivers
Nifty 50 (Large-Caps)	9% - 11%	Banking, IT, consumer staples
Nifty Midcap 150	15% - 18%	Autos, retail, discretionary
Nifty Smallcap 250	18% - 22%	Metals, infra, high-beta sectors
BSE 500 (Broad Market)	14% - 16%	Consumption-led recovery

Mid and small caps do grow faster. But this analysis requires a crucial qualifier: faster average growth comes with significantly higher variance. The same sectors that drove 18 to 22 per cent earnings growth in good years — metals, infrastructure, high-beta industrials are also the ones that see sharp earnings contractions when global commodity cycles turn or domestic capex slows. The earnings growth number quoted for small caps is an average that obscures a wide distribution of outcomes.

Large-cap earnings growth of 9 to 11 per cent may appear modest by comparison. But it is delivered with far greater consistency. Banks generate stable net interest income. IT companies have long-term contracts. Consumer staples businesses protect margins through brand power. This reliability has a compounding effect that is easy to underestimate when markets are rewarding growth stories aggressively, but deeply valuable when uncertainty rises. In the current environment, where global growth expectations are being revised, interest rates remain elevated across major economies and Indian corporate earnings face margin pressure from multiple directions, the predictability of large-cap earnings is a genuine competitive advantage.

The Compounding Case for Earnings Consistency

An investment that grows earnings at 10 per cent consistently over 10 years generates a 2.6x expansion in the earnings base. An investment that grows at 20 per cent for 5 years but contracts 10 per cent for the next 5 generates a similar or lower outcome with far greater emotional cost along the way. In equity markets, consistency is underpriced during bull phases and aggressively repriced during corrections. This is exactly the dynamic playing out in 2025 and 2026, as investors who chased small-cap growth numbers are now experiencing the variance that always accompanied those averages.

The Volatile Environment: Why Global Uncertainty Amplifies the Case

The argument for large caps is not built solely on domestic data. The global environment in 2026 has shifted meaningfully in ways that disproportionately benefit large, liquid, domestically entrenched businesses over smaller, more financially leveraged

or export sensitive ones.

Foreign institutional investors have been net sellers of Indian equities for extended periods, reflecting a broader global risk-off posture. In 2025, FPI equity outflows reached ₹1,66,286 crore one of the sharpest single-year withdrawal figures in recent memory. In January 2026 alone, FPIs pulled out ₹35,962 crore from equities. When foreign capital exits at this scale, it does not exit uniformly. It exits through the most liquid channel available, which means large caps absorb the brunt of institutional selling but also recover fastest once flows reverse.

Mid and small caps, by contrast, experience delayed and more disorderly selling during FPI led risk off phases. Retail investors, who constitute a higher proportion of the ownership base in these segments, tend to sell reactively rather than strategically. This amplifies volatility without necessarily improving the quality of price discovery.

The structural case is reinforced by one more factor: market representation. The Nifty 100 represents nearly 65 per cent of India's listed market capitalisation. These companies are not just large; they are the Indian economy. Banks that fund infrastructure. Energy companies that power factories. Technology firms that serve global clients. Consumer businesses that capture domestic demand. Betting on large caps in India is, in a meaningful sense, betting on India itself with a margin of safety built into the entry price.

Portfolio Implications: Rebalancing With Discipline

None of this analysis suggests that mid-cap and small-cap stocks should be abandoned. Over a full market cycle, they remain essential components of wealth creation. The data from 2021 to 2024 is too compelling to ignore. The argument here is more nuanced and more actionable: after several years in which the risk-reward balance tilted aggressively toward the broader market, that balance is now shifting back toward large caps.

For investors who accumulated mid and small-cap exposure during the rally, a gradual rebalancing toward large caps serves multiple purposes. It reduces overall portfolio volatility. It improves liquidity, ensuring the ability to act during future opportunities. It positions portfolios toward assets trading at discounts to historical valuations. And it provides exposure to earnings streams that are more predictable in an uncertain global environment.

The rebalancing does not need to be abrupt. Markets rarely reward dramatic repositioning. But investors who wait for clarity for volatility to subside, for mid-cap earnings to stabilise, for global flows to turn positive will likely find that large caps have already repriced much of the opportunity away. The entry points that valuation data reveals today are a function of current stress. They rarely persist once the stress passes.

Conclusion: Stability Is Not the Absence of Ambition

The instinct to chase the fastest moving segment of the market is deeply human. It is also, historically, one of the most reliable ways to arrive late at every party. Between 2021 and 2024, mid and small caps were the party. They delivered extraordinary returns to those who entered early and had the discipline to stay. For many investors, however, the entry came late and the discipline is now being tested.

Large caps are not a consolation prize. They are the foundation. The Nifty 100 at a nearly 18 per cent discount to its 10-year median P/E, backed by consistent earnings growth, deep institutional ownership and the liquidity to navigate any

environment, represents a compelling opportunity for investors who approach markets with a medium to long-term horizon.

The years ahead are unlikely to reward portfolios that are overweight a single capitalisation segment. They will reward portfolios that are structured thoughtfully — with large caps providing the stability and liquidity base, and selective mid and small-cap exposure adding growth where valuations justify the risk.

Betting on large-cap stocks today is not a defensive move. It is a disciplined one. In markets where global uncertainty remains elevated and the easy liquidity that powered the broader market rally is no longer available, discipline is precisely what the environment demands.

Methodology

To come up with a list of performing large-cap stocks, we took into consideration five crucial parameters. The first includes market capitalization. The second, third and fourth parameters obtained from the Profit & Loss Account include Sales, Operating Profit and Net Profit. We have also taken into consideration the efficiency of the companies by analyzing profit margins. Lastly, we factored in the returns earned by investors by means of dividends. This is because we want investor-friendly companies to be featured on our list. Each parameter was then ranked by awarding it a carefully determined weightage based on its significance. We then segregated the companies into two categories as follows:

- **Turnaround Performance:** These companies include those

that successfully managed to turnaround the losses incurred in FY24 into profits in FY25.

- **Thriving Companies:** This list includes all those companies that have seen their profits increasing on yearly basis for FY25.
- **Banks and financial companies** are treated differently here — Profit Before Tax replaces operating profit as the relevant earnings measure, reflecting the distinct nature of financial sector accounting.

All the raw financial data is sourced from Accord Fintech and price-related information is as of March 13, 2026.



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Zydus: A Global Pharma Powerhouse in the Making

What is the long-term sustainable growth outlook for the International Markets business after the recent 38 per cent year-on-year growth acceleration?

Our International Markets business continues to deliver strong growth and broad-based momentum, recording a robust 38 per cent year-on-year growth in Q3FY26. This performance has been driven by our focused, therapy-led approach in emerging markets, along with the meaningful expansion of our portfolio and market reach across Europe. Newly added markets, including the UK and several emerging regions, have performed well and exceeded expectations. Backed by strong operational execution and differentiated product offerings, we remain confident of sustaining 20 per cent+ growth going forward and building a resilient international franchise over the long term.

To what extent will the India Formulations business continue to be driven by its innovation portfolio and chronic segment, and do you expect this to remain the key reason for outperformance versus the broader market?

India branded formulations grew 14 per cent year on year, once again outperforming the broader market, supported by innovation-led products and pillar brands. Chronic therapies remained the key growth driver, with their contribution rising to 45.3 per cent as of MAT December 2025, reflecting an improvement of 560 basis points over three years and 660 basis points over the last four years. During Q3FY26, the business outpaced the market in key therapies such as Cardiology, Respiratory, Dermatology and Pain Management, as well as in super-specialty areas including Oncology and Nephrology. The innovative portfolio, comprising Saroglitazar, Desidustat and Ujvira, grew 23 per cent in Q3FY26 and is expected to scale further on the back of strong traction, while growth-booster brands

Dr. Sharvil Patel
Managing Director
Zydus Lifesciences Limited



delivered growth of over 13 per cent. Over the last four years, from CY21 to CY25, the share of the innovation portfolio in the India business has increased from around 1 per cent to around 9 per cent, according to IQVIA. Saroglitazar crossed Rs 500 crore in revenues in CY25, as per IQVIA. The number of large brands has also increased steadily over the years, with the contribution of brands exceeding Rs 25 crore rising from 56 per cent of total India sales in CY21 to 64 per cent in CY25. We expect the India business to sustain double-digit growth and continue outperforming the IPM, supported by continued traction in the innovation portfolio and growth-booster brands, monetisation of the biosimilars portfolio including recently approved launches, an uptick in the vaccines business, the GLP-1 opportunity, and the increasing salience of chronic therapies.

As the company sharpens its focus on specialty therapies, how do you plan to balance this strategic shift with the U.S. business's existing generics-led foundation?

The U.S. generics foundation remains robust, supported by a diversified product portfolio comprising both internal and partner products, even as the business pivots towards specialty segments such as 505(b)(2), paediatric rare diseases and the innovation portfolio. In the generics space, a number of important launches, including some with sole exclusivity, are planned over the next two years. In FY27, we expect to launch 40–45 new products, positioning the business for a strong growth trajectory ahead. On the specialty front, we will leverage our 505(b)(2) portfolio, paediatric rare disease products, biosimilars and our novel chemical entity, Saroglitazar.

While the generics portfolio continues to provide scale, cash flows and market presence, we are steadily expanding our U.S. specialty footprint across multiple platforms. These include 505(b)(2), rare disease offerings, biosimilars and the NCE pipeline, which are expected to drive margin expansion and sustainable growth over time.

What are the key operational and execution challenges in scaling up the new Bio CDMO business at the acquired Agenus facilities?

We expect commercialisation to begin from H2FY27, starting with the supply of BOT and BAL. We are currently focused on qualifying the facilities and onboarding new customers. Scaling up the CDMO business is expected to take at least two to three years. The first key milestone will be the progress of BOT and BAL in their clinical and regulatory journey. Our execution priorities for Agenus include facility qualification, regulatory readiness, onboarding external CDMO clients and scaling production capabilities.

How are recent acquisitions such as Comfort Click and Amplitude Surgical expected to affect the company's blended operating margins over the next fiscal year?

Comfort Click has lower margins compared to Zydus' consolidated margins. Amplitude Surgical operates at margins

similar to our existing business, and therefore its impact is largely neutral. Considering the overall scale of the business, we do not expect a material impact on consolidated margins due to the acquisitions of Amplitude and CCL. Consolidated EBITDA margins for the first nine months stood at 30.3 per cent, and we expect margins of over 23 per cent in Q4FY26 despite the reduction in high-margin Revlimid revenues and the integration of CCL and Amplitude. The strategic expansion into wellness through CCL and MedTech through Amplitude is expected to support long-term growth and diversification.

How is the company preparing its commercial and go-to-market infrastructure for the potential U.S. launch of Saroglitazar Magnesium?

The NDA filing for PBC is expected in Q4FY26, with the launch timeline dependent on whether the review follows a fast-track pathway of 6–9 months or a standard 12-month timeline. Pre-operative work is currently underway, while field force hiring will be initiated closer to the launch, with an indicative sales team of around 60–80 members. Commercial expenses for Saroglitazar are expected to pick up meaningfully in the latter part of FY27. At present, the key priority remains the NDA filing. Following the first review with the FDA, the field force ramp-up will commence.

Your continuous investments in R&D seem to be paying off. With the approval for Desidustat in China, how is your global strategy going to pan out?

Zydus Group is at a critical inflection point, staying ahead of the curve as an innovation-led, global life-sciences organisation. Zydus has achieved several industry firsts, including the development of India's first novel biologics and vaccines, and the successful lab-to-market New Chemical Entity (NCE), Lipaglyn (Saroglitazar Mg), in 2013 which is now helping patients with Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatotic Liver Disease (MASLD) and Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis (MASH). Oxemia (Desidustat) to treat chronic anaemia in Chronic Kidney Disease in 2022, has benefitted more than 1 lakh patients with CKD in India. In fact, with Desidustat's approval in China, this becomes the first New Chemical Entity to be approved anywhere outside of India.

We have also received USFDA Orphan Drug Designation (ODD) for Desidustat for the treatment of Sickle Cell Disease. We have also launched therapies for rare and orphan diseases like Nulibry, Zokinvy and ZYCUBO to treat MOCD Type A, Progeria and Menkes' Disease which are rare paediatric life-threatening disorders. In addition, ZYIL1 has received orphan drug designation from the USFDA for Cryopyrin-Associated Periodic Syndrome (CAPS).

Zydus addresses the entire patient journey, offering solutions across every stage of care. Its diversified presence spans the full healthcare value chain, including consumer wellness, preventive vaccines, pharmaceuticals and med-tech, enabling a more integrated and patient-centric approach to healthcare delivery. ■

Turnaround Companies

These companies include those that successfully managed to turn around losses incurred in FY24 into profits in FY25.

Sr. No.
1

Lenskart Solutions Ltd.

BSE Code: 544600

Price (₹): 504.25

Face Value (₹): 2

Book Value: 52.78

Last Five Years' Financial Data

(₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	6,653	5,428	3,788	1,503	905
Operating Profit	977	680	264	-115	-47
Interest	147	124	83	23	7
PAT	297	-10	-64	-102	29
Adjusted EPS (₹)	3.83	-2.26	-8.34	-13.39	3.79
Equity Capital	154	154	15	15	15

Sr. No.	Glenmark Pharmaceuticals Ltd.				
2					
BSE Code: 532296	Price (₹): 2258	Face Value (₹): 1	Book Value: 858.30		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	16,468	13,322	11,813	12,990	12,305
Operating Profit	4,371	2,351	1,195	2,278	2,327
Interest	233	207	516	350	298
PAT	1,065	1,047	-1,434	377	994
Adjusted EPS (₹)	37.74	37.11	-53.22	10.53	33.37
Equity Capital	28	28	28	28	28

Sr. No.	UPL Ltd.				
3					
BSE Code: 512070		Price (₹): 628.45	Face Value (₹): 2	Book Value: 161.76	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
(₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	49077	46637	43098	53576	46240
Operating Profit	8743	7128	4297	10196	9529
Interest	3479	3627	3852	2963	2295
PAT	2005	820	-1878	4414	4437
Adjusted EPS (₹)	20.83	10.62	-14.21	42.28	42.18
Equity Capital	169	159	150	150	153

Improving Companies

These companies include those that continued to report losses in FY25, albeit at lower levels than the previous year.

Sr. No.	Vodafone Idea Ltd.				
1					
BSE Code: 532822	Price (₹): 9.57	Face Value (₹): 10	Book Value: -8.06		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	44,554	43,571	42,652	42,177	38,516
Operating Profit	18,773	18,049	17,072	16,753	15,968
Interest	22,976	24,543	25,766	23,354	20,981
PAT	-24,584	-27,383	-31,238	-29,301	-28,245
Adjusted EPS (₹)	-2.61	-3.84	-6.23	-6.02	-8.79
Equity Capital	1,08,343	71,393	50,120	48,680	32,119

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)
Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

The last five years' financial data may not be based on the same reporting period for every company. Some numbers are shown on a TTM basis, while others are reported as per the company's year-end format, such as December-ending or FY25.

“For many investors, large-cap stocks offer familiarity, liquidity, and relative comfort during uncertain times. They may not always be the fastest movers, but they often remain central to long term portfolios. This section presents essential data on large-cap companies to help readers assess their standing at a glance. Investors should use this information as a reference and apply their own discretion before making any investment decision.”

Thriving Companies

This list includes all companies that have seen their profits increase on a yearly basis in FY25.

Sr. No.	Bajaj Finance Ltd.				
1					
BSE Code: 500034		Price (₹): 863.55	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 157.34	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	79,374.00	69,709.00	54,974.00	41,411.00	31,633.00
Operating Profit	24,054.00	22,080.00	19,310.00	15,528.00	9,504.00
Interest	27,820.00	24,992.00	18,886.00	12,701.00	9,848.00
PAT	18,325.00	16,779.00	14,451.00	11,508.00	7,028.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	29.00	26.77	23.35	19.01	11.61
Equity Capital	622.00	124.00	124.00	121.00	121.00

Sr. No.	Shriram Finance Ltd.				
2					
BSE Code: 511218		Price (₹): 1,031.40	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 334.43	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	47,074.00	43,941.00	34,973.00	30,492.00	19,255.00
Operating Profit	12,155.00	12,644.00	9,884.00	8,214.00	3,549.00
Interest	21,409.00	18,529.00	14,868.00	12,987.00	9,773.00
PAT	9,147.00	9,576.00	7,399.00	6,020.00	2,721.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	48.63	50.81	39.20	32.11	20.12
Equity Capital	376.00	376.00	376.00	374.00	271.00

Sr. No.	Adani Green Energy Ltd.				
3					
BSE Code: 541450		Price (₹): 865.95	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 90.33	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	12,499.00	11,212.00	9,220.00	7,792.00	5,133.00
Operating Profit	10,279.00	8,889.00	7,339.00	4,970.00	3,512.00
Interest	6,226.00	5,492.00	5,088.00	2,911.00	2,617.00
PAT	1,856.00	2,001.00	1,260.00	973.00	489.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	9.13	9.12	6.94	6.15	3.13
Equity Capital	1,647.00	1,584.00	1,584.00	1,584.00	1,564.00

Sr. No.	Tata Capital Ltd.				
4					
BSE Code: 544574		Price (₹): 318.50	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 89.39	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	30,856.00	28,324.00	18,178.00	13,631.00	10,162.00
Operating Profit	5,952.00	4,919.00	4,392.00	3,937.00	2,348.00
Interest	15,928.00	15,030.00	9,568.00	6,601.00	4,889.00
PAT	4,424.00	3,655.00	3,327.00	2,946.00	1,801.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	10.93	9.64	8.41	8.51	4.69
Equity Capital	4,007.00	3,762.00	3,703.00	3,507.00	3,463.00

Sr. No.	Bharti Airtel Ltd.				
5					
BSE Code: 532454	Price (₹): 1,800.80	Face Value (₹): 5.00	Book Value: 235.63		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	203,466.00	172,985.00	149,982.00	139,145.00	116,547.00
Operating Profit	115,192.00	85,060.00	77,893.00	71,274.00	57,534.00
Interest	21,452.00	21,754.00	22,648.00	19,300.00	16,616.00
PAT	37,051.00	37,481.00	8,558.00	12,287.00	8,305.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	53.30	58.85	13.20	14.97	7.23
Equity Capital	2,900.00	2,900.00	2,877.00	2,837.00	2,795.00

Sr. No.	HDFC Bank Ltd.				
6					
BSE Code: 500180	Price (₹): 832.50	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 349.70		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	348,212.00	336,367.00	283,649.00	170,754.00	135,936.00
Operating Profit	100,043.00	96,242.00	76,569.00	61,498.00	50,873.00
Interest	187,257.00	183,894.00	154,139.00	77,780.00	58,584.00
PAT	77,430.00	73,440.00	65,446.00	46,149.00	38,151.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	48.54	46.26	42.16	41.22	34.31
Equity Capital	1,536.00	765.00	760.00	558.00	555.00

Sr. No.	Axis Bank Ltd.				
7					
BSE Code: 532215		Price (₹): 1,233.75	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 633.04	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	130,820.00	127,374.00	112,759.00	87,448.00	68,846.00
Operating Profit	34,941.00	36,722.00	35,178.00	18,621.00	18,929.00
Interest	73,116.00	71,036.00	61,391.00	43,389.00	34,923.00
PAT	26,415.00	28,191.00	26,492.00	10,919.00	14,207.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	84.66	90.58	85.49	35.16	45.99
Equity Capital	621.00	619.00	617.00	615.00	614.00

Sr. No.	Punjab National Bank				
8					
BSE Code: 532461	Price (₹): 116.60	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 116.43		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	130,497.00	124,010.00	109,065.00	86,845.00	76,242.00
Operating Profit	26,458.00	26,015.00	14,160.00	5,151.00	4,826.00
Interest	87,490.00	80,704.00	68,534.00	51,817.00	46,823.00
PAT	17,875.00	18,553.00	9,157.00	3,359.00	3,908.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	15.47	16.08	8.27	3.04	3.51
Equity Capital	2,299.00	2,299.00	2,202.00	2,202.00	2,202.00

Sr. No.	Adani Power Ltd.				
9					
BSE Code: 533096		Price (₹): 149.10	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 25.89	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
(₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	54,255.00	56,203.00	50,351.00	38,773.00	27,711.00
Operating Profit	19,886.00	21,418.00	18,228.00	10,096.00	9,881.00
Interest	3,164.00	3,340.00	3,388.00	3,334.00	4,095.00
PAT	11,299.00	12,750.00	20,829.00	10,727.00	4,912.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	5.95	6.71	10.80	5.56	2.55
Equity Capital	3,857.00	3,857.00	3,857.00	3,857.00	3,857.00

Sr. No.

10

State Bank Of India

BSE Code: 500112

Price (₹): 1,085.35

Face Value (₹): 1.00

Book Value: 555.40

Last Five Years' Financial Data

(₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	511,356.00	490,938.00	439,189.00	350,845.00	289,973.00
Operating Profit	114,849.00	106,365.00	91,240.00	75,399.00	49,739.00
Interest	313,278.00	300,943.00	259,736.00	189,981.00	156,194.00
PAT	86,537.00	80,523.00	69,543.00	57,750.00	37,183.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	91.71	86.91	75.17	62.35	39.64
Equity Capital	923.00	892.00	892.00	892.00	892.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

Sr. No. 11 Cholamandalam Invest. & Fin. Co. Ltd.

BSE Code: 511243 Price (₹): 1,523.85 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 335.18

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	29,702.00	25,890.00	19,163.00	12,884.00	10,148.00
Operating Profit	6,532.00	5,741.00	4,605.00	3,615.00	2,908.00
Interest	13,996.00	12,495.00	9,231.00	5,748.00	4,298.00
PAT	4,847.00	4,263.00	3,420.00	2,665.00	2,154.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	57.57	50.69	40.72	32.42	26.23
Equity Capital	168.00	168.00	168.00	164.00	164.00

Sr. No. 13 Bank Of Baroda

BSE Code: 532134 Price (₹): 289.15 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 293.55

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	132,604.00	127,945.00	118,379.00	94,503.00	73,385.00
Operating Profit	25,799.00	27,619.00	25,799.00	20,565.00	10,008.00
Interest	81,357.00	78,265.00	69,899.00	49,942.00	38,815.00
PAT	19,645.00	20,865.00	18,869.00	15,005.00	7,933.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	37.65	40.06	36.29	28.82	15.18
Equity Capital	1,036.00	1,036.00	1,036.00	1,036.00	1,036.00

Sr. No. 15 Canara Bank

BSE Code: 532483 Price (₹): 140.30 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 117.73

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	126,028.00	121,601.00	110,519.00	85,885.00	70,614.00
Operating Profit	23,781.00	23,025.00	20,000.00	14,427.00	9,145.00
Interest	88,669.00	82,681.00	72,118.00	52,990.00	43,035.00
PAT	18,415.00	17,692.00	15,401.00	11,345.00	6,158.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	20.25	19.34	16.84	12.41	6.75
Equity Capital	1,814.00	1,814.00	1,814.00	1,814.00	1,814.00

Sr. No. 17 Bajaj Finserv Ltd.

BSE Code: 532978 Price (₹): 1,770.90 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 62.46

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	149,145.00	133,822.00	110,382.00	82,072.00	68,406.00
Operating Profit	54,959.00	49,524.00	40,886.00	29,868.00	21,455.00
Interest	27,337.00	24,587.00	18,607.00	12,380.00	9,629.00
PAT	19,200.00	17,558.00	15,595.00	12,210.00	8,314.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	60.59	55.57	51.07	40.29	28.63
Equity Capital	160.00	160.00	159.00	159.00	80.00

Sr. No. 19 The Indian Hotels Company Ltd.

BSE Code: 500850 Price (₹): 624.80 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 86.95

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	9,349.00	8,335.00	6,769.00	5,810.00	3,056.00
Operating Profit	3,079.00	2,769.00	2,160.00	1,805.00	405.00
Interest	220.00	208.00	220.00	236.00	428.00
PAT	2,164.00	2,038.00	1,330.00	1,053.00	-265.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	14.10	13.40	8.85	7.06	-1.74
Equity Capital	142.00	142.00	142.00	142.00	142.00

Sr. No. 12 Adani Ports and Special Eco. Zone Ltd.

BSE Code: 532921 Price (₹): 1,391.30 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 205.76

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	36,487.00	30,475.00	26,711.00	20,852.00	17,119.00
Operating Profit	21,627.00	18,141.00	15,589.00	10,947.00	9,528.00
Interest	3,764.00	2,532.00	2,733.00	2,363.00	2,544.00
PAT	12,497.00	11,061.00	8,104.00	5,391.00	4,953.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	56.93	51.35	37.55	24.58	23.13
Equity Capital	432.00	432.00	432.00	432.00	422.00

Sr. No. 14 Union Bank Of India

BSE Code: 532477 Price (₹): 182.10 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 155.91

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	108,368.00	108,417.00	100,376.00	81,163.00	68,230.00
Operating Profit	23,534.00	23,424.00	21,507.00	12,147.00	8,566.00
Interest	71,093.00	70,733.00	63,364.00	48,033.00	40,178.00
PAT	18,938.00	18,027.00	13,797.00	8,512.00	5,265.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	24.81	23.62	18.07	12.45	7.70
Equity Capital	7,738.00	7,634.00	7,634.00	6,835.00	6,835.00

Sr. No. 16 ICICI Bank Ltd.

BSE Code: 532174 Price (₹): 1,266.10 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 442.71

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	194,012.00	186,331.00	159,516.00	121,067.00	95,407.00
Operating Profit	75,426.00	72,854.00	60,434.00	46,256.00	34,241.00
Interest	90,029.00	89,028.00	74,108.00	50,543.00	41,167.00
PAT	56,609.00	54,569.00	46,081.00	35,461.00	26,538.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	74.19	71.65	63.02	48.74	36.14
Equity Capital	1,429.00	1,425.00	1,405.00	1,397.00	1,390.00

Sr. No. 18 Bajaj Housing Finance Ltd.

BSE Code: 544252 Price (₹): 83.72 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 26.22

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	10,764.00	9,576.00	7,617.00	5,665.00	3,767.00
Operating Profit	3,230.00	2,814.00	2,201.00	1,733.00	986.00
Interest	6,548.00	5,981.00	4,695.00	3,213.00	2,157.00
PAT	2,478.00	2,163.00	1,731.00	1,258.00	710.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	2.97	2.60	2.58	1.87	1.45
Equity Capital	8,328.00	6,712.00	6,712.00	4,883.00	4,883.00

Sr. No. 20 Interglobe Aviation Ltd.

BSE Code: 539448 Price (₹): 4,253.45 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 235.99

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	84,675.00	80,803.00	68,904.00	54,446.00	25,931.00
Operating Profit	17,263.00	18,102.00	16,356.00	6,531.00	575.00
Interest	5,780.00	5,124.00	4,208.00	3,168.00	2,386.00
PAT	3,211.00	7,258.00	8,172.00	-306.00	-6,162.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	83.12	187.84	211.73	-7.93	-159.94
Equity Capital	387.00	386.00	386.00	386.00	385.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

[Thriving Companies]

Sr. No. 21	Trent Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500251		Price (₹): 3,532.15	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 204.08	
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	19,263.00	17,135.00	12,375.00	8,242.00	4,498.00
Operating Profit	3,396.00	2,820.00	1,971.00	1,114.00	595.00
Interest	162.00	200.00	368.00	409.00	325.00
PAT	1,620.00	1,534.00	1,477.00	394.00	35.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	46.06	43.51	41.82	12.51	2.98
Equity Capital	36.00	36.00	36.00	36.00	36.00

Sr. No. 23	Multi Commodity Exchange Of India Ltd.				
BSE Code: 534091		Price (₹): 2,525.00	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 93.88	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	1,704.00	1,113.00	684.00	514.00	367.00
Operating Profit	1,137.00	665.00	63.00	145.00	161.00
Interest	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
PAT	937.00	560.00	83.00	149.00	143.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	36.75	21.96	3.26	5.84	5.63
Equity Capital	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00

Sr. No. 25	Eicher Motors Ltd.				
BSE Code: 505200		Price (₹): 6,974.90	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 747.53	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	22,569.00	18,870.00	16,536.00	14,442.00	10,298.00
Operating Profit	5,529.00	4,723.00	4,329.00	3,446.00	2,178.00
Interest	67.00	54.00	51.00	28.00	19.00
PAT	5,357.00	4,734.00	4,001.00	2,914.00	1,677.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	195.35	172.69	146.13	106.55	61.32
Equity Capital	27.00	27.00	27.00	27.00	27.00

Sr. No. 27	Bank Of India				
BSE Code: 532149		Price (₹): 154.75	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 167.63	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
(₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	74,519.00	71,308.00	61,073.00	47,932.00	38,281.00
Operating Profit	13,025.00	12,771.00	10,375.00	6,056.00	5,655.00
Interest	49,688.00	46,594.00	37,757.00	27,441.00	24,083.00
PAT	9,823.00	9,552.00	6,567.00	3,839.00	3,487.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	21.58	20.97	14.42	9.35	8.51
Equity Capital	4,553.00	4,553.00	4,553.00	4,104.00	4,104.00

Sr. No. 29	Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500247		Price (₹): 375.30	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 129.30	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	68,726.00	65,669.00	56,237.00	42,151.00	33,741.00
Operating Profit	24,901.00	28,989.00	23,863.00	19,646.00	15,948.00
Interest	29,404.00	28,275.00	22,567.00	14,411.00	11,554.00
PAT	18,798.00	22,126.00	18,213.00	14,925.00	12,089.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	18.90	22.26	18.32	15.03	12.18
Equity Capital	994.00	994.00	994.00	993.00	992.00

Sr. No. 22	Indian Bank				
BSE Code: 532814		Price (₹): 909.35	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 527.37	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	65,875.00	62,039.00	55,650.00	44,985.00	38,888.00
Operating Profit	15,887.00	14,864.00	11,017.00	5,963.00	3,253.00
Interest	39,634.00	36,826.00	32,341.00	24,717.00	22,129.00
PAT	11,515.00	11,264.00	8,423.00	5,574.00	4,144.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	85.47	83.61	62.51	44.74	33.26
Equity Capital	1,347.00	1,347.00	1,347.00	1,245.00	1,245.00

Sr. No. 24	IDBI Bank Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500116		Price (₹): 98.80	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 54.18	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	28,199.00	28,917.00	26,446.00	20,592.00	18,316.00
Operating Profit	11,834.00	10,738.00	8,418.00	5,346.00	3,760.00
Interest	15,213.00	14,257.00	12,226.00	9,130.00	9,122.00
PAT	9,318.00	7,656.00	5,814.00	3,728.00	2,557.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	8.64	7.10	5.38	3.45	2.36
Equity Capital	10,752.00	10,752.00	10,752.00	10,752.00	10,752.00

Sr. No. 26	Waaree Energies Ltd.				
BSE Code: 544277	Price (₹): 2,739.50	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 425.75		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	22,060.00	14,444.00	11,398.00	6,751.00	2,854.00
Operating Profit	5,254.00	2,722.00	1,574.00	836.00	106.00
Interest	289.00	152.00	140.00	82.00	41.00
PAT	3,402.00	1,928.00	1,274.00	500.00	80.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	113.71	65.00	62.76	24.49	3.84
Equity Capital	288.00	287.00	263.00	243.00	197.00

Sr. No. 28	Lloyds Metals & Energy Ltd.				
BSE Code: 512455		Price (₹): 1,205.60	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 186.70	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
(₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	12,286.00	6,721.00	6,525.00	3,353.00	692.00
Operating Profit	3,856.00	1,953.00	1,732.00	814.00	146.00
Interest	356.00	27.00	6.00	65.00	18.00
PAT	2,500.00	1,450.00	1,243.00	-289.00	97.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	46.23	27.71	24.60	-5.72	2.64
Equity Capital	53.00	52.00	51.00	50.00	37.00

Sr. No. 30	Bharat Electronics Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500049	Price (₹): 453.75	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value:	31.30	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	26,535.00	23,769.00	20,268.00	17,734.00	15,368.00
Operating Profit	7,884.00	6,837.00	5,051.00	4,090.00	3,344.00
Interest	11.00	13.00	12.00	19.00	9.00
PAT	5,963.00	5,323.00	3,985.00	2,986.00	2,400.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	8.16	7.28	5.45	4.08	3.28
Equity Capital	731.00	731.00	731.00	731.00	244.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

Sr. No. 31 Solar Industries India Ltd.

BSE Code: 532725 Price (₹): 14,524.30 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 423.56

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	8,952.00	7,540.00	6,070.00	6,918.00	3,948.00
Operating Profit	2,332.00	2,026.00	1,482.00	1,336.00	748.00
Interest	121.00	116.00	109.00	90.00	50.00
PAT	1,527.00	1,288.00	875.00	811.00	455.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	160.47	133.65	92.38	83.68	48.77
Equity Capital	18.00	18.00	18.00	18.00	18.00

Sr. No. 33 Maruti Suzuki India Ltd.

BSE Code: 532500 Price (₹): 13,016.10 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 3,219.02

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	171,774.00	152,913.00	141,858.00	117,571.00	88,330.00
Operating Profit	20,126.00	20,224.00	18,626.00	11,029.00	5,752.00
Interest	213.00	194.00	194.00	187.00	127.00
PAT	14,932.00	14,500.00	13,488.00	8,211.00	3,880.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	474.92	461.20	429.01	271.82	128.43
Equity Capital	157.00	157.00	157.00	151.00	151.00

Sr. No. 35 Bharti Hexacom Ltd.

BSE Code: 544162 Price (₹): 1,518.15 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 134.37

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	9,229.00	8,548.00	7,089.00	6,579.00	5,405.00
Operating Profit	4,791.00	4,197.00	3,361.00	2,786.00	1,814.00
Interest	623.00	688.00	644.00	639.00	572.00
PAT	1,755.00	1,494.00	504.00	549.00	1,675.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	35.09	29.87	10.09	21.97	66.98
Equity Capital	250.00	250.00	250.00	250.00	250.00

Sr. No. 37 Adani Energy Solutions Ltd.

BSE Code: 539254 Price (₹): 1,003.40 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 167.85

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	26,519.00	23,767.00	16,607.00	13,293.00	11,258.00
Operating Profit	7,801.00	7,067.00	5,711.00	4,518.00	4,206.00
Interest	3,505.00	3,259.00	2,767.00	2,781.00	2,365.00
PAT	2,384.00	922.00	1,196.00	1,281.00	1,236.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	18.70	8.82	10.20	11.26	10.95
Equity Capital	1,201.00	1,201.00	1,115.00	1,115.00	1,100.00

Sr. No. 39 HDFC Asset Management Company Ltd.

BSE Code: 541729 Price (₹): 2,428.05 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 201.27

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	3,969.00	4,050.00	3,159.00	2,478.00	2,429.00
Operating Profit	3,182.00	3,346.00	2,536.00	1,929.00	1,913.00
Interest	12.00	9.00	9.00	10.00	9.00
PAT	2,875.00	2,461.00	1,946.00	1,424.00	1,393.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	67.18	57.55	45.57	33.36	32.66
Equity Capital	107.00	107.00	107.00	107.00	106.00

Sr. No. 32 Ashok Leyland Ltd.

BSE Code: 500477 Price (₹): 178.25 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 20.98

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	53,811.00	48,535.00	45,703.00	41,673.00	26,237.00
Operating Profit	10,428.00	9,208.00	7,856.00	5,093.00	2,765.00
Interest	4,517.00	3,930.00	2,982.00	2,094.00	1,869.00
PAT	3,586.00	3,383.00	2,696.00	1,359.00	-285.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	5.63	5.29	4.23	2.11	-0.61
Equity Capital	587.00	294.00	294.00	294.00	294.00

Sr. No. 34 The Phoenix Mills Ltd.

BSE Code: 503100 Price (₹): 1,559.70 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 152.32

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	4,206.00	3,807.00	3,972.00	2,616.00	1,460.00
Operating Profit	2,447.00	2,162.00	2,182.00	1,519.00	735.00
Interest	384.00	403.00	396.00	341.00	295.00
PAT	1,419.00	1,307.00	1,333.00	1,478.00	268.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	30.46	27.53	30.76	37.37	6.65
Equity Capital	72.00	72.00	36.00	36.00	36.00

Sr. No. 36 Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd.

BSE Code: 500520 Price (₹): 3,032.80 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 566.48

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	186,334.00	159,211.00	139,078.00	121,269.00	90,171.00
Operating Profit	35,239.00	30,518.00	24,892.00	20,285.00	14,683.00
Interest	9,580.00	9,083.00	7,488.00	5,830.00	5,018.00
PAT	16,904.00	14,073.00	12,270.00	11,374.00	7,253.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	126.47	103.97	90.62	82.68	52.91
Equity Capital	558.00	558.00	557.00	557.00	556.00

Sr. No. 38 IDFC First Bank Ltd.

BSE Code: 539437 Price (₹): 64.80 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 54.43

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	39,409.00	36,502.00	30,325.00	22,728.00	17,173.00
Operating Profit	1,950.00	1,864.00	3,857.00	3,331.00	175.00
Interest	18,963.00	17,208.00	13,870.00	10,091.00	7,465.00
PAT	1,576.00	1,490.00	2,942.00	2,485.00	132.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	2.05	2.04	4.16	3.75	0.21
Equity Capital	8,589.00	7,322.00	7,070.00	6,618.00	6,218.00

Sr. No. 40 Bank Of Maharashtra

BSE Code: 532525 Price (₹): 67.16 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 40.84

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	28,257.00	24,948.00	20,495.00	15,899.00	13,019.00
Operating Profit	7,066.00	5,542.00	4,072.00	3,448.00	1,153.00
Interest	15,178.00	13,281.00	10,672.00	8,157.00	6,974.00
PAT	6,474.00	5,542.00	4,072.00	2,605.00	1,153.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	8.42	7.21	5.75	3.87	1.71
Equity Capital	7,692.00	7,692.00	7,081.00	6,730.00	6,730.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

[Thriving Companies]

Sr. No. 41	The Federal Bank Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500469		Price (₹): 270.20	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 146.50	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
				(₹ Cr)	
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	28,835.00	28,106.00	23,565.00	17,812.00	14,382.00
Operating Profit	5,583.00	5,588.00	5,261.00	4,263.00	2,646.00
Interest	17,826.00	17,631.00	14,495.00	9,975.00	7,959.00
PAT	4,219.00	4,234.00	3,964.00	3,210.00	1,996.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	16.65	16.93	15.93	14.95	9.37
Equity Capital	492.00	491.00	487.00	423.00	421.00

Sr. No. 43	AU Small Finance Bank Ltd.				
BSE Code: 540611		Price (₹): 902.45	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 251.51	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	17,888.00	16,064.00	10,555.00	8,205.00	5,922.00
Operating Profit	41.00	520.00	528.00	1,016.00	601.00
Interest	9,264.00	8,052.00	5,398.00	3,780.00	2,688.00
PAT	2,313.00	2,106.00	1,535.00	1,428.00	1,130.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	31.02	28.29	22.93	21.42	17.94
Equity Capital	745.00	669.00	667.00	315.00	312.00

Sr. No.	TVS Motor Company Ltd.				
45					
BSE Code: 532343		Price (₹): 3,421.05	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 224.41	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	52,559.00	44,089.00	38,779.00	31,974.00	24,355.00
Operating Profit	8,084.00	6,575.00	5,435.00	4,027.00	2,755.00
Interest	2,215.00	2,093.00	1,917.00	1,368.00	940.00
PAT	3,064.00	2,380.00	1,779.00	1,309.00	731.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	60.93	47.06	35.50	27.97	15.93
Equity Capital	48.00	48.00	48.00	48.00	48.00

Sr. No. 47	NTPC Green Energy Ltd.				
BSE Code: 544289		Price (₹): 97.61	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 22.31	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	2,568.00	2,210.00	1,963.00	170.00	0.00
Operating Profit	2,229.00	1,920.00	1,745.00	152.00	0.00
Interest	806.00	766.00	694.00	51.00	0.00
PAT	2,568.00	2,210.00	1,963.00	170.00	0.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	0.66	0.56	0.60	0.36	0.00
Equity Capital	8,426.00	5,720.00	4,720.00	0.00	0.00

Sr. No.	Cummins India Ltd.				
49					
BSE Code: 500480		Price (₹): 4,754.45	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 281.08	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	11,602.00	10,391.00	9,000.00	7,772.00	6,171.00
Operating Profit	2,478.00	2,080.00	1,770.00	1,248.00	883.00
Interest	15.00	16.00	27.00	16.00	12.00
PAT	2,242.00	2,000.00	1,721.00	1,228.00	934.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	80.87	72.15	62.07	44.31	33.68
Equity Capital	55.00	55.00	55.00	55.00	55.00

Sr. No. 42	Muthoot Finance Ltd.				
BSE Code: 533398		Price (₹): 3,245.70	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 859.40	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	27,542.00	20,214.00	15,062.00	11,898.00	12,186.00
Operating Profit	11,653.00	7,266.00	5,996.00	4,923.00	5,410.00
Interest	9,956.00	7,461.00	5,452.00	4,225.00	4,268.00
PAT	8,653.00	5,352.00	4,468.00	3,670.00	4,031.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	217.16	132.84	107.71	89.98	100.08
Equity Capital	401.00	401.00	401.00	401.00	401.00

Sr. No. 44	JSW Infrastructure Ltd.				
BSE Code: 543994		Price (₹): 258.95	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 24.86	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	5,122.00	4,476.00	3,763.00	3,195.00	2,273.00
Operating Profit	2,475.00	2,262.00	1,968.00	1,623.00	1,109.00
Interest	260.00	266.00	332.00	596.00	420.00
PAT	1,639.00	1,521.00	1,161.00	750.00	330.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	7.69	7.16	5.50	3.97	54.02
Equity Capital	416.00	415.00	410.00	360.00	60.00

Sr. No. 46	Power Finance Corporation Ltd.				
BSE Code: 532810		Price (₹): 416.00	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 309.95	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	115,789.00	107,106.00	91,508.00	77,807.00	76,262.00
Operating Profit	42,312.00	38,632.00	33,588.00	26,496.00	23,382.00
Interest	68,674.00	64,670.00	57,968.00	47,017.00	44,709.00
PAT	33,386.00	30,514.00	26,461.00	21,179.00	18,768.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	76.42	69.67	59.88	48.15	42.47
Equity Capital	3,300.00	3,300.00	3,300.00	2,640.00	2,640.00

Sr. No. 48	Eternal Ltd.				
BSE Code: 543320		Price (₹): 221.25	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 37.86	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	42,905.00	20,243.00	12,114.00	7,079.00	4,192.00
Operating Profit	794.00	648.00	43.00	-1,211.00	-1,851.00
Interest	316.00	154.00	72.00	49.00	12.00
PAT	231.00	527.00	351.00	-971.00	-1,222.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	0.25	0.55	0.40	-1.14	-1.54
Equity Capital	910.00	907.00	868.00	836.00	764.00

Sr. No. 50	Bajaj Holdings & Investment Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500490	Price (₹): 9,796.40	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 2,060.67		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	1,154.00	739.00	1,702.00	522.00	484.00
Operating Profit	987.00	559.00	1,562.00	380.00	367.00
Interest	1.00	1.00	2.00	7.00	3.00
PAT	8,963.00	6,626.00	7,365.00	4,946.00	4,126.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	789.55	585.90	652.98	435.83	364.41
Equity Capital	111.00	111.00	111.00	111.00	111.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

Sr. No. 51 Varun Beverages Ltd.					
BSE Code: 540180 Price (₹): 410.70 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 55.43					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	21,685.00	20,008.00	16,043.00	13,173.00	8,823.00
Operating Profit	5,070.00	4,818.00	3,717.00	2,863.00	1,694.00
Interest	196.00	483.00	292.00	204.00	207.00
PAT	3,062.00	2,634.00	2,102.00	1,550.00	746.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	8.98	7.67	6.33	4.61	2.14
Equity Capital	676.00	676.00	650.00	650.00	433.00

Sr. No. 52 Sun Pharmaceutical Industries Ltd.					
BSE Code: 524715 Price (₹): 1,825.00 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 102.19					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	56,809.00	52,578.00	48,497.00	43,886.00	38,654.00
Operating Profit	17,493.00	15,114.00	13,018.00	11,650.00	10,258.00
Interest	302.00	231.00	238.00	172.00	127.00
PAT	10,953.00	10,965.00	9,610.00	8,513.00	3,389.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	45.50	45.55	39.91	35.32	13.64
Equity Capital	240.00	240.00	240.00	240.00	240.00

Sr. No. 53 Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd.					
BSE Code: 543237 Price (₹): 2,447.90 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 221.15					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	12,330.00	11,432.00	9,467.00	7,827.00	5,733.00
Operating Profit	1,973.00	2,066.00	1,416.00	801.00	441.00
Interest	50.00	10.00	9.00	9.00	14.00
PAT	2,407.00	2,414.00	1,937.00	1,119.00	611.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	59.66	59.83	48.02	27.74	15.14
Equity Capital	202.00	202.00	202.00	202.00	202.00

Sr. No. 54 Adani Enterprises Ltd.					
BSE Code: 512599 Price (₹): 2,002.15 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 483.63					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	94,995.00	97,895.00	96,421.00	127,540.00	69,420.00
Operating Profit	13,968.00	14,252.00	11,377.00	8,818.00	3,714.00
Interest	6,169.00	5,978.00	4,555.00	3,969.00	2,526.00
PAT	14,132.00	8,005.00	3,335.00	2,422.00	788.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	103.69	55.02	25.37	19.30	6.30
Equity Capital	115.00	115.00	114.00	114.00	110.00

Sr. No. 55 Aditya Birla Capital Ltd.					
BSE Code: 540691 Price (₹): 320.30 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 105.52					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	44,264.00	40,632.00	33,958.00	30,163.00	22,232.00
Operating Profit	15,954.00	14,275.00	11,981.00	10,191.00	5,538.00
Interest	11,106.00	9,694.00	7,617.00	4,722.00	3,480.00
PAT	3,585.00	3,410.00	3,439.00	4,824.00	1,660.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	13.40	12.78	12.83	19.83	7.06
Equity Capital	2,613.00	2,607.00	2,600.00	2,418.00	2,416.00

Sr. No. 56 Torrent Power Ltd.					
BSE Code: 532779 Price (₹): 1,506.05 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 383.69					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	29,017.00	29,165.00	27,183.00	25,694.00	14,258.00
Operating Profit	5,523.00	5,322.00	4,596.00	4,789.00	3,615.00
Interest	919.00	1,045.00	943.00	818.00	628.00
PAT	3,215.00	3,059.00	1,896.00	2,165.00	459.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	62.67	59.31	38.14	44.06	9.45
Equity Capital	504.00	504.00	481.00	481.00	481.00

Sr. No. 57 Coal India Ltd.					
BSE Code: 533278 Price (₹): 470.15 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 40.28					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	138,778.00	143,369.00	144,762.00	138,252.00	109,715.00
Operating Profit	40,359.00	47,064.00	47,971.00	44,232.00	24,721.00
Interest	1,114.00	884.00	819.00	684.00	541.00
PAT	29,755.00	35,302.00	37,369.00	31,723.00	17,378.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	48.45	57.37	60.69	51.54	28.17
Equity Capital	6,163.00	6,163.00	6,163.00	6,163.00	6,163.00

Sr. No. 58 Samvardhana Motherson Intl. Ltd.					
BSE Code: 517334 Price (₹): 120.15 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 36.45					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	121,111.00	113,663.00	98,692.00	78,788.00	63,536.00
Operating Profit	10,755.00	10,552.00	9,322.00	6,251.00	4,476.00
Interest	1,578.00	1,882.00	1,811.00	781.00	543.00
PAT	3,639.00	4,146.00	3,020.00	1,670.00	1,182.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	3.23	3.60	2.67	1.47	0.86
Equity Capital	1,055.00	704.00	678.00	678.00	452.00

Sr. No. 59 Lupin Ltd.					
BSE Code: 500257 Price (₹): 2,356.85 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 611.37					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	26,150.00	22,708.00	20,011.00	16,642.00	16,405.00
Operating Profit	7,652.00	5,278.00	3,800.00	1,721.00	219.00
Interest	403.00	295.00	312.00	274.00	143.00
PAT	4,669.00	3,306.00	1,936.00	448.00	-1,528.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	101.70	71.88	42.01	9.45	-33.62
Equity Capital	91.00	91.00	91.00	91.00	91.00

Sr. No. 60 GE Vernova T&D India Ltd.					
BSE Code: 522275 Price (₹): 3,749.40 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 92.84					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	5,722.00	4,292.00	3,168.00	2,773.00	3,066.00
Operating Profit	1,491.00	831.00	332.00	121.00	-89.00
Interest	13.00	27.00	41.00	61.00	59.00
PAT	1,437.00	820.00	263.00	27.00	-69.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	41.71	23.76	7.07	-0.06	-1.94
Equity Capital	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

[Thriving Companies]

Sr. No.	Titan Company Ltd.				
61					
BSE Code: 500114		Price (₹): 4,126.95	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 217.41	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	75,580.00	60,456.00	51,084.00	40,575.00	28,799.00
Operating Profit	7,955.00	5,694.00	5,292.00	4,882.00	3,344.00
Interest	1,082.00	953.00	619.00	300.00	218.00
PAT	4,766.00	3,337.00	3,496.00	3,274.00	2,198.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	53.69	37.59	39.38	36.61	24.48
Equity Capital	89.00	89.00	89.00	89.00	89.00

Sr. No.	Larsen & Toubro Ltd.				
63					
BSE Code: 500510		Price (₹): 3,720.95	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 514.37	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	277,504.00	255,734.00	221,113.00	183,341.00	156,521.00
Operating Profit	35,603.00	34,335.00	28,758.00	27,166.00	24,314.00
Interest	9,775.00	9,925.00	9,512.00	9,445.00	9,235.00
PAT	18,977.00	17,673.00	15,547.00	12,531.00	10,419.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	118.18	109.35	95.00	74.50	61.70
Equity Capital	275.00	275.00	275.00	281.00	281.00

Sr. No.	Indian Overseas Bank				
65					
BSE Code: 532388		Price (₹): 33.90	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 17.08	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	31,046.00	28,144.00	24,066.00	19,407.00	16,736.00
Operating Profit	6,165.00	4,573.00	3,423.00	2,353.00	1,779.00
Interest	18,813.00	17,244.00	14,226.00	11,146.00	10,419.00
PAT	4,956.00	3,396.00	2,666.00	2,104.00	1,709.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	2.57	1.76	1.41	1.11	0.90
Equity Capital	19,257.00	19,257.00	18,902.00	18,902.00	18,902.00

Sr. No.	Max Healthcare Institute Ltd.				
67					
BSE Code: 543220		Price (₹): 1,020.30	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 89.23	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	8,140.00	7,028.00	5,406.00	4,563.00	3,931.00
Operating Profit	2,148.00	1,849.00	1,492.00	1,241.00	946.00
Interest	224.00	165.00	60.00	84.00	101.00
PAT	1,419.00	1,076.00	1,058.00	1,104.00	605.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	14.59	11.07	10.88	11.37	6.24
Equity Capital	972.00	972.00	972.00	971.00	970.00

Sr. No.	Dr. Reddy's Laboratories Ltd.				
69					
BSE Code: 500124		Price (₹): 1,318.75	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 378.64	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	34,682.00	32,644.00	28,011.00	24,670.00	21,545.00
Operating Profit	8,069.00	8,547.00	7,933.00	6,470.00	3,768.00
Interest	334.00	283.00	171.00	143.00	96.00
PAT	5,523.00	5,725.00	5,578.00	4,507.00	2,182.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	66.72	67.77	66.87	54.14	26.23
Equity Capital	84.00	83.00	83.00	83.00	83.00

Sr. No.	Yes Bank Ltd.				
62					
BSE Code: 532648		Price (₹): 19.31	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 15.98	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	30,169.00	30,919.00	27,606.00	22,702.00	19,019.00
Operating Profit	4,200.00	3,224.00	1,538.00	981.00	1,434.00
Interest	20,773.00	21,998.00	19,527.00	14,800.00	12,528.00
PAT	3,174.00	2,447.00	1,285.00	736.00	1,064.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	1.01	0.78	0.45	0.26	0.42
Equity Capital	6,274.00	6,271.00	5,754.00	5,751.00	5,011.00

Sr. No.	DLF Ltd.				
64					
BSE Code: 532868		Price (₹): 558.90	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 118.23	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	9,508.00	7,994.00	6,427.00	5,695.00	5,717.00
Operating Profit	2,016.00	2,109.00	2,124.00	1,726.00	1,743.00
Interest	287.00	397.00	356.00	392.00	625.00
PAT	4,428.00	4,367.00	2,724.00	2,034.00	1,500.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	17.89	17.64	11.02	8.22	6.06
Equity Capital	495.00	495.00	495.00	495.00	495.00

Sr. No.	Oberoi Realty Ltd.				
66					
BSE Code: 533273		Price (₹): 1,470.70	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 430.90	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	5,409.00	5,286.00	4,496.00	4,193.00	2,694.00
Operating Profit	3,016.00	3,103.00	2,430.00	2,112.00	1,182.00
Interest	294.00	265.00	218.00	169.00	86.00
PAT	2,237.00	2,226.00	1,927.00	1,905.00	1,047.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	61.53	61.21	52.99	52.38	28.80
Equity Capital	364.00	364.00	364.00	364.00	364.00

Sr. No.	Polycab India Ltd.				
68					
BSE Code: 542652		Price (₹): 7,446.65	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 738.24	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	27,005.00	22,408.00	18,039.00	14,108.00	12,204.00
Operating Profit	3,870.00	2,964.00	2,492.00	1,843.00	1,264.00
Interest	201.00	169.00	108.00	60.00	35.00
PAT	2,657.00	2,046.00	1,803.00	1,283.00	917.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	174.49	134.28	118.75	84.85	60.80
Equity Capital	151.00	150.00	150.00	150.00	149.00

Sr. No.	NTPC Ltd.				
70					
BSE Code: 532555	Price (₹): 390.60	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value:	177.77	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	187,531.00	188,138.00	178,525.00	176,207.00	132,669.00
Operating Profit	54,719.00	54,392.00	51,499.00	47,596.00	40,362.00
Interest	13,712.00	13,282.00	12,301.00	11,447.00	9,376.00
PAT	24,828.00	23,953.00	21,332.00	17,121.00	16,960.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	24.94	24.16	21.46	17.44	17.20
Equity Capital	9,697.00	9,697.00	9,697.00	9,697.00	9,697.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

Sr. No. 71 REC Ltd.

BSE Code: 532955 Price (₹): 343.45 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 329.57

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	60,260.00	56,369.00	47,517.00	39,486.00	39,276.00
Operating Profit	21,842.00	20,117.00	17,960.00	13,898.00	12,431.00
Interest	36,076.00	34,131.00	29,948.00	23,733.00	22,051.00
PAT	17,243.00	15,884.00	14,145.00	11,167.00	10,036.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	65.49	60.32	53.72	42.41	38.11
Equity Capital	2,633.00	2,633.00	2,633.00	2,633.00	1,975.00

Sr. No. 73 Lodha Developers Ltd.

BSE Code: 543287 Price (₹): 869.25 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 209.47

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	16,187.00	13,780.00	10,316.00	9,470.00	9,233.00
Operating Profit	4,728.00	3,987.00	2,665.00	2,064.00	2,186.00
Interest	641.00	550.00	482.00	482.00	688.00
PAT	3,345.00	2,767.00	1,554.00	490.00	1,208.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	33.48	27.71	15.58	5.05	12.49
Equity Capital	998.00	998.00	994.00	482.00	482.00

Sr. No. 75 Sundaram Finance Ltd.

BSE Code: 590071 Price (₹): 5,351.15 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 1,197.78

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	9,508.00	8,513.00	7,274.00	5,501.00	5,111.00
Operating Profit	2,672.00	2,447.00	1,961.00	1,711.00	1,417.00
Interest	4,652.00	4,226.00	3,418.00	2,410.00	2,236.00
PAT	2,058.00	1,879.00	1,842.00	1,510.00	1,296.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	185.21	169.17	129.25	119.51	105.61
Equity Capital	110.00	110.00	110.00	110.00	110.00

Sr. No. 77 Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd.

BSE Code: 500570 Price (₹): 324.45 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 66.07

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	349,637.00	439,695.00	434,016.00	345,967.00	278,454.00
Operating Profit	24,455.00	56,138.00	57,809.00	31,816.00	24,720.00
Interest	3,136.00	5,083.00	7,594.00	10,225.00	9,312.00
PAT	85,324.00	28,149.00	31,807.00	2,690.00	-11,309.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	231.05	75.60	94.47	7.27	-34.45
Equity Capital	737.00	736.00	767.00	766.00	766.00

Sr. No. 79 Life Insurance Corporation of India

BSE Code: 543526 Price (₹): 796.50 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 241.63

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	945,284.00	889,970.00	845,966.00	784,628.00	723,606.00
Operating Profit	53,846.00	53,278.00	32,651.00	34,130.00	3,326.00
Interest	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
PAT	52,998.00	48,320.00	40,916.00	35,997.00	4,125.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	83.83	76.40	64.69	56.91	6.52
Equity Capital	6,325.00	6,325.00	6,325.00	6,325.00	6,325.00

Sr. No. 72 Torrent Pharmaceuticals Ltd.

BSE Code: 500420 Price (₹): 4,444.75 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 266.87

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	12,742.00	11,516.00	10,728.00	9,620.00	8,508.00
Operating Profit	4,167.00	3,721.00	3,368.00	2,842.00	2,431.00
Interest	205.00	252.00	354.00	333.00	255.00
PAT	2,272.00	1,911.00	1,656.00	1,245.00	777.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	67.12	56.47	48.94	36.79	22.97
Equity Capital	169.00	169.00	169.00	169.00	85.00

Sr. No. 74 Avenue Supermarts Ltd.

BSE Code: 540376 Price (₹): 3,950.45 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 380.09

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	66,009.00	59,358.00	50,789.00	42,840.00	30,976.00
Operating Profit	4,931.00	4,495.00	4,106.00	3,639.00	2,502.00
Interest	120.00	69.00	58.00	67.00	54.00
PAT	2,864.00	2,707.00	2,536.00	2,378.00	1,492.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	44.03	41.61	38.97	36.69	23.04
Equity Capital	651.00	651.00	651.00	648.00	648.00

Sr. No. 76 L&T Finance Ltd.

BSE Code: 533519 Price (₹): 265.45 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 107.05

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	17,197.00	15,924.00	14,252.00	12,775.00	11,930.00
Operating Profit	3,730.00	3,491.00	3,029.00	1,709.00	1,423.00
Interest	6,573.00	6,007.00	5,387.00	5,812.00	5,765.00
PAT	2,810.00	2,643.00	2,317.00	1,536.00	1,049.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	11.25	10.60	9.32	6.55	4.33
Equity Capital	2,500.00	2,495.00	2,489.00	2,480.00	2,474.00

Sr. No. 78 Bajaj Auto Ltd.

BSE Code: 532977 Price (₹): 9,165.15 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 1,189.66

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	57,719.00	50,995.00	44,870.00	36,455.00	33,145.00
Operating Profit	11,709.00	9,555.00	8,765.00	6,465.00	5,259.00
Interest	971.00	389.00	60.00	40.00	9.00
PAT	8,884.00	7,325.00	7,708.00	6,060.00	6,166.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	318.04	262.29	276.10	214.17	213.08
Equity Capital	279.00	279.00	279.00	283.00	289.00

Sr. No. 80 Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd.

BSE Code: 541154 Price (₹): 4,011.50 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 580.38

Last Five Years' Financial Data

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	32,846.00	30,981.00	30,381.00	26,927.00	24,620.00
Operating Profit	10,006.00	9,621.00	9,752.00	6,686.00	5,415.00
Interest	10.00	22.00	43.00	64.00	65.00
PAT	8,896.00	8,364.00	7,621.00	5,828.00	5,080.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	133.02	125.07	113.96	87.14	75.96
Equity Capital	334.00	334.00	334.00	334.00	334.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

[Thriving Companies]

Sr. No. 81 ITC Ltd.					
BSE Code: 500875 Price (₹): 303.90 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 58.80					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	79,809.00	75,323.00	67,932.00	70,919.00	60,645.00
Operating Profit	26,913.00	25,839.00	25,188.00	25,704.00	20,623.00
Interest	67.00	45.00	39.00	78.00	60.00
PAT	35,356.00	35,052.00	20,751.00	19,477.00	15,503.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	27.98	27.77	16.39	15.44	12.37
Equity Capital	1,253.00	1,251.00	1,248.00	1,243.00	1,232.00

Sr. No. 83 Tata Consultancy Services Ltd.					
BSE Code: 532540 Price (₹): 2,442.85 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 261.01					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	260,802.00	255,324.00	240,893.00	225,458.00	191,754.00
Operating Profit	70,102.00	67,407.00	64,296.00	59,259.00	53,057.00
Interest	1,189.00	796.00	778.00	779.00	784.00
PAT	47,963.00	48,797.00	46,099.00	42,303.00	38,449.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	131.88	134.20	126.88	115.19	104.75
Equity Capital	362.00	362.00	362.00	366.00	366.00

Sr. No. 85 ABB India Ltd.					
BSE Code: 500002 Price (₹): 6,412.50 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 333.89					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	13,203.00	13,203.00	12,188.00	10,447.00	8,568.00
Operating Profit	2,042.00	2,043.00	2,311.00	1,497.00	968.00
Interest	18.00	20.00	16.00	13.00	15.00
PAT	1,669.00	1,668.00	1,872.00	1,242.00	1,016.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	79.30	78.73	88.31	58.61	47.96
Equity Capital	42.00	42.00	42.00	42.00	42.00

Sr. No. 87 Mahindra & Mahindra Financial Serv. Ltd.					
BSE Code: 532720 Price (₹): 346.30 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 171.41					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	20,352.00	18,519.00	15,963.00	12,828.00	11,419.00
Operating Profit	3,176.00	3,027.00	2,588.00	2,804.00	1,549.00
Interest	8,931.00	8,415.00	6,959.00	5,094.00	4,417.00
PAT	2,377.00	2,261.00	1,943.00	2,071.00	1,150.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	17.08	16.27	13.90	14.91	8.18
Equity Capital	278.00	247.00	247.00	247.00	247.00

Sr. No. 89 Infosys Ltd.					
BSE Code: 500209 Price (₹): 1,265.85 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 202.01					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	173,173.00	162,990.00	153,670.00	146,767.00	121,641.00
Operating Profit	40,986.00	39,236.00	36,425.00	35,130.00	31,491.00
Interest	413.00	416.00	470.00	284.00	200.00
PAT	28,003.00	26,750.00	26,248.00	24,108.00	22,146.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	67.73	64.32	63.20	58.08	52.56
Equity Capital	2,074.00	2,073.00	2,071.00	2,069.00	2,098.00

Sr. No. 82 Persistent Systems Ltd.					
BSE Code: 533179 Price (₹): 4,718.45 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 444.38					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	13,935.00	11,939.00	9,822.00	8,351.00	5,711.00
Operating Profit	2,612.00	2,058.00	1,676.00	1,519.00	958.00
Interest	72.00	67.00	47.00	47.00	12.00
PAT	1,732.00	1,400.00	1,093.00	921.00	690.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	110.77	90.54	70.98	60.24	45.15
Equity Capital	78.00	78.00	77.00	76.00	76.00

Sr. No. 84 Indian Railway Finance Corporation Ltd.					
BSE Code: 543257 Price (₹): 99.90 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 43.33					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	26,672.00	27,153.00	26,650.00	23,892.00	20,299.00
Operating Profit	6,951.00	6,504.00	6,415.00	6,310.00	6,102.00
Interest	19,477.00	20,495.00	20,101.00	17,447.00	14,075.00
PAT	7,007.00	6,502.00	6,412.00	6,337.00	6,090.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	5.37	4.98	4.91	4.85	4.66
Equity Capital	13,069.00	13,069.00	13,069.00	13,069.00	13,069.00

Sr. No. 86 Power Grid Corporation Of India Ltd.					
BSE Code: 532898 Price (₹): 303.70 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 110.10					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	47,343.00	45,792.00	45,843.00	45,603.00	41,622.00
Operating Profit	38,958.00	38,837.00	39,244.00	39,576.00	35,826.00
Interest	8,576.00	8,700.00	8,773.00	9,634.00	8,036.00
PAT	15,524.00	15,521.00	15,573.00	15,420.00	16,824.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	16.68	16.69	16.74	16.58	18.09
Equity Capital	9,301.00	9,301.00	9,301.00	6,975.00	6,975.00

Sr. No. 88 Nippon Life India Asset Management Ltd.					
BSE Code: 540767 Price (₹): 850.85 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 71.50					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	2,537.00	2,518.00	2,036.00	1,512.00	1,533.00
Operating Profit	1,653.00	1,729.00	1,386.00	957.00	1,017.00
Interest	7.00	7.00	6.00	4.00	4.00
PAT	1,443.00	1,286.00	1,107.00	723.00	744.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	22.68	20.27	17.58	11.61	11.96
Equity Capital	637.00	635.00	630.00	623.00	622.00

Sr. No. 90 HCL Technologies Ltd.					
BSE Code: 532281 Price (₹): 1,358.45 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 125.87					
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	126,409.00	117,055.00	109,913.00	101,456.00	85,651.00
Operating Profit	26,474.00	25,504.00	24,198.00	22,628.00	20,529.00
Interest	785.00	644.00	553.00	353.00	319.00
PAT	16,471.00	17,399.00	15,710.00	14,845.00	13,523.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	60.66	64.08	57.86	54.73	49.74
Equity Capital	543.00	543.00	543.00	543.00	543.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

Sr. No. 91 Suzlon Energy Ltd.

BSE Code: 532667 Price (₹): 42.46 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 5.53

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	15,029.00	10,890.00	6,529.00	5,971.00	6,582.00
Operating Profit	2,752.00	1,863.00	1,037.00	833.00	900.00
Interest	412.00	255.00	164.00	421.00	735.00
PAT	3,230.00	2,072.00	660.00	2,887.00	-177.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	2.38	1.53	0.49	2.28	-0.17
Equity Capital	2,744.00	2,732.00	2,722.00	2,454.00	1,843.00

Sr. No. 92 Nestle India Ltd.

BSE Code: 500790 Price (₹): 1,219.85 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 28.95

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	21,911.00	20,202.00	24,394.00	19,126.00	16,897.00
Operating Profit	4,928.00	4,771.00	5,843.00	4,471.00	3,706.00
Interest	159.00	136.00	145.00	119.00	155.00
PAT	3,262.00	3,208.00	3,933.00	2,999.00	2,391.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	16.91	16.63	20.40	15.55	12.40
Equity Capital	96.00	96.00	96.00	96.00	96.00

Sr. No. 93 Dixon Technologies (India) Ltd.

BSE Code: 540699 Price (₹): 10,804.50 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 498.06

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	48,655.00	38,860.00	17,691.00	12,192.00	10,697.00
Operating Profit	1,901.00	1,515.00	705.00	519.00	384.00
Interest	160.00	162.00	81.00	64.00	49.00
PAT	1,811.00	1,233.00	375.00	255.00	190.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	261.80	181.87	61.47	42.90	32.05
Equity Capital	12.00	12.00	12.00	12.00	12.00

Sr. No. 94 Tata Power Company Ltd.

BSE Code: 500400 Price (₹): 402.30 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 58.51

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	64,624.00	65,478.00	61,449.00	55,109.00	42,816.00
Operating Profit	12,978.00	12,166.00	10,735.00	7,728.00	7,031.00
Interest	5,175.00	4,702.00	4,633.00	4,372.00	3,859.00
PAT	5,008.00	4,775.00	4,280.00	3,810.00	2,156.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	11.88	12.43	11.57	10.44	5.45
Equity Capital	320.00	320.00	320.00	320.00	320.00

Sr. No. 95 Pidilite Industries Ltd.

BSE Code: 500331 Price (₹): 1,386.05 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 98.68

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	14,159.00	13,140.00	12,383.00	11,799.00	9,921.00
Operating Profit	3,317.00	3,011.00	2,708.00	1,986.00	1,856.00
Interest	55.00	50.00	51.00	48.00	42.00
PAT	2,314.00	2,096.00	1,747.00	1,289.00	1,207.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	22.52	20.41	17.00	12.52	11.88
Equity Capital	102.00	51.00	51.00	51.00	51.00

Sr. No. 96 HDB Financial Services Ltd.

BSE Code: 544429 Price (₹): 650.10 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 240.67

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	16,300.00	14,173.00	12,403.00	8,725.00	7,027.00
Operating Profit	2,928.00	3,305.00	2,627.00	1,724.00	1,436.00
Interest	6,433.00	4,907.00	3,512.00	3,333.00	2,449.00
PAT	2,176.00	2,461.00	1,959.00	1,153.00	933.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	27.34	31.03	24.76	14.68	11.92
Equity Capital	796.00	793.00	791.00	786.00	783.00

Sr. No. 97 PB Fintech Ltd.

BSE Code: 543390 Price (₹): 1,462.40 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 155.07

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	6,241.00	4,977.00	3,438.00	2,558.00	1,425.00
Operating Profit	404.00	94.00	-188.00	-662.00	-901.00
Interest	36.00	34.00	27.00	22.00	14.00
PAT	580.00	353.00	64.00	-488.00	-833.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	12.59	7.69	1.48	-10.82	-18.53
Equity Capital	92.00	92.00	90.00	90.00	90.00

Sr. No. 98 Hyundai Motor India Ltd.

BSE Code: 544274 Price (₹): 1,991.95 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 223.82

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	69,787.00	69,193.00	69,829.00	60,308.00	47,378.00
Operating Profit	9,165.00	8,915.00	9,079.00	7,554.00	5,491.00
Interest	105.00	127.00	158.00	142.00	132.00
PAT	5,790.00	5,640.00	6,060.00	4,709.00	2,902.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	71.26	69.41	0.00	0.00	0.00
Equity Capital	813.00	813.00	813.00	813.00	813.00

Sr. No. 99 Hindustan Zinc Ltd.

BSE Code: 500188 Price (₹): 582.95 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 41.40

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	36,387.00	34,083.00	28,932.00	34,098.00	29,440.00
Operating Profit	19,178.00	17,431.00	13,676.00	17,515.00	16,225.00
Interest	945.00	1,095.00	955.00	333.00	290.00
PAT	11,802.00	10,353.00	7,759.00	10,511.00	9,629.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	27.94	24.50	18.36	24.88	22.79
Equity Capital	845.00	845.00	845.00	845.00	845.00

Sr. No. 100 UNO Minda Ltd.

BSE Code: 532539 Price (₹): 1,067.70 Face Value (₹): 2.00 Book Value: 97.04

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	18,850.00	16,775.00	14,031.00	11,236.00	8,313.00
Operating Profit	2,175.00	1,874.00	1,585.00	1,242.00	885.00
Interest	183.00	170.00	113.00	70.00	62.00
PAT	1,222.00	1,021.00	925.00	700.00	413.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	19.76	16.42	15.25	11.41	6.23
Equity Capital	115.00	115.00	115.00	115.00	57.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

[Thriving Companies]

Sr. No. 101	Reliance Industries Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500325		Price (₹): 1,391.85	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 419.65	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	1,024,548.00	962,820.00	899,041.00	876,396.00	694,673.00
Operating Profit	178,640.00	165,598.00	162,498.00	142,318.00	108,581.00
Interest	26,631.00	24,269.00	23,118.00	19,571.00	14,584.00
PAT	97,776.00	81,309.00	79,020.00	74,088.00	67,845.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	61.49	51.47	51.45	49.29	44.87
Equity Capital	13,532.00	13,532.00	6,766.00	6,766.00	6,765.00

Sr. No. 103	Hindustan Unilever Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500696		Price (₹): 2,135.45	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 219.36	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	64,544.00	63,121.00	61,896.00	60,580.00	52,446.00
Operating Profit	14,898.00	14,843.00	14,659.00	14,147.00	12,857.00
Interest	419.00	395.00	334.00	114.00	106.00
PAT	14,540.00	10,671.00	10,282.00	10,143.00	8,892.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	61.77	45.32	43.74	43.07	37.79
Equity Capital	235.00	235.00	235.00	235.00	235.00

Sr. No. 105	Cipla Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500087		Price (₹): 1,325.25	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 419.19	
Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	28,351.00	27,548.00	25,774.00	22,753.00	21,763.00
Operating Profit	6,466.00	7,128.00	6,291.00	5,027.00	4,553.00
Interest	55.00	62.00	90.00	110.00	106.00
PAT	4,533.00	5,269.00	4,154.00	2,833.00	2,547.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	56.29	65.28	51.05	34.71	31.19
Equity Capital	162.00	162.00	161.00	161.00	161.00

Sr. No. 107	Ultratech Cement Ltd.				
BSE Code: 532538		Price (₹): 11,090.55	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 2,452.26	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	85,775.00	75,955.00	70,908.00	63,240.00	52,599.00
Operating Profit	16,013.00	12,797.00	12,979.00	10,620.00	11,514.00
Interest	1,860.00	1,651.00	968.00	823.00	945.00
PAT	7,663.00	6,040.00	7,004.00	5,073.00	7,334.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	260.11	204.94	242.65	175.41	254.42
Equity Capital	295.00	295.00	289.00	289.00	289.00

Sr. No. 109	CG Power and Industrial Solutions Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500093		Price (₹): 737.45	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 50.70	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	11,729.00	9,909.00	8,046.00	6,973.00	5,484.00
Operating Profit	1,466.00	1,319.00	1,142.00	1,005.00	647.00
Interest	11.00	21.00	17.00	28.00	82.00
PAT	1,109.00	973.00	1,428.00	963.00	913.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	7.17	6.37	9.34	6.30	6.33
Equity Capital	315.00	306.00	305.00	305.00	288.00

Sr. No. 102	Vishal Mega Mart Ltd.				
BSE Code: 544307		Price (₹): 106.10	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 14.61	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	12,340.00	10,716.00	8,912.00	7,586.00	5,589.00
Operating Profit	1,816.00	1,564.00	1,276.00	1,044.00	826.00
Interest	174.00	180.00	170.00	185.00	213.00
PAT	786.00	632.00	462.00	321.00	203.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	1.69	1.37	1.02	0.71	0.45
Equity Capital	4,671.00	4,597.00	4,509.00	4,507.00	4,503.00

Sr. No.	Indus Towers Ltd.				
104					
BSE Code: 534816		Price (₹): 441.60	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 143.72	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	32,119.00	30,123.00	28,601.00	28,382.00	27,717.00
Operating Profit	17,825.00	20,650.00	14,557.00	9,669.00	14,901.00
Interest	1,647.00	1,858.00	1,864.00	1,670.00	1,603.00
PAT	7,131.00	9,932.00	6,036.00	2,040.00	6,373.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	27.02	37.65	22.40	7.57	23.65
Equity Capital	2,638.00	2,638.00	2,695.00	2,695.00	2,695.00

Sr. No. 106	Mankind Pharma Ltd.				
BSE Code: 543904		Price (₹): 2,208.35	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 386.62	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	13,914.00	12,207.00	10,260.00	8,749.00	7,782.00
Operating Profit	3,371.00	3,026.00	2,517.00	1,902.00	1,991.00
Interest	688.00	432.00	34.00	46.00	60.00
PAT	1,803.00	2,011.00	1,942.00	1,310.00	1,453.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	43.11	48.26	47.75	32.00	35.78
Equity Capital	41.00	41.00	40.00	40.00	40.00

Sr. No. 108	Grasim Industries Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500300	Price (₹): 2,676.55	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 805.78		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	168,597.00	148,478.00	130,978.00	117,627.00	95,701.00
Operating Profit	34,114.00	28,262.00	27,195.00	21,589.00	20,431.00
Interest	14,536.00	12,500.00	9,277.00	6,044.00	4,776.00
PAT	9,471.00	7,756.00	9,926.00	11,078.00	11,206.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	66.19	54.46	85.42	100.33	110.96
Equity Capital	136.00	136.00	133.00	132.00	132.00

Sr. No.	Godrej Properties Ltd.				
110					
BSE Code: 533150		Price (₹): 1,614.65	Face Value (₹): 5.00	Book Value:	583.43
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
(₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	3,795.00	4,923.00	3,036.00	2,252.00	1,825.00
Operating Profit	-989.00	-74.00	-130.00	207.00	-56.00
Interest	131.00	174.00	152.00	174.00	167.00
PAT	1,574.00	1,389.00	747.00	621.00	351.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	52.53	46.48	26.08	20.55	12.68
Equity Capital	151.00	151.00	139.00	139.00	139.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

Sr. No. 111 Fortis Healthcare Ltd.

BSE Code: 532843 Price (₹): 860.25 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 121.91

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	8,770.00	7,783.00	6,893.00	6,298.00	5,718.00
Operating Profit	1,988.00	1,588.00	1,268.00	1,101.00	1,069.00
Interest	298.00	184.00	131.00	129.00	147.00
PAT	981.00	809.00	645.00	633.00	790.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	12.72	10.26	7.93	7.80	7.35
Equity Capital	755.00	755.00	755.00	755.00	755.00

Sr. No. 113 Biocon Ltd.

BSE Code: 532523 Price (₹): 392.70 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 166.61

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	16,827.00	15,262.00	14,756.00	11,174.00	8,184.00
Operating Profit	3,496.00	3,254.00	3,216.00	2,412.00	1,793.00
Interest	971.00	897.00	974.00	419.00	68.00
PAT	630.00	1,429.00	1,298.00	643.00	772.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	4.81	8.44	8.52	3.85	5.40
Equity Capital	668.00	600.00	600.00	600.00	600.00

Sr. No. 115 ICICI Lombard General Insurance Co. Ltd.

BSE Code: 540716 Price (₹): 1,856.55 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 325.86

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	26,221.00	23,961.00	20,572.00	17,876.00	16,026.00
Operating Profit	3,487.00	3,407.00	2,654.00	1,264.00	1,016.00
Interest	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
PAT	2,735.00	2,508.00	1,919.00	1,729.00	1,271.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	55.02	50.60	38.94	35.21	25.89
Equity Capital	497.00	496.00	493.00	491.00	455.00

Sr. No. 117 Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Ltd.

BSE Code: 508869 Price (₹): 7,574.30 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 674.51

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	24,215.00	21,794.00	19,059.00	16,612.00	14,663.00
Operating Profit	3,528.00	3,033.00	2,394.00	2,065.00	2,189.00
Interest	445.00	458.00	449.00	381.00	379.00
PAT	1,866.00	1,505.00	935.00	844.00	1,108.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	125.32	100.56	62.50	56.97	73.42
Equity Capital	72.00	72.00	72.00	72.00	72.00

Sr. No. 119 MRF Ltd.

BSE Code: 500290 Price (₹): 137,828.75 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 46,619.86

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	30,180.00	28,152.00	25,169.00	23,008.00	19,317.00
Operating Profit	4,675.00	4,095.00	4,272.00	2,404.00	2,061.00
Interest	378.00	368.00	361.00	326.00	263.00
PAT	2,230.00	1,869.00	2,081.00	769.00	669.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	5,258.19	4,407.54	4,907.26	1,813.09	1,577.96
Equity Capital	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00

Sr. No. 112 SBI Cards And Payment Services Ltd.

BSE Code: 543066 Price (₹): 710.20 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 161.27

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	19,639.00	18,074.00	16,986.00	13,670.00	10,679.00
Operating Profit	2,200.00	2,164.00	2,931.00	2,579.00	1,699.00
Interest	3,153.00	3,179.00	2,595.00	1,648.00	1,027.00
PAT	2,092.00	1,916.00	2,408.00	2,258.00	1,616.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	21.97	20.14	25.32	23.87	17.14
Equity Capital	952.00	951.00	946.00	943.00	941.00

Sr. No. 114 Zydus Lifesciences Ltd.

BSE Code: 532321 Price (₹): 916.55 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 218.02

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	26,089.00	23,242.00	19,547.00	17,237.00	15,265.00
Operating Profit	8,046.00	7,058.00	5,384.00	3,860.00	3,342.00
Interest	392.00	166.00	81.00	130.00	127.00
PAT	5,026.00	4,673.00	3,973.00	2,092.00	4,618.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	49.09	44.97	38.36	19.37	43.83
Equity Capital	101.00	101.00	101.00	101.00	102.00

Sr. No. 116 JSW Energy Ltd.

BSE Code: 533148 Price (₹): 518.40 Face Value (₹): 10.00 Book Value: 132.55

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	17,592.00	11,745.00	11,486.00	10,332.00	8,167.00
Operating Profit	9,019.00	5,221.00	5,382.00	3,282.00	3,572.00
Interest	4,883.00	2,269.00	2,053.00	844.00	777.00
PAT	2,603.00	1,983.00	1,725.00	1,480.00	1,743.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	13.01	11.16	10.47	8.99	10.51
Equity Capital	1,746.00	1,745.00	1,641.00	1,641.00	1,640.00

Sr. No. 118 National Aluminium Company Ltd.

BSE Code: 532234 Price (₹): 409.25 Face Value (₹): 5.00 Book Value: 118.13

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	18,098.00	16,788.00	13,149.00	14,257.00	14,181.00
Operating Profit	8,317.00	7,508.00	2,801.00	2,340.00	4,516.00
Interest	108.00	59.00	17.00	13.00	23.00
PAT	6,142.00	5,268.00	1,988.00	1,435.00	2,951.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	33.45	28.68	10.83	7.81	16.07
Equity Capital	918.00	918.00	918.00	918.00	918.00

Sr. No. 120 FSN E-Commerce Ventures Ltd.

BSE Code: 543384 Price (₹): 244.80 Face Value (₹): 1.00 Book Value: 6.06

Last Five Years' Financial Data (₹ Cr)

Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	9,436.00	7,950.00	6,386.00	5,144.00	3,774.00
Operating Profit	663.00	475.00	347.00	257.00	164.00
Interest	121.00	108.00	84.00	76.00	47.00
PAT	144.00	72.00	40.00	21.00	41.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	0.49	0.23	0.11	0.07	0.14
Equity Capital	286.00	286.00	286.00	285.00	47.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

[Thriving Companies]

Sr. No. 121	Coromandel International Ltd.				
BSE Code: 506395		Price (₹): 2,008.90	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 427.64	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	30,464.00	24,085.00	22,058.00	29,628.00	19,111.00
Operating Profit	3,138.00	2,577.00	2,380.00	2,902.00	2,156.00
Interest	319.00	262.00	187.00	190.00	75.00
PAT	2,362.00	2,055.00	1,641.00	2,013.00	1,528.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	81.26	70.14	55.78	68.46	52.08
Equity Capital	29.00	29.00	29.00	29.00	29.00

Sr. No. 123	Hero MotoCorp Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500182		Price (₹): 5,395.60	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 1,118.44	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
(₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	44,403.00	40,923.00	37,789.00	34,158.00	29,551.00
Operating Profit	6,371.00	5,789.00	5,235.00	4,099.00	3,256.00
Interest	76.00	71.00	76.00	105.00	53.00
PAT	5,471.00	4,376.00	3,742.00	2,800.00	2,329.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	272.09	218.91	187.31	140.61	115.95
Equity Capital	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00	40.00

Sr. No. 125	IndusInd Bank Ltd.				
BSE Code: 532187	Price (₹): 830.90	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 827.95		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	45,879.00	48,668.00	45,748.00	36,368.00	30,822.00
Operating Profit	-2,616.00	3,526.00	11,979.00	9,932.00	6,433.00
Interest	29,220.00	29,636.00	25,132.00	18,776.00	15,822.00
PAT	-2,034.00	2,576.00	8,977.00	7,444.00	4,805.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	-26.11	33.06	115.34	95.93	62.03
Equity Capital	779.00	779.00	778.00	776.00	775.00

Sr. No. 127	Bosch Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500530		Price (₹): 31,280.70	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 4,934.11	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
(₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	19,380.00	18,087.00	16,727.00	14,929.00	11,782.00
Operating Profit	2,516.00	2,310.00	2,095.00	1,810.00	1,457.00
Interest	19.00	17.00	51.00	12.00	29.00
PAT	2,757.00	2,015.00	2,491.00	1,426.00	1,218.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	934.68	683.27	844.69	483.33	413.07
Equity Capital	30.00	30.00	30.00	30.00	30.00

Sr. No. 129	Info Edge (India) Ltd.				
BSE Code: 532777		Price (₹): 955.50	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 697.94	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
(₹ Cr)					
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	3,165.00	2,850.00	2,536.00	2,346.00	1,589.00
Operating Profit	1,066.00	874.00	711.00	348.00	446.00
Interest	27.00	36.00	35.00	18.00	11.00
PAT	1,685.00	1,310.00	595.00	-70.00	12,882.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	20.79	14.85	8.89	-1.66	198.16
Equity Capital	129.00	129.00	129.00	129.00	129.00

Sr. No. 122	Hitachi Energy India Ltd.				
BSE Code: 543187		Price (₹): 24,877.05	Face Value (₹): 2.00	Book Value: 1,086.89	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	7,277.00	6,385.00	5,237.00	4,469.00	4,884.00
Operating Profit	1,037.00	605.00	359.00	250.00	323.00
Interest	15.00	54.00	57.00	54.00	53.00
PAT	841.00	384.00	164.00	94.00	203.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	188.74	86.15	38.64	22.16	47.99
Equity Capital	9.00	9.00	8.00	8.00	8.00

Sr. No. 124	Britannia Industries Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500825		Price (₹): 5,785.60	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 164.25	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	18,865.00	17,943.00	16,769.00	16,301.00	14,136.00
Operating Profit	3,481.00	3,176.00	3,167.00	2,831.00	2,201.00
Interest	125.00	139.00	164.00	169.00	144.00
PAT	2,416.00	2,178.00	2,134.00	2,316.00	1,516.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	100.27	90.45	88.84	96.39	63.31
Equity Capital	24.00	24.00	24.00	24.00	24.00

Sr. No. 126	Vedanta Ltd.				
BSE Code: 500295		Price (₹): 719.55	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 189.39	
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
					(₹ Cr)
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	120,395.00	152,968.00	143,727.00	147,308.00	132,732.00
Operating Profit	33,165.00	42,343.00	35,312.00	34,431.00	44,824.00
Interest	6,631.00	9,914.00	9,465.00	6,225.00	4,797.00
PAT	20,704.00	20,535.00	7,539.00	14,503.00	23,710.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	36.25	38.33	11.40	28.45	50.58
Equity Capital	391.00	391.00	372.00	372.00	372.00

Sr. No. 128	SBI Life Insurance Company Ltd.				
BSE Code: 540719	Price (₹): 1,941.10	Face Value (₹): 10.00	Book Value: 189.62		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	131,315.00	116,888.00	131,988.00	80,636.00	82,983.00
Operating Profit	1,346.00	2,776.00	2,104.00	1,923.00	730.00
Interest	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
PAT	2,479.00	2,413.00	1,894.00	1,721.00	1,506.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	24.73	24.08	18.91	17.19	15.05
Equity Capital	1,002.00	1,001.00	1,001.00	1,001.00	1,001.00

Sr. No. 130	LTIMindtree Ltd.				
BSE Code: 540005	Price (₹): 4,322.45	Face Value (₹): 1.00	Book Value: 788.99		
Last Five Years' Financial Data					
	(₹ Cr)				
Particulars	TTM	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Net Sales	40,788.00	38,008.00	35,517.00	33,183.00	26,109.00
Operating Profit	7,178.00	6,495.00	6,387.00	6,108.00	5,249.00
Interest	278.00	279.00	222.00	150.00	123.00
PAT	4,724.00	4,602.00	4,585.00	4,410.00	3,950.00
Adjusted EPS (₹)	160.42	155.21	154.72	149.02	225.27
Equity Capital	30.00	30.00	30.00	30.00	30.00

Book value is expressed in rupees (₹)

Share price data as of Mar 13, 2026

Metals and Mining Cycles, Challenges, and Opportunities Ahead

Amid rising tensions in the Middle East, global attention has largely been focused on crude oil prices and their impact on economies, businesses, and investments. Yet another critical sector now stands at an important crossroads: metals and mining. With metal prices witnessing sharp volatility in recent months, it becomes essential to examine the sector's financial performance, key growth drivers, and the challenges that could shape its future

Commodity markets rarely move in isolation. They reflect the pulse of the global economy, reacting quickly to geopolitical developments, trade disruptions, and shifts in industrial demand. In recent months, the metals and mining sector has once again come under the spotlight. Metal prices have been fluctuating sharply, influenced by weak global cues, supply disruptions, and geopolitical tensions such as the escalating conflict between Iran and Israel. These developments have reminded investors how sensitive commodity markets are to global instability.

For India, the timing of this volatility is crucial. The country is in the middle of an ambitious infrastructure expansion, with large investments planned in roads, railways, renewable energy, housing, and manufacturing. All these sectors depend heavily on metals such as steel, aluminium, copper, and zinc. At the same time, global trade patterns are evolving and supply chains are being reconfigured. As a result, the metals and mining sector stands at an interesting crossroads.

While external risks remain high, domestic demand and policy support are creating strong long-term opportunities. This combination of global uncertainty and domestic structural growth makes the sector particularly relevant for investors today. Let us examine how the sector has performed financially, the structural growth drivers shaping its trajectory, the risks it faces, and the outlook ahead as it seeks to capitalise on emerging opportunities.

The Backbone of the Economy

Few sectors reflect the pulse of an economy as closely as metals and mining. From highways and rail networks to automobiles, power systems, and housing, almost every major industry depends on metals in some form. Steel, aluminium, copper,

and a range of industrial minerals form the basic building blocks of modern infrastructure and manufacturing. In India, the sector has evolved into a critical pillar of economic development, supporting a wide ecosystem of downstream industries.

Mining activity fuels several sectors including cement, power generation, engineering goods, and automobiles. Beyond its industrial linkages, the sector also generates substantial employment and plays a key role in regional development, particularly in mineral rich states. India is endowed with significant reserves of iron ore, bauxite, limestone, and manganese, providing a strong natural foundation for a robust



metals industry. Over the past decade, capacity additions, technological upgrades, and modernisation have steadily strengthened the country's production ecosystem.

Within this landscape, steel occupies a central position. Often regarded as the backbone of industrial activity, steel demand closely mirrors the pace of economic expansion. India has already emerged as one of the world's leading steel producers, supported by strong domestic demand and expanding manufacturing capacity. The country's steelmaking capacity is projected to reach 300 million tonnes by 2030, growing at a compound annual rate of about 9-10 per cent, driven largely by infrastructure development and construction activity.

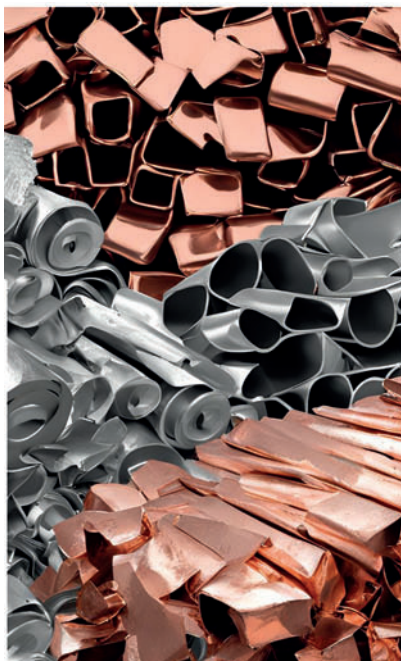
Alongside steel, aluminium is gaining strategic importance in the evolving industrial landscape. Lightweight, durable, and highly recyclable, the metal has become indispensable in sectors such as transportation, power transmission, packaging, and renewable energy. The global shift toward cleaner energy systems has further elevated aluminium's relevance, as electric vehicles, solar installations, and transmission networks require substantial aluminium components. With abundant bauxite reserves and a well-established refining base, India is well positioned to benefit from this rising demand, particularly as the country accelerates investments in renewable energy and modern power infrastructure.

Financial Pulse of the Sector

To assess the sector's financial performance more closely, we analysed the 13 constituents of the BSE Metals Index, which together command a combined market capitalisation of nearly ₹20 lakh crore. At an aggregate level, the sector delivered a healthy financial performance in Q3FY26. The sector reported

revenue growth of around 14 per cent year-on-year, with a majority of companies posting double digit expansion in their topline performance. Profitability trends were even stronger, with the combined net profit of the index constituents rising sharply by around 68 per cent during the quarter.

A significant portion of this surge was driven by an exceptional performance from Adani Enterprises, which reported a nearly 2,400 per cent jump in net profit, largely supported by substantial other income. However, even after excluding this outlier, the sector's aggregate profit



growth remains robust at roughly 40 per cent, highlighting the underlying strength in operating performance and the resilience of metal producers amid a volatile global environment. Among the trends visible during the quarter, steel companies clearly emerged as the strongest performers within the broader metals pack.

Several factors contributed to this outperformance. To begin with, the sector benefited from a favourable base effect, as the corresponding period last year was marked by softer steel prices and weaker export demand amid global economic uncertainties. With price realisations stabilising and domestic demand improving, the year-on-year comparison naturally appeared stronger. More importantly, the underlying demand environment in India has remained supportive. Continued government spending on infrastructure projects such as highways, railways, metro systems, and urban housing has kept domestic steel consumption firm.

Construction activity remains one of the largest consumers of steel, and the ongoing infrastructure build-out has ensured steady offtake for producers. This has helped maintain healthy capacity utilisation levels across major steel plants. Another factor that worked in favour of steel producers was relative stability in raw material costs during the quarter. Prices of certain inputs such as coking coal moderated compared to earlier peaks, offering some relief on the cost front. Companies that have integrated operations or access to captive iron ore mines were able to benefit even more from this environment, as their cost structures remained relatively stable.

Many leading steel companies have also spent the past few years improving operational efficiency and expanding their portfolio of value-added products. Higher sales of specialised and coated steel products tend to carry better margins compared to commodity grade steel. This shift toward a richer product mix helped support profitability despite fluctuations in global metal prices. In contrast, non-ferrous metal producers faced relatively mixed conditions as global demand for metals such as aluminium and zinc remained influenced by international price movements. As a result, the relatively stronger domestic demand environment allowed steel companies to outperform other segments of the metals sector during the quarter.

Government Reforms Driving Growth

The performance of India's metals and mining industry has been closely linked to policy reforms and government initiatives. Over the past few years, policymakers have taken several steps to improve transparency in mining operations, encourage exploration, and attract investment in mineral resources. One of the key priorities has been to streamline the process of mineral auctions and accelerate the operationalisation of mines. By introducing transparent bidding mechanisms and simplifying regulatory procedures, the government aims to increase domestic mineral production and reduce dependence on imports.

Special Feature

Policy initiatives have also focused on building strategic capabilities in critical minerals that are essential for emerging technologies. As the global economy shifts toward electric mobility and renewable energy, access to minerals such as lithium, cobalt, and rare earth elements is becoming increasingly important. In addition, targeted incentive programmes have been introduced to encourage domestic manufacturing of specialised metal products. These initiatives are designed to strengthen India's position in global value chains while promoting technological upgrades in the metals sector.

- **Capacity Expansion by Domestic Producers** — Major Indian metal companies are expanding production capacity and investing in modern technologies to improve efficiency, reduce costs, and meet rising domestic demand driven by infrastructure and manufacturing growth.
- **Export Opportunities** — With improving competitiveness and expanding production capacity, Indian metal producers are increasingly exploring global markets, creating opportunities to boost exports of steel, aluminium, and value-added metal products.
- **Critical Minerals Strategy** — India's focus on securing

Performance of the Constituents of the BSE Metals Index

Company Name	Latest Market Cap. (₹ Cr.)	Revenue (₹ Cr.)		Y-o-Y Growth (%)	Net Profit (₹ Cr.)		Y-o-Y Growth (%)
		Q3FY25	Q3FY26		Q3FY25	Q3FY26	
JSW Steel Ltd.	2,88,258	41,378	45,991	11.15	719	2,410	235.19
Vedanta Ltd.	2,81,763	17,063	23,369	36.96	4,876	7,807	60.11
Hindustan Zinc Ltd.	2,48,216	8,556	10,922	27.65	2,647	3,879	46.54
Tata Steel Ltd.	2,43,053	53,648	57,002	6.25	295	2,730	825.42
Adani Enterprises Ltd.	2,27,183	22,848	24,820	8.63	229	5,727	2,400.87
Hindalco Industries Ltd.	2,15,509	58,390	66,521	13.93	3,735	2,049	-45.14
Jindal Steel Ltd.	1,21,074	11,751	13,027	10.86	951	189	-80.13
National Aluminium Company Ltd.	73,015	4,662	4,731	1.48	1,566	1,595	1.85
NMDC Ltd.	70,036	6,568	7,611	15.88	1,880	1,757	-6.54
Lloyds Metals & Energy Ltd.	64,664	1,675	5,058	201.97	389	1,090	180.21
Steel Authority of India Ltd.	63,527	24,490	27,371	11.76	142	374	163.38
Jindal Stainless Ltd.	60,624	9,907	10,518	6.17	654	828	26.61
APL Apollo Tubes Ltd.	56,008	5,433	5,815	7.03	217	310	42.86

Growth Drivers Shaping the Next Phase

- **Infrastructure Growth** — India's large investments in highways, railways, metro networks, airports, and industrial corridors are driving strong demand for steel and other metals, making infrastructure development one of the sector's most powerful long-term growth engines.
- **Urbanisation and Housing Demand** — Rapid urbanisation and growing housing demand are boosting construction activity across residential and commercial projects, increasing consumption of construction metals such as steel, aluminium, and other essential building materials.
- **Manufacturing Push under 'Make in India'** — Government initiatives to strengthen domestic manufacturing are increasing metal demand from sectors such as automobiles, capital goods, defence equipment, and engineering, supporting long-term growth in steel and non-ferrous metal consumption.
- **Energy Transition and Renewable Power** — Expansion of renewable energy capacity is creating fresh demand for metals. Solar panels, wind turbines, and transmission infrastructure require large quantities of aluminium, copper, and specialised steel products.
- **Electric Vehicle Ecosystem** — The rapid growth of electric mobility is increasing demand for lightweight metals and battery-related minerals, particularly aluminium and copper, as automakers focus on improving energy efficiency and reducing vehicle weight.

critical minerals required for clean energy technologies, batteries, and electronics is encouraging exploration and investment, opening new growth avenues within the broader metals and mining ecosystem.

- **Technological Advancements in Mining** — Adoption of automation, digital monitoring, and advanced extraction technologies is improving productivity, enhancing safety, and reducing operational costs, helping mining companies operate more efficiently in an increasingly competitive environment.

Key Challenges Ahead

Geopolitics and Supply Chain Disruptions — Geopolitical developments have become an increasingly important variable in commodity markets. Conflicts in energy producing regions can disrupt supply routes, raise transportation costs, and create uncertainty across global supply chains. These disruptions do not always affect metal supply directly, but they often influence the cost structure of producers through higher energy prices and logistics expenses.

The recent escalation of tensions between Iran and Israel has brought these risks back into focus. The Middle East plays a crucial role in global energy markets and in the supply of certain raw materials used by various industries. Any prolonged instability in the region can affect shipping routes, freight costs, and access to critical inputs.

Potential Raw Material Bottlenecks — For India, one area of concern is the potential disruption in the supply chain of key raw materials sourced from the Middle East. Industries across the country depend on imports of minerals such as limestone and gypsum, both of which are widely used in construction materials and industrial processes. Any disruption in supply due to geopolitical tensions could tighten availability and push up input costs for domestic industries.

Although metals producers do not rely on these materials as directly as the cement sector, the broader industrial ecosystem is interconnected. Shipping routes through the region also represent a potential pressure point. Escalating tensions can raise insurance costs for cargo vessels and increase freight rates, thereby affecting the landed cost of imported raw materials. Higher logistics expenses can gradually filter through supply chains, impacting production costs across several industries.

Global Influences Shaping the Industry — Beyond geopolitical concerns, the metals and mining sector faces a range of structural challenges. Commodity price volatility remains one of the most significant risks. Commodity markets are inherently international, and price movements are largely shaped by global supply and demand dynamics. Developments in major economies often ripple through metal markets almost instantly, influencing pricing, trade flows, and profitability across the industry.

China continues to exert a powerful influence on global metal markets due to its dominant role in production and consumption. Any shift in Chinese construction activity, infrastructure spending, or industrial output can quickly alter global demand for steel and base metals. When China's construction sector slows, the effects are often visible in declining global prices and rising export pressures. Conversely, a recovery in Chinese industrial activity can tighten global supply and push prices higher.

Trade Flows and Pricing Pressures — International trade strategies also shape the competitive landscape. Producers in several countries often export surplus output to global markets, sometimes at aggressive prices, which can place pressure on domestic producers in other regions. This phenomenon has been visible in the steel sector on multiple occasions, where cheaper imports have affected pricing dynamics and margins. Energy costs form another critical component of metal production economics. Both steelmaking and aluminium smelting are energy intensive processes, making producers highly sensitive to fluctuations in fuel and electricity prices.

Changes in coal prices, natural gas markets, or power tariffs can significantly influence operating costs for metal producers. As a result, global energy price movements often translate directly into shifts in profitability for the sector. Currency fluctuations can also influence the cost of imported inputs. A weakening rupee tends to make raw material imports more expensive,

placing additional pressure on margins for companies that rely on overseas supplies.

Rising Sustainability Expectations — Environmental considerations represent another important dimension of risk. Mining and metal production activities can have substantial environmental impact, including land degradation, water usage, and greenhouse gas emissions. As sustainability standards become more stringent, companies are facing increasing pressure to adopt cleaner technologies and improve environmental compliance.

Regulators and investors alike are placing greater emphasis on environmental, social, and governance practices. This shift is encouraging companies to invest in greener production processes, improved waste management systems, and more responsible mining practices. While these initiatives are essential for long-term sustainability, they often require significant capital investment.

Conclusion

For investors, the metals and mining sector presents a compelling mix of opportunity and cyclicity. Commodity businesses have historically delivered strong returns during favourable price cycles, but they can also face periods of volatility when global demand weakens or supply expands. As a result, investing in this sector often requires patience, a long-term perspective, and careful selection of companies with resilient business models. Producers with integrated operations and access to captive raw material sources generally enjoy structural cost advantages and greater control over their supply chains.

These factors often translate into stronger margins and better earnings stability across commodity cycles. Companies that are steadily expanding their portfolio of value-added products may also be better positioned to cushion the impact of sharp fluctuations in global metal prices. India's long-term demand outlook remains a key supportive factor for the sector. The country's aggressive infrastructure expansion, rising urbanisation, growing manufacturing ecosystem, and the accelerating transition toward renewable energy are expected to sustain strong consumption of metals over the coming decade.

Steel, aluminium, copper, and other industrial metals will remain essential inputs for building transport networks, energy infrastructure, housing, and advanced manufacturing capacity. At the same time, investors must remain mindful of external variables such as global commodity price trends, energy costs, trade flows, and geopolitical developments. These factors can influence profitability in the short-term. Despite such uncertainties, the sector's structural importance to India's economic transformation remains undeniable.

As the country continues to strengthen its industrial base and infrastructure network, the metals and mining industry is likely to remain a critical enabler of long-term growth.



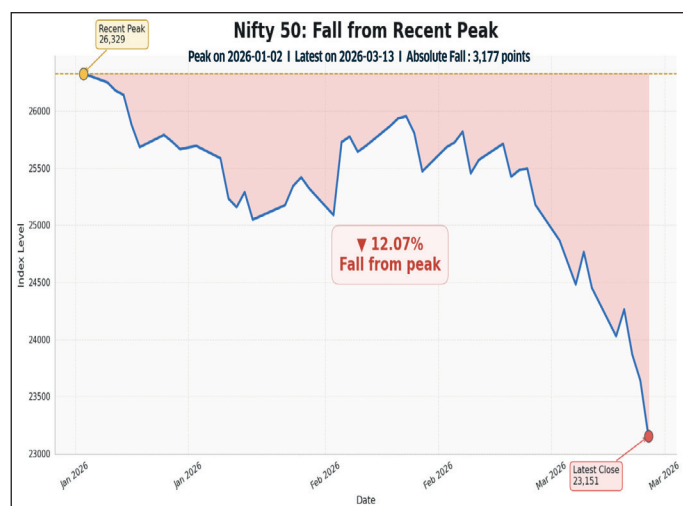


As war clouds darken global markets and energy prices surge, India's equity story faces a sharp test of conviction. Yet beneath the volatility lies a market that is correcting, not cracking. With valuations near historical comfort zones and structural growth drivers intact, this phase may be less a warning sign and more a rare long-term entry window

The Indian equity market in March 2026 stands at a peculiar crossroads, defined by a jarring disconnect between local economic vitality and global kinetic conflict. While the Sensex and Nifty 50 have navigated a turbulent few weeks, shedding 10 per cent from their mid-February peaks and are already in

correction phase and slipping below the psychological support of 24,000, the underlying structural story of the Indian economy remains not only intact but increasingly decoupled from the fragilities of the Western and Middle Eastern theatres. The immediate catalyst, a sharp escalation in the U.S.-Israel-Iran conflict, has resurrected the spectre of a global energy shock, driven by a surge in Brent crude towards the

\$120 per barrel mark and a doubling of liquefied natural gas (LNG) prices to nearly \$25 per MMBtu. Yet, for the way we see things, this 'fog of war' is a familiar backdrop. Historical analysis of geopolitical drawdowns, from the 1990 Gulf War to the 2022 Russia-Ukraine conflict, consistently demonstrates that markets panic on the rumour of war but find their floor the moment the scope of the conflict is defined. In the current environment, the 10-15 per cent correction in the Nifty 50 from its all-time highs is less a signal of economic decay and more an invitation for long-term capital to enter at valuations that finally account for risk.



The Geopolitical Crucible: Energy Shocks and the Hormuz Chokepoint

The immediate macroeconomic stressor is centred on the Strait of Hormuz, a critical artery through which 20 per cent of global petroleum liquids and 55-65 per cent of India's LNG imports flow. The deployment of naval mines in the strait has effectively halted commercial traffic, as insurers withdraw coverage for tankers entering the mine-risk zone. For India, which imports 85-89 per cent of its crude oil and 50 per cent of its natural gas, this is a direct hit to the 'Triple Threat' of the current account deficit (CAD), fiscal deficit, and inflation.

The closure of the Ras Laffan facility in Qatar and the subsequent declaration of 'Force Majeure' by QatarEnergy has created a significant LNG crisis for India. Qatar is India's single-largest LNG supplier, providing between 10-11 million tonnes per annum, accounting for approximately 45 per cent of total LNG imports. Following this suspension, Asian spot LNG prices surged from \$10 per MMBtu to \$24-25 per MMBtu, forcing price-sensitive industrial consumers to seek alternative feedstocks such as furnace oil or naphtha. India's largest terminal operator, Petronet LNG, has also invoked force majeure for its affected tankers after insurers withdrew coverage, serving notices to downstream off-takers including public sector utilities.

Macroeconomic Transmission Channels

The transmission of high energy prices into the Indian economy is mechanical and measurable. It is estimated that every \$10 increase in the price of crude oil widens the CAD by approximately 30-40 basis points of GDP. With crude hovering near \$120, the CAD is projected to swell towards 1.9-2.2 per cent of GDP, a significant leap from the 0.7-0.8 per cent seen in previous years.

Oil Price Scenario	Brent Crude Range	Impact on India's CAD (% of GDP)	Inflation Impact (CPI/WPI)	Economic Significance
Baseline	\$75 - \$80	1.0% - 1.3%	CPI ~4.0%	Manageable within existing fiscal targets.
Stress Scenario 1	\$100 - \$115	1.9% - 2.2%	WPI +80-100 bps	Serious pressure on fiscal slippage and margins.
Severe Shock	\$130 - \$150	>3.0%	GDP growth near 6%	Risk of a sharp economic slowdown and external imbalance.

The fiscal burden is equally concerning. If Brent remains above \$100 per barrel throughout FY27, the central government could face an additional expenditure of ₹3.6 lakh crore, largely driven by fertiliser subsidies and the need to insulate consumers from retail fuel price spikes. Every additional month of conflict with crude near \$100 could add roughly ₹30,000 crore to the Centre's fiscal burden due to compensation for oil marketing companies (OMCs). However, the government's proactive inclusion of the fertiliser sector in 'Priority Sector-2' for natural gas supply ensures that food security remains uncompromised, even as industrial sectors like ceramics in Morbi face supply curtailments of 40-50 per cent.

Anatomy of a Drawdown: Historical Resilience vs. Contemporary Panic

To understand why the current dip is a buying opportunity, the historical 'recoil effect' of the Indian markets provides a necessary perspective. History is a relentless teacher of the fact that geopolitical events create temporary price shocks, not structural shifts in domestic productivity. Market reactions to military conflicts typically follow a predictable pattern, a sharp initial pullback followed by a period of stabilisation as economic fundamentals reassert their dominance.

Comparative History of Geopolitical Shocks

In 19 of the last 20 major global military conflicts, the market took an average of only 28 days to return to its pre-event levels. The 1990 Gulf War saw global markets decline as Iraq invaded Kuwait and seized oilfields; the S&P 500 fell 15.9 per cent between July and October 1990. However, once Operation Desert Storm was launched in January 1991 and the conflict's limited duration became clear, equities recovered their losses within months. Similarly, during the 2003 Iraq War, the market bottom occurred just days before the invasion began, followed by a strong rally over the next year.

Cover Story

Event	Nifty/ Market Drawdown	Duration to Bottom	Recovery to Previous Peak	Long-Term Market Impact
Gulf War (1990)	~16%	~3 Months	~6 Months	Recovery followed by early 90s reforms.
Dot-com Bust (2000-03)	53%	19 Months	46 Months	Prolonged waves of decline; eventual 77% rally in 2003.
Global Financial Crisis (2008)	65%	10 Months	71 Months	Brutal collapse followed by sharp rebound in 2009.
Demonetization (2016)	25%	11 Months	24 Months	Temporary pause in a longer upward trend.
COVID-19 Crash (2020)	38%	46 Trading Days	10 Months	Fastest crash in history followed by rapid intervention.
Russia-Ukraine (2022)	7.4% - 18%	~1 Month	13 Months	Energy shock absorbed as supply routes stabilized.
March 2026 Conflict	12.07% (Current)	Ongoing	--	Immediate panic selling on war headlines.

The March 2026 drawdown is currently well within the 'normal' range of geopolitical corrections. Unlike 2008, where the global financial system itself faced systemic failure, or 2020, where global demand vanished overnight, the current crisis is a supply-side disruption in a world characterised by robust domestic demand. Indian markets have developed a powerful 'Domestic Buffer' through the financialisation of household savings. Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) played a stabilising role during FY26, recording net purchases of around ₹5.99 lakh crore in the equity cash market, providing a massive counter-weight to Foreign Portfolio Investor (FPI) outflows.

Structural Bedrock: The India Growth Engine to 2030

While headlines focus on the risk of minefields in the Persian Gulf, the 'Engine Room' of the Indian economy is being rebuilt through three decisive structural shifts, the National Manufacturing Mission, the Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) stack, and the strategic 'China Plus One' supply chain pivot. These drivers are not temporary; they are designed to sustain GDP growth in the 6.5-7.8 per cent range through the end of the decade.

The National Manufacturing Mission and PLI 2.0

Manufacturing is no longer a peripheral part of the Indian growth story; it is its fulcrum. For India to achieve 'Viksit Bharat' status by 2047, the government aims to elevate manufacturing's share of GDP from the current 15-17 per cent to 25 per cent by 2035. The National Manufacturing Mission (NMM), announced in the Union Budget 2025-26, integrates policy and execution into a unified roadmap, focusing on clean-tech, solar PV modules and green hydrogen.

As of late 2025, manufacturing growth rose to 5.40 per cent YoY, with the Index of Industrial Production (IIP) showing

accelerating industrial momentum led by basic metals, pharmaceuticals and motor vehicles. The Production Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes have been the 'crown jewel' of this push, attracting over ₹2,00,000 crore in realised investments across 14 sectors and generating over 12.6 lakh jobs as of September 2025. The expansion of mobile phone manufacturing is a primary success case; capacity has grown 150-fold over a decade, with exports reaching nearly ₹2 lakh crore in 2024-25.

Manufacturing Target	Projected Value by 2030	Projected Value by 2035	Strategic Intervention
Sector Size (US\$)	\$350 Billion	\$1 Trillion	PLI 2.0 and NMM integration
Employment Impact	3.5 Crore New Jobs	100 Million Jobs	MSME formalization and skilling
FDI Inflow (Annual)	~\$25 Billion	~\$60 Billion	Advanced Manufacturing Clusters
Share of GDP (%)	~20%	25%	NITI Aayog Roadmap execution

The transition is moving from 'order book anticipation' to 'high-octane execution'. The national priority is to create structured access pathways through twenty 'Plug & Play Frontier Technology-enabled Industrial Parks' and the establishment of the Global Frontier Technology Institute (GFTI) to drive R&D in AI, material science and robotics.

Digital Public Infrastructure: The Productivity Multiplier

India's Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) is the silent catalyst for economic formalisation and mass-scale efficiency. The 'India Stack', comprising Aadhaar, UPI and the Jan Dhan financial inclusion layer, has fundamentally reshaped governance and service delivery. India has built this architecture at an incredibly low cost, moving from being a user of digital systems to a builder of population-scale infrastructure.

The economic returns are extraordinary. Aadhaar transformed identity verification, reducing costs from \$10-20 to just \$0.27 per transaction, creating significant savings for the government and enabling millions to access banking services directly. By March 2026, more than 144 crore Aadhaar numbers had been generated, with over 2,707 crore authentication transactions in the preceding year alone.

- **Unified Payments Interface (UPI):** In January 2026, UPI processed 21.70 billion transactions worth over ₹28.33 lakh crore. It now captures 73 per cent of India's retail digital payments market.
- **Jan Dhan Yojana:** Accounts have grown to 57.71 crore as of March 2026, with deposits increasing to ₹2.94 lakh crore.

- **Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC):** This expands market access for small businesses, with over 1.16 lakh retail sellers live across 630+ cities as of December 2025.

This digital backbone ensures that even during global energy shocks, the domestic consumption engine, which accounts for 61.5 per cent of GDP, remains resilient. The cumulative amount transferred through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) crossed ₹49.09 lakh crore by January 2026, ensuring that welfare reaches the intended recipients without leakage, thereby supporting rural demand.

Valuation Evaluation: Evolution vs. Froth

A common critique during market corrections is that Indian equities are 'overvalued' relative to historical averages. Critics often point to the Buffett Indicator (Market Cap-to-GDP ratio), which hit an all-time high of 142 per cent in late 2025. However, the veteran analyst must look beneath the headline numbers to distinguish between a 'bubble' and an 'evolving economy'.

The Evolution of the Buffett Indicator

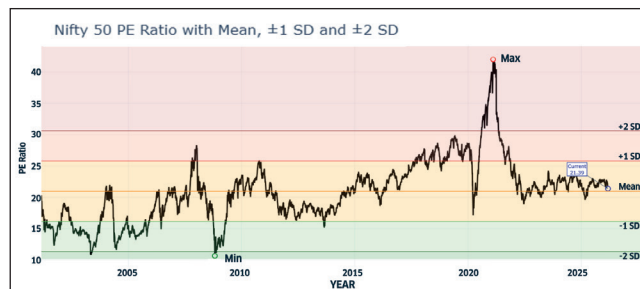
The Buffett Indicator is a macro-level tool used to judge whether a stock market is overheated relative to the size of its economy. Historically, a ratio well above 100 per cent is considered a red flag, while 70-80 per cent suggests undervaluation. In 2007, just before the global financial crisis, India's indicator peaked at 150 per cent.

However, the 'New India' story suggests that the Buffett Indicator may be a blunt instrument for an emerging market undergoing rapid listing and formalisation. The ratio is expanding because more of India's economy is being captured in the listed space. Furthermore, the transition of the NSE to consolidated earnings for PE calculations in April 2021 provides a more accurate picture of corporate profitability, accounting for overseas subsidiaries that were previously invisible in standalone numbers.

Valuation Chart

The picture that emerges from the valuation charts is not of a euphoric market running far ahead of fundamentals, but of an equity market that is still trading in a fairly reasonable zone by historical standards.

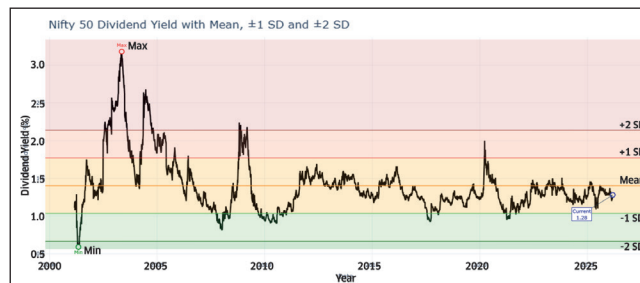
Start with the Nifty 50's price-to-earnings ratio. The latest reading of 21.39 is almost sitting on top of the long-term average of 20.98. In statistical terms, it is barely 0.09 standard deviations above its historical mean, which means it is nowhere close to an overstretched zone. More importantly, it remains comfortably below the +1 SD band near 25.8 and even farther from the +2 SD zone above 30.6, which is where markets typically begin to look meaningfully expensive. Put differently, the market is trading around its median valuation, not at frothy extremes.



The price-to-book ratio tells an even stronger story. The current Nifty PB of 3.32 is actually below its historical average of 3.59 and sits in only the 34th percentile of the long-term range. That is an important point. If the market were genuinely overheated, PB would usually be pressing higher bands, but instead it is below the mean and well within the normal range. Against a historical peak of 6.55, today's reading does not suggest excess. It suggests moderation.



Dividend yield, too, does not flash a warning of speculative excess. At 1.28 per cent, the current yield is a little below the long-term average of 1.40 per cent, which is natural in a market that has recovered from lower levels. Yet it remains broadly in line with the historical middle band and is not near the abnormally compressed levels one tends to see in blow-off rallies. The current figure is close to the historical median of 1.32 per cent, again reinforcing the idea that valuations are not stretched to an unhealthy degree.



Taken together, the three metrics send a consistent message. PE is near average, PB is below average, and dividend yield is near the middle of its historical range. That combination does not describe a market in bubble territory. It describes a market that may no longer be dirt-cheap, but is still far from being richly overvalued.

Cover Story

This is where the attractiveness of the equity market lies today. Investors are not being asked to pay panic-level premiums for earnings or book value. The broad market appears to be pricing in growth, but not irrationally so. In fact, relative to history, the current setup looks more like a market in a fair-to-reasonable valuation corridor rather than one demanding caution on the grounds of excess alone.

The real takeaway is this: the Indian equity market may not be screamingly cheap, but the data does not support the argument that it is dangerously expensive either. Valuations are sitting in a zone that still leaves room for selective participation, especially if earnings delivery holds up. For long-term investors, that is an encouraging backdrop. It suggests the market remains investible, attractive on a relative historical basis and, importantly, not in the kind of overvaluation territory that has historically preceded major valuation-led corrections.

Valuation Metric	March 2026 Value	Historical Range / Mean	Market Status
Nifty 50 PE Ratio	21.39	18 - 22 (Long-term)	Fair to Attractive
Nifty 50 PB Ratio	3.32	3.0 - 3.5 (Neutral)	Fair Value
Nifty Dividend Yield	1.28%	1.1% - 1.5%	Historically Average
India Buffett Indicator	106.40%	~80% (10-yr median)	Moderately Elevated
U.S. Buffett Indicator	216% - 227%	~160%	Critically Overvalued

Sectoral Strategic Priorities: Where to Deploy Capital

The impact of an oil shock is not uniform across India. While some segments face direct and immediate pressure, others have entered a multi-year execution phase, making them less sensitive to short-term geopolitical volatility.

Defence and Green Hydrogen: Cornerstones of Autonomy

The defence sector is shifting from anticipation to active execution in 2026. The strategic push for indigenisation has expanded the defence order pipeline to a record ₹3.3 lakh crore in FY26, nearly double the annual defence capital outlay. The Defence Acquisition Council approved ₹79,000 crore in the winter session alone, covering munitions, missiles and air defence systems. This operational momentum is expected to improve the financial performance of companies such as Bharat Dynamics and Astra Microwave.

The National Green Hydrogen Mission has also moved from planning to on-ground execution as of February 2026. Under the SIGHT scheme, the government finalised contracts for 3,000 MW per annum of electrolyser manufacturing capacity, supported by ₹4,440 crore in incentives. Companies such as Reliance, Adani and L&T are positioning India as a global export hub for clean fuels. Green hydrogen prices have already fallen below \$4 per kg and are moving towards a target of \$1.50 per kg by 2030.

Pharmaceuticals: The Defensive Hedge

Pharmaceuticals have emerged as a relative safe haven amid the volatility of 2026. The sector offers reasonable valuations and has outperformed the broader market. Beneficiaries of the ₹15,000 crore Production Linked Incentive scheme are investing in high-end drugs for cancer and diabetes. Stocks such as Aurobindo Pharma and Dr Reddy's are viewed as attractive on declines, with the sector faring better than interest rate-sensitive segments.

Vulnerable Sectors: Navigating Headwinds

Investors should be cautious in sectors exposed to the combined impact of high oil prices, currency depreciation and delayed interest rate cuts.

- **Airlines and Logistics:** Aviation Turbine Fuel is a major cost component. Elevated crude prices compress margins and push up ticket prices.
- **Paints and Chemicals:** These industries rely on crude derivatives as key inputs. Margins may shrink if higher costs cannot be passed on to consumers.
- **Private Banks and Real Estate:** These sectors remain under pressure as markets factor in delayed rate cuts by the Reserve Bank of India due to energy-driven inflation.
- **City Gas Distribution:** The piped natural gas, industrial and commercial segment is facing LNG supply curtailments of 40–50 per cent. Industry-wide daily volumes may decline by 8–10 per cent in the near term.

Portfolio Strategy for the Decade: Guidance for Retail Investors

Retail investors should assess the March 2026 correction through the lens of long-term value and investment horizon. Historical rolling return data show that the Nifty 50 Total Return Index has not delivered negative returns over any 7-year or 10-year holding period.

Strategic Asset Allocation

Successful investing during corrections depends more on discipline than intelligence. The current sentiment, ranging from sceptical to bearish, and foreign portfolio investor ownership at a 15-year low, have historically signalled favourable entry points.

1. **Lump-Sum Deployment:** Use the 8–10 per cent correction to allocate additional funds to quality businesses across large, mid and small-cap segments.
2. **Gold as Insurance:** Maintain around 10 per cent allocation to gold or Gold ETFs. In periods of conflict, gold helps offset equity volatility and preserve purchasing power.
3. **Continue SIPs:** Do not discontinue Systematic Investment Plans. Domestic institutional investors have provided structural support to the market, and the financialisation of savings has made buying during declines a widespread practice.
4. **Maintain Liquidity:** Keep 3–6 month fixed deposits yielding 7–8 per cent for liquidity and to capitalise on

tactical opportunities, particularly if the Nifty approaches the 22,000–23,200 range, seen as a strong psychological support zone.

The Gordon Growth Perspective

The Indian equity market remains attractive when evaluated using the Gordon Growth Model, which emphasises long-term growth and cost of capital in determining intrinsic value.

India's GDP growth, projected between 6 and 7.8 per cent, supports a higher sustainable growth rate, a key driver of equity valuations. In contrast, several developed markets, particularly the United States, face elevated valuations. The Shiller CAPE ratio in the U.S. remains close to 40, suggesting relatively lower prospective returns. Against this backdrop, India's equity risk premium appears more attractive.

Inflation in India remains anchored near 4 per cent, supporting monetary stability and containing the cost of capital. A lower cost of capital reduces the discount applied to future cash flows, thereby enhancing valuations. Combined with favourable demographics, policy support, rising private capital expenditure and expanding capital markets, these factors strengthen India's long-term investment case, especially after the underperformance of Indian equities over the past 12–18 months.

Structural reforms, increasing private capital inflows and

continued policy support further reinforce this outlook. As the Gordon Growth framework indicates, intrinsic value rises with higher growth and a manageable cost of capital, conditions that currently favour India relative to several major global markets.

The Case for Optimism Amid Uncertainty

The March 2026 conflict is testing investor conviction, but India's structural strengths remain intact. The National Manufacturing Mission, Digital Public Infrastructure and fiscal discipline, with the deficit contained at 4.4 per cent of GDP in FY26, provide resilience that few economies possess.

While disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz are affecting LNG and crude supplies, they do not alter India's long-term trajectory. The ambition to become the world's third-largest economy by 2027 is supported by resilient services exports, strong remittances and a current account deficit of just 0.7 per cent of GDP for calendar year 2025.

For investors, the message is clear. Volatility is inherent to markets. Deep corrections have historically been followed by strong recoveries. The Nifty's 10.5 per cent annualised return over the past decade underscores the value of patience. By accumulating quality businesses in pharmaceuticals, defence and BFSI, while maintaining a prudent gold allocation, investors can convert short-term uncertainty into long-term opportunity. This is not the time to exit; it is the time to review valuations and stay invested.

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Tax Column



Jayesh Dadia
Chartered Accountant

I am residing in India and own agricultural land where I have carried out agricultural activities. Now I have decided to give the agricultural land on rent. Whether the rent received would enjoy exemption from the Income Tax Act?

Yes, the rent received from leasing out the agricultural land is exempt from Income Tax under section 10 (1) of the Income Tax Act. However, you have to satisfy certain conditions. The land which you have given on rent must be used for genuine agricultural purposes such as growing crops, fruits or vegetables by the tenant. Thus, there is a direct nexus between the rent and the agricultural activities. But if the tenant uses the land for non-agricultural purposes such as a warehouse or residential house, then the rent received by you will be taxable in your hands.

Therefore, kindly ensure that the tenant uses the land wholly and exclusively for agricultural purposes. Kindly also ensure that even after the land is rented, it should be assessed for Land Revenue in India.

Kindly also note that the rental income will be treated as agricultural income and would be added to your Other Income to determine your tax slab. This often pushes your non-agricultural income into a higher tax bracket, effectively increasing the tax you pay on your other income.

I am a resident of India. My neighbours are an old age couple and I take care of them. Now, out of love and affection, they have decided to give me a new motor car as a gift. They are not my relatives. Whether receipt of motor car would be taxed in my hands, particularly when my neighbours are not my relatives?

Under section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act, if you receive any property, in excess of ₹50,000 without consideration, then such value is considered as taxable in your hands. However, on careful reading of section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act, which talks about property which is specific in nature, motor car is not considered as property. Therefore, in my opinion, receiving a car as a gift from your neighbours should not trigger tax under section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act. However, the Income Tax Officer may make proper inquiry to satisfy that there is a genuine gift.

Therefore, you have to prepare proper paperwork supported by confirmation from neighbours explaining their source from where payment for the car was made. Also, you should establish that no business or professional connection is there with the neighbours; otherwise, the Income Tax Officer can consider it as Business Income under section 28(iv) of the Income Tax Act. In view of the above documents, in my opinion, the fair market value of the motor car which you receive as a gift cannot be taxed. If the amount is taxed by the Income Tax Officer, you will get relief from the Appellate Authorities.

My father had a long medical treatment in the current financial year. He was hospitalised for a long time as well as had surgeries two times. The total cost incurred is approximately ₹60 lakh. We received financial help from neighbours, friends,

office staff, etc., aggregating to ₹40 lakh. All this money was paid to hospital, doctors and incurred on medicine. Kindly let me know the income tax implications of ₹40 lakh in my father's hands?

₹40 lakh is a significant amount of financial support. However, medical help received from non-relatives and non-charitable trusts is subject to tax under section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act. Under this section, any amount received in excess of ₹50,000 from non-relatives is taxable as Income from Other Sources. Although you have spent the entire money on medical treatment, no such deduction is available under section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act. Therefore, in my opinion, the entire ₹40 lakh would be subject to tax if your case is picked up for scrutiny.

However, you can sort out the payment of ₹40 lakh under different headings. If the amount is received from relatives defined in section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act, then the amount is not taxable. Further, any amount received from Foundation / Trust registered under section 12AA of the Income Tax Act, then such amount is not taxable. Some amount which you received may be payable in future. This amount you may show as loan, which is not taxable under section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act. But if you still find that none of the amount is falling under the above heads, then the only option is to offer to tax or consider the entire amount as loan payable, duly confirmed by the donor, so the same cannot be brought to tax in the current financial year.



We would be happy to address your tax-related queries. Kindly share them with us at editorial@dsij.in



ROLLING AHEAD

Wheels India
BSE Code: 590073
CMP: ₹921.05

Wheels India has built a strong presence in wheels for trucks, tractors, passenger vehicles and construction equipment, while also supplying air suspension systems for trucks and buses. Beyond auto, it has a footprint in industrial components used in construction and wind energy, giving it a wider base than a typical auto ancillary company. Its long-standing ties with leading domestic OEMs remain a key strength and have helped it grow faster than the industry in select areas. What makes the story more interesting now is the company's push beyond its traditional business. It is looking to grow exports of wheels for construction equipment and agricultural tractors, ramp up machining capacity for large windmill castings, expand fabricated and structural parts for windmills, including offshore projects, and scale up the hydraulic cylinder business. The aluminium wheel rim business is still small, but it adds another layer to the growth story.

IN A GOLDILOCKS ZONE

MCX
BSE Code: 534091
CMP: ₹2,554.95

MCX is India's largest Exchange in the commodity derivatives segment. MCX

continues to command over 99 per cent share across bullion, base metals and energy. What is adding a little extra buzz now is the chatter on the street. Technically, the stock is said to be setting up well for an upward move over the next few weeks, with some brokerage desks believed to be turning constructive on the counter. There is also growing talk that Q4FY26 and full-year FY26 earnings could come in strong, helped by healthy traction in commodity trading activity. Hence, watch out!

PIPELINE TO PROFITS

Astral
BSE Code: 532830
CMP: ₹1,620.10

Astral has moved well beyond being just a pipe company. Over the years, it has built a wider building materials portfolio, with plumbing still at the centre but adhesives, paints and bathware increasingly adding to the story. What the street seems to be picking up on is the improvement in plumbing demand in Q4. Channel restocking appears to have helped, and January volumes are believed to have come in especially strong. Management is sounding reasonably confident too, with plumbing volume growth for FY26 expected to be above 14 per cent. Then there is the margin angle. Astral continues to push its value-added product mix, which matters because that is where better realisations usually sit. The India adhesives business is still posting healthy double-digit growth, while the UK adhesives operation, after a messy phase, is showing signs of finding its feet again.



BUYING THE DIP

Torrent Pharmaceuticals
BSE Code: 500420
CMP: ₹4,263.05

Torrent Pharma, the flagship company of the Torrent Group, remains one of India's leading pharma names. What is catching the street's eye now is the steady buying interest emerging on every dip. Broker desk murmurs suggest the stock is seeing demand at lower levels, indicating that market participants may be quietly accumulating the counter. In a selective market, such price action often points to underlying confidence. For now, Torrent Pharma appears to be one of those quality names where weakness is being viewed less as a concern and more as an opportunity.



(Closing price as of March 16, 2026)

MUTUAL FUND UNLOCKED

DALAL STREET INVESTMENT JOURNAL

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Cover Story

Large-Caps in Uncertain Times

Special Report

Life Cycle Funds



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When Geopolitics Rattles Markets, Asset Allocation Must Do the Heavy Lifting

The latest U.S.-Iran-Israel conflict is a reminder that markets move on more than earnings and valuations, sometimes on shipping routes, oil tankers and fear. For India, the stakes are high: energy remains our biggest external vulnerability. Elevated crude prices, a weakening rupee and sharp equity sell-offs reflect exactly that anxiety.

This is why large-cap funds and life cycle funds deserve attention right now.

When crude spikes and uncertainty rises, the impact spreads fast, across inflation expectations, currency stability, corporate margins and investor sentiment. In such phases, the quality of equity exposure matters more than its quantity. Large-cap funds hold businesses with stronger balance sheets, better cash flows and greater resilience under macro stress. They may not top return charts in a roaring bull market; but when markets turn risk-averse, leadership, liquidity and business strength command a real premium.

The current environment equally strengthens the case for life cycle funds and goal-based allocation. These funds follow a pre-defined glide path, gradually reducing risk as the target date approaches, removing the burden of repeated emotional decisions from the investor. That matters enormously right now. The biggest damage in volatile markets is rarely caused by the market alone; it is caused by investor behaviour. People abandon SIPs near bottoms, chase safety after the fall, and return to equity only after recovery. A disciplined allocation framework breaks that cycle.

The takeaway is not that every geopolitical tremor demands a portfolio overhaul. It is that such episodes remind us to build portfolios that are prepared, not reactive. Large-cap funds provide a sturdier core. Life cycle funds bring long-term discipline. And asset allocation remains the quiet hero of wealth creation, less exciting than a hot theme, but far more dependable when the unexpected strikes.

Markets will move past this conflict, as they always have. Investors who emerge with confidence will not be those who predicted every event. They will be those who let allocation, not emotion, guide their decisions.

Shashikant Singh
Executive Editor

Understanding the Role of a Satellite Portfolio

I recently read your mutual fund story on Concentration vs Diversification and found it very insightful. Could you please share some examples of the types of investments that can be included in a satellite portfolio?

- **Radhika Patil**

Editor Responds : In a core-satellite investment approach, the core portfolio typically consists of stable, diversified funds designed to deliver consistent long-term returns. The satellite portfolio, on the other hand, is meant to complement the core by capturing specific opportunities or higher growth potential. For instance, satellite allocations may include sectoral or thematic funds such as banking, technology, or infrastructure, which can benefit from favourable sector cycles. Investors may also consider mid-cap or small-cap funds in the satellite portion to participate in higher growth segments of the market, though these tend to be more volatile. Some investors even use the satellite portion to take tactical calls, such as investing in international funds, thematic ideas, or emerging trends. However, since these investments can be more volatile, it is generally advisable to keep satellite exposure limited, typically around 20 to 30 per cent of the overall portfolio.

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Large-Caps in Uncertain Times



When markets grow volatile, protecting capital matters as much as earning returns. This story explains why large-cap mutual funds remain a dependable core holding, with relatively better downside protection, strong inflows, and a clear role across different risk profiles. It also highlights why factors like cost, overlap, taxation, and holding period deserve as much attention as performance

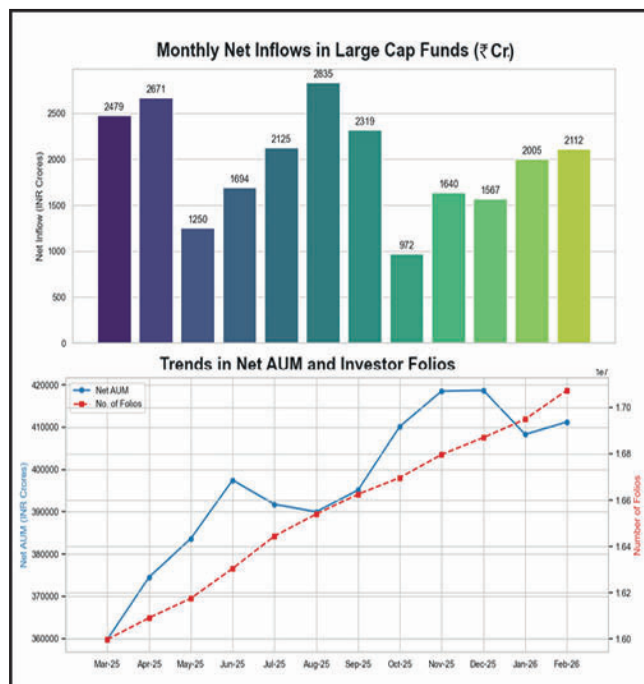
The rising tensions in the Middle East have made the situation even more challenging for the Indian equity market, which has already been one of the worst-performing major markets globally over the past year. With much of the world's energy supply coming from the Middle East, the current geopolitical situation is affecting global markets, and India, which imports over 80 per cent of its oil, is facing the brunt of the impact.

In this macroeconomic environment, fund allocations need to shift from speculative growth towards more stable investments. Market fluctuations are a natural part of the economic cycle, so the goal should be to focus on preserving capital while remaining invested. For disciplined investors, the key is to

navigate through market downturns and avoid the significant risks often associated with aggressive, high-risk funds focused on smaller or more volatile sectors. Large-cap equity funds, which are generally more stable, offer a safer route to wealth preservation, especially when broader market liquidity tightens. These funds provide a higher chance of safeguarding your capital during uncertain times.

The inflows into large-cap funds over the past year further reinforce their growing appeal among investors. As evident from the steady rise in both folio counts and assets under management (AUM), investors are increasingly seeking the stability and resilience that large-cap funds provide. The data show a consistent upward trend, with monthly net inflows remaining robust despite broader market volatility. For

instance, from March 2025 to February 2026, the AUM of large-cap funds surged from ₹3.59 lakh crore to ₹4.11 lakh crore, reflecting investor confidence in these funds as a safe haven in uncertain times. The strategic shift towards large-cap funds is further validated by the fact that more than 1.07 lakh new folios were added in just one year, underscoring the growing recognition of their long-term stability and potential for wealth preservation.



Historical performance data validate this defensive thesis. During periods of contraction or heightened uncertainty, the large-cap fund category consistently demonstrates superior risk-mitigation capabilities.

MF Performance Comparison by Category: Large-Cap Fund Returns

Year	Large-Cap	Mid-Cap	Small-Cap
2025	8.69%	2.35%	-5.53%
2019	10.68%	2.76%	-1.07%
2018	0.74%	-12.16%	-19.01%

Capital Preservation Psychology

The quantitative spread in 2025, where large caps outperformed small caps by over 14 per cent, highlights the category's role as a defensive bastion. However, the most critical insight lies in the maths of recovery. In 2018, a small-cap investor facing a -19.01 per cent drawdown required a nearly 23.5 per cent gain just to achieve a breakeven state. Conversely, the large-cap return of 0.74 per cent preserved the compounding runway. By containing the 'drawdown effect',

large-cap funds ensure that compounding resumes from a significantly higher capital base, preventing the 'reset' of long-term wealth cycles.

This resilience is a function of the category's structural mandates and the fundamental scale of the underlying constituents.

The Flip Side: Critical Context for the Wise Investor

While the data overwhelmingly support the stability of large caps, a prudent investor must also understand their limitations.

- **Valuation Risk:** The 'safest' stocks are often the most watched and can sometimes become expensive. If the broader market corrects, large caps will fall too. They are not immune to downturns; they simply tend to fall less than their smaller counterparts.
- **The Underperformance Cycle:** Large-cap funds can and do lag behind mid and small-cap funds during strong bull markets fuelled by abundant liquidity (e.g., 2021-2022). An investor expecting large-cap funds to top the return charts every year will be disappointed. Their true value lies in downside protection, not necessarily upside leadership.

Structural Integrity: Defining the Large-Cap Investment Universe

The risk-return profile of a fund is dictated by its regulatory boundary and the fundamental capitalisation of its assets. Fund category definitions are not merely labels; they are the mathematical constraints that determine a fund's volatility ceiling.

In the Indian context, 'Large-Cap' is not a subjective term defined by a fund manager's whim. Since the SEBI reclassification of 2018, the definition has been clinical: large-caps are the 1st to 100th companies by full market capitalisation. These lists are updated periodically by the industry to ensure the investible universe remains accurate.

A Large-Cap Mutual Fund is structurally mandated to invest at least 80 per cent of its total assets in these top 100 stocks. This leaves a 20 per cent tactical window for mid-caps, small-caps, or cash, a flexibility managers use to hunt for extra 'alpha' or to provide a liquidity buffer.

This universe possesses unique differentiators:

- **Macroeconomic Synchronicity:** These firms represent the core of the national economy; their performance is a proxy for GDP growth rather than niche sector sentiment.
- **Scalability and Resilience:** Large-cap entities possess the balance sheet strength to maintain operations during credit crunches or unfavourable market conditions that threaten the solvency of smaller firms.
- **Built-in Damage Control:** Professional management and diversified revenue streams serve as internal hedging mechanisms, minimising idiosyncratic risk during

volatile cycles.

- **Liquidity and scalability:** Large caps typically carry higher trading liquidity. This reduces implementation slippage as AUM grows and can reduce the risk that investor flows force a manager into undesirable trading.

From an investor's perspective, these factors significantly reduce 'drawdown fear', the 10-20 per cent portfolio dips that often trigger irrational investor exits. By lowering the standard deviation of returns, the large-cap category facilitates a 'stay-invested' approach, which is the primary driver of long-term terminal value.

Performance Review (2017-2025)

Professional wealth management prioritises Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR) and risk-adjusted metrics over a multi-year horizon (5-10 years). Short-term fluctuations are noise. Institutional-grade returns are built through consistent capture of market upside with limited downside participation.



The Compounding Multiplier

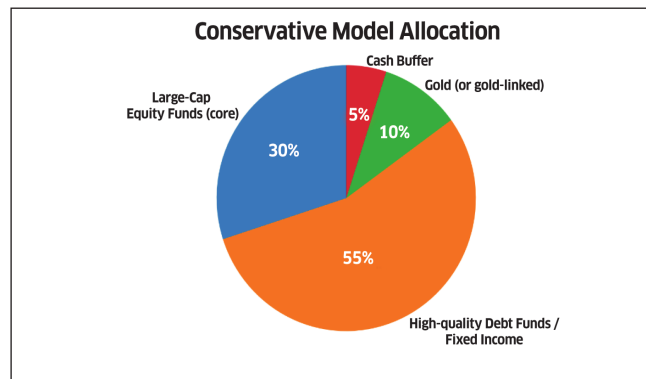
The category's 10-year cumulative return stands at 282.22 per cent. To put this in perspective, an initial capital outlay of ₹1,00,000 would have appreciated to approximately ₹3,83,000. This demonstrates that stability is not just a defensive trait but a compounding engine. By avoiding the devastating -20 per cent or -30 per cent years common in smaller caps, the large-cap category maintains the momentum required for significant wealth creation.

Investor Roadmap: Strategic Allocation and Implementation

Investors often use model portfolios (Conservative, Moderate, Aggressive) to balance risk and return. Each model has a different allocation across asset classes like equities (subdivided into large-cap core and other equity categories), debt/fixed income, gold, and sometimes cash. Below, we provide a detail for each such category of investors and ideal allocation towards large-cap funds.

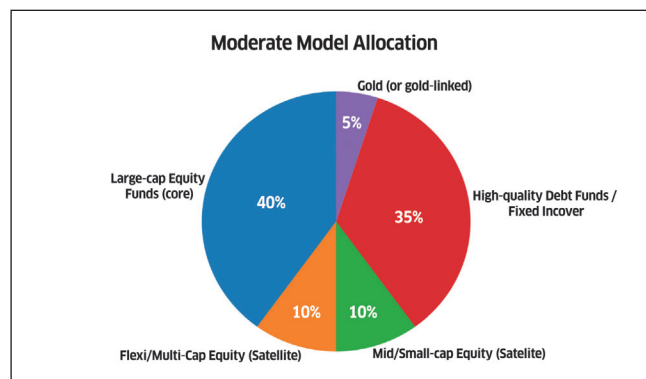
A Conservative portfolio emphasises capital preservation and income over growth. In this model, only 30 per cent is

allocated to equities, most of which should be focused on large-cap funds for stability, while a substantial 55 per cent is in high-quality debt/fixed income for steady returns. A significant 10 per cent allocation to gold provides diversification benefits (gold often holds value or rises when shares falter). The remaining 5 per cent is kept in a cash buffer to meet short-term needs or opportunities. This low-equity, high-debt mix results in lower volatility, aligning with a conservative risk tolerance.



Moderate Model Allocation

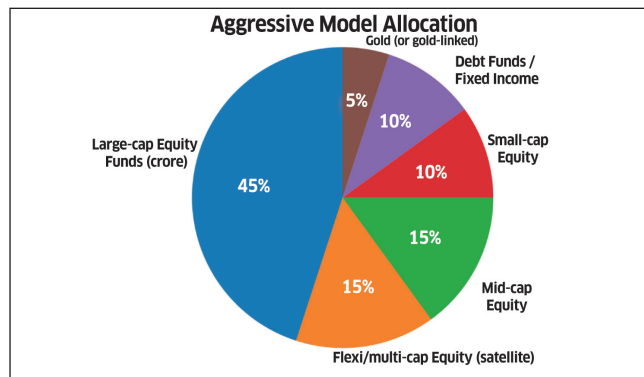
A Moderate portfolio strikes a balance between growth and stability. About 60 per cent of the assets are in equities for growth, split into: 40 per cent large-cap core equity for stability, and two 10 per cent satellite equity allocations (one flexi/multi-cap and one mid/small-cap) to add growth potential. Approximately 35 per cent is allocated to high-quality debt funds to reduce overall volatility. A 5 per cent allocation to gold is included as a hedge and diversifier. This mix seeks a middle ground in risk, being more growth-oriented than conservative portfolios but with a substantial debt cushion compared to aggressive portfolios.



Aggressive Model Allocation

An Aggressive portfolio prioritises growth and is willing to accept higher volatility. Here, about 85 per cent of the portfolio is invested in equities, distributed across multiple equity categories for diversification: 45 per cent in large-cap core, 15 per cent in flexi/multi-cap, 15 per cent in mid-cap, and 10 per cent in small-cap equities. Spreading the equity allocation

among large, mid, and small caps as well as a flexi-cap fund can provide diversification within stocks (mixing stable blue-chips with higher-growth small/mid companies). Only 10 per cent is in debt/fixed income, just enough to slightly cushion downturns, and 5 per cent in gold serves as a hedge against market crashes. There is no cash reserve in this model, as it aims to be fully invested for maximum growth. This high-equity allocation suits investors with high risk tolerance and a long investment horizon.



Implementation Checklist: From Reading to Acting

Before diving into the fund data, here is a practical checklist to ensure you apply this information correctly:

1. **Direct vs. Regular Plans:** The expense ratios in the table below are for Direct Plans (purchased directly from the AMC). If you buy through a broker or advisor (Regular

Plan), the expense ratio will be approximately 0.5 to 1 per cent higher, which will significantly impact your long-term returns. Always opt for Direct Plans if you are a self-directed investor.

2. **Avoid 'Fund Collection':** Owning five different large-cap funds does not give you more diversification; it only gives you a headache and more fees. Because of the 80 per cent mandate, most large-cap portfolios look very similar. Owning 1–2 high-quality strategies is sufficient.
3. **Check for Overlap:** If you already own a Nifty 50 or Nifty 100 Index Fund, check the holdings below. You may already own most of these stocks, making an active large-cap fund redundant in your portfolio.
4. **Mind the Friction:** Always check the Exit Loads. Some funds use tiered loads to discourage short-term trading.

To evaluate individual funds within this category, you should employ several technical risk-adjusted metrics:

- **Sharpe Ratio:** Measures excess return per unit of risk. Higher the better, it shows the fund generates efficient returns relative to its volatility.
- **Information Ratio:** Measures the consistency and magnitude of active outperformance relative to a benchmark (e.g., Nifty 100).
- **Alpha:** Quantifies the excess return generated by the fund manager over the benchmark index.
- **Standard Deviation:** Measures the total volatility or dispersion of returns; lower values indicate higher predictability.
- **Beta:** Measures sensitivity to market movements. A Beta of less than 1 implies the fund is less volatile than the benchmark.

Top 10 Funds based on AUM (₹ Cr.)											
Funds	Fund Manager	AUM (in ₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)	Inception Date	NAV (₹)	Return (%) 10 Years	Large-Cap (%)	Mid-Cap (%)	Small-Cap (%)	Sharpe	Sortino
ICICI Pru. Large Cap Fund(G)	Sankaran Naren	77,451.60	1.40	May 23, 2008	106.67	15.13	84.02	8.00	0.14	0.31	0.64
SBI Large Cap Fund-Reg. (G)	Saurabh Pant	55,246.20	1.48	Feb. 14, 2006	89.87	13.06	81.69	10.68	2.92	0.23	0.47
Nippon India Large Cap Fund (G)	Sailesh Raj Bhan	51,403.80	1.47	Aug. 8, 2007	87.48	15.37	81.07	15.44	2.80	0.32	0.65
Mirae Asset Large Cap Fund-Reg. (G)	Gaurav Misra	40,184.40	1.51	Apr. 4, 2008	107.34	13.86	84.67	9.16	5.37	0.19	0.37
HDFC Large Cap Fund (G)	Rahul Bajjal	40,085.20	1.58	Oct. 11, 1996	1,095.59	14.30	85.52	13.01	-	0.26	0.52
Axis Large Cap Fund-Reg. (G)	Shreyash Devalkar	32,436.80	1.58	Jan. 5, 2010	57.56	12.75	89.41	1.73	-	0.18	0.33
Aditya Birla SL Large Cap Fund-Reg. (G)	Harish krishnan	30,094.30	1.63	Aug. 30, 2002	498.45	12.98	82.87	6.44	7.54	0.24	0.48
Canara Rob Large Cap Fund-Reg. (G)	Shridatta Bhandwaladar	17,103.60	1.65	Aug. 20, 2010	59.60	14.45	88.63	8.53	0.01	0.24	0.49
UTI Large Cap Fund-Reg. (G)	Karthikraj Lakshmanan	12,658.20	1.75	Aug. 3, 2005	256.77	12.35	86.65	9.51	1.84	0.18	0.35
Kotak Large Cap Fund (G)	Rohit Tandon	10,864.20	1.73	Feb. 4, 2003	552.59	13.53	84.66	8.64	3.64	0.24	0.48

How to Read This Table

- **For Beginners:** Prioritise Expense Ratio (lower is better and check the Direct Plan instead of Regular Plan) and Inception Date (older funds like HDFC Large Cap have seen more market cycles). Do not chase last year's returns.
- **For Intermediates:** Look at the Sharpe Ratio. A higher number (like Nippon India's 0.32) indicates better risk-adjusted returns.

Taxation: The Silent Killer of Returns (Updated for FY 2026-27)

Understanding the tax implications is just as important as picking the right fund. As confirmed in the Union Budget 2026, the following rules apply for the financial year 2026-27. For Equity-Oriented Mutual Funds (which large-cap funds are), the tax treatment is as follows:

- **Long-Term Capital Gains (LTCG):** If you hold your units for more than 12 months, any profit is considered long-term. Gains up to ₹1.25 lakh in a financial year are tax-exempt. Gains above this limit are taxed at a flat rate of 12.5 per cent.
- **Short-Term Capital Gains (STCG):** If you redeem your units within 12 months, the gains are added to your income and taxed at a flat rate of 20 per cent.
- **Surcharge and Cess:** These tax rates are increased by a 4 per cent Health and Education Cess. A surcharge may also apply if your total income is very high.

Important Note on the Tax Rebate: The rebate under Section 87A (which can make income up to ₹12 lakh tax-free under the new regime) is not available on capital gains that are taxed at these special rates (12.5 per cent / 20 per cent). This means your LTCG on mutual funds is taxable even if your other income is below the rebate limit.

This tax structure heavily reinforces the 'Buy-and-Hold' strategy discussed earlier. By staying invested for the long term, you not only benefit from compounding but also from a lower, more predictable tax rate on your profits.

Strategic Implementation for 2026

We believe the modern retail playbook is built on four pillars of discipline:

- **Minimum 5-Year Horizon:** Large-cap equities require full market cycles to normalise returns. Anything less is market timing.
- **Buy-and-Hold Discipline:** Active trading incurs taxes and timing errors. Maintaining market exposure through cycles is the only proven method for capturing the 282.227 per cent decade-long growth.
- **The 'Anchor' Philosophy:** Use large-caps as the core of your portfolio. They should typically constitute 50–70 per cent of your equity exposure, depending on your age and risk appetite. They are the 'long-horizon capital' that provides durable participation in India's economic growth.

Mind the Overlap Reality

Across multiple large-cap fact sheets here, holdings repeatedly include large private-sector banks, diversified conglomerates, and IT services names. A non-exhaustive cross-fund set of high-frequency holdings (weights vary by fund) includes:

- HDFC Bank
- ICICI Bank
- Reliance Industries
- Larsen & Toubro
- Infosys
- State Bank of India
- Bharti Airtel
- Kotak Mahindra Bank
- Axis Bank

This overlap reality has two investor implications. Do not buy 3–4 large-cap funds expecting 3–4 independent bets; you may just be buying overlapping mega-cap exposure multiple times, with multiple cost layers. If you do own two funds, ensure you are deliberately diversifying by process (quality-growth vs value/contrarian vs low-volatility bias), not merely by AMC brand.

SIP Discipline and Rebalancing

Large-caps can lag mid-caps in momentum-heavy phases. The key is not to 'chase' the top-performing category of last year, but to use Systematic Investment Plans (SIPs) to spread entry points and benefit from rupee-cost averaging.

Stress Testing Your Decision — Before investing, ask yourself: 'What if the market is flat for 5 years?' While India's demographic dividend makes a 'Lost Decade' (like Japan's) less likely, it is a possibility globally. Large-cap funds, by virtue of holding profitable, dividend-paying companies, offer a better cushion in such sideways markets compared to small-caps. However, they are not immune to prolonged stagnation. Your investment horizon must account for this risk.

Final Word — Large-cap mutual funds may not be the most 'exciting' part of the investment world. They do not offer the 50 per cent overnight gains sometimes seen in thematic or sectoral funds. However, for the serious investor, excitement is the enemy of stability. Chasing quick riches often leads to sleepless nights, sharp drawdowns, and eroded capital when markets turn negative or sectoral returns diminish. In contrast, large-cap funds deliver steady compounding through proven business models and disciplined risk management. In 2026, the giants of the Nifty 100 remain the most liquid, transparent, and resilient companies in the nation. These blue-chip leaders dominate critical sectors with strong balance sheets, consistent earnings growth, and superior corporate governance. By choosing low-cost, high-conviction funds (preferably Direct plans to eliminate distributor fees) and maintaining a 5+ year horizon, you sidestep emotional decisions and let time work its magic. This approach anchors your financial future in the bedrock of the Indian economy, ensuring sustainable wealth creation with far less volatility than speculative bets.



Divesh Kumar Bajaj
NDI Enterprises Private Limited



Thematic Investing - Aligning Portfolios with Long-term Trends

The modern economy and portfolios are composed of evolving industries and shifts that challenge investors to think beyond traditional sectors and their composition. Thematic investing has gained prominence as a strategy for investors who wish to tap into structural changes that may be missed by other approaches. This strategy focuses on identifying themes and trends and investing in securities aligned with them.

Understanding the concept - Themes are a set of ideas or opportunities that cut across various sectors, industries and business models. Consider digital transformation, medical and healthcare breakthroughs, a move towards renewable sources of energy, development of infrastructural patterns in cities, and demographic changes in society and markets. These ideas or themes are sometimes supported or preceded by macro trends or mega-shifts in policy or technology, or by people's behaviour and global value chains. In the Indian context, themes have been shaped by reform, evolving infrastructural patterns, growing access to financial markets, and domestic consumption demands.

One of the prime attractions of thematic investing is that it is focused on the future. Sector investments may go with the cycle and the latest economic news, but thematic investments have the ability to develop over the long run. This helps in aligning with the growth story that may not necessarily be captured through the conventional market index. It is possible for a theme to attract investments from the manufacturing sector, services

sector, tech sector, and financial sector, all of which may ride the same wave.

Challenges to consider - Thematic investing also faces some challenges. To identify the right theme at the right time, you will need a web of macro information, valuation cycles, and the interplay among various sectors. The fact is, most individuals do not have the means to spend their whole lives tracking the cross-currents of changes related to interest rates, inflation, currency movements, or fiscal policies on various sectors. Therefore, a given theme could become less attractive as circumstances change.

Behavioural biases introduce an added complication. During the good phases, investors are drawn to trendy themes, which are buoyed by optimism and success. During tougher times, fear becomes the driving force behind selling out early or missing the show when the theme itself remains strong in the long run. The marketplace indicates that the passion for a particular sector gets washed away when the market peaks and troughs, thereby showing the importance of maintaining standards and balance.

Here, investing is not about identifying potential themes, but rather about the sell as much as the buy. Sometimes we pursue promising themes, but the decision to rebalance or sell out of a theme can be as important as the initial entry point.

Mutual funds as an option - Thematic mutual funds or Fund of Funds can help to improve the efficiency of thematic exposure. For the average retail investor, they provide a diversified way to get exposure to themes without necessarily investing directly into the stocks. Professionals use structured research to identify emerging themes, determine valuations, track macro trends, and rebalance when necessary. They also help ensure timely entry and exit decisions, which are critical in thematic investing. Another benefit of using mutual funds is the ability to begin with a smaller amount, making thematic exposure more scalable.

An investor needs to treat investing in thematic mutual funds or Fund of Funds more as a complement to their existing equity holdings. While broad equity funds give stability and market-linked growth, thematic investing allows a focus on specific growth opportunities. Given that themes are dynamic, allocation to such funds should be aligned with overall portfolio objectives.

Equally important is the fact that not all themes that resonate may actually work. Structural trends may take time to materialise or may hit roadblocks because of unforeseen events. Which is why it is important that a diversified portfolio is built based on a number of themes that are reviewed periodically.

Thus, thematic investing provides an exciting means of exposure to the India growth story. While mutual funds offer an accessible and professionally managed route to thematic exposure, success depends on disciplined execution and ensuring thematic exposure remains a satellite allocation within a diversified core portfolio.



UTI Nifty Next 50 Index Fund

Equity: Large Cap Index

Scheme Category

6,246

AUM (₹ Cr.) Feb 28, 2026

23.02

NAV (₹) Mar 13, 2026

0%

Exit Load

11.37% p.a.

5-Year Median Rolling Returns (Since Inception)

0.35%

Expense Ratio (%)
Feb. 28, 2026

NIFTY Next 50 TRI

Benchmark

Sharwan Kumar Goyal & Ayush Jain

Fund Managers

Reason for recommendation

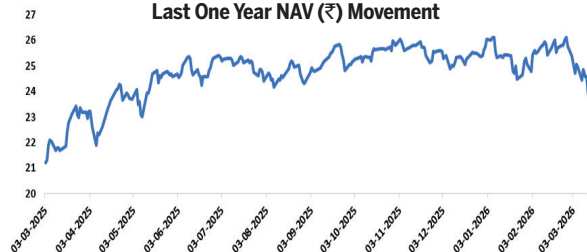
In a volatile market, large-cap funds often become a sensible starting point because they provide exposure to relatively well-established businesses with stronger balance sheets, deeper liquidity, and better resilience during uncertain phases. Within the large-cap space, index funds can be even more appealing as they keep costs low, and, when managed efficiently, offer lower tracking error and closer mirroring of the benchmark. Against this backdrop, UTI Nifty Next 50 Index Fund stands out for its return profile. Over the last 6 months, the fund declined 6.33 per cent versus the category average decline of 7.29 per cent, showing better downside control. Its outperformance becomes even more visible over longer periods, 19.79 per cent versus 12.14 per cent over 3 years, and 12.79 per cent versus 10.86 per cent over 7 years. This shows that the fund has not only held up relatively well in weaker periods but has also created stronger wealth over medium- to long-term horizons than its category average. From a sector allocation perspective, the fund appears reasonably diversified. The largest exposure is to Financials at 17.55 per cent, which reflects the importance of banks and financial institutions in India's growth story. This is followed by Energy at 15.92 per cent, giving the portfolio exposure to companies linked to fuel, power, and broader economic activity. Capital Goods at 12.61 per cent adds an infrastructure and manufacturing angle. Looking at

Top Holdings

COMPANY NAME	% TO NET ASSETS
Vedanta Ltd.	5.24
TVS Motor Company Ltd.	3.91
Divi's Laboratories Ltd.	3.50
Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd.	3.21
Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd.	3.19
Cholamandalam Invest. and Fin. Co. Ltd.	3.15
Britannia Industries Ltd.	3.04
Indian Oil Corporation Ltd.	3.01
Tata Power Company Ltd.	2.73
Varun Beverages Ltd.	2.66

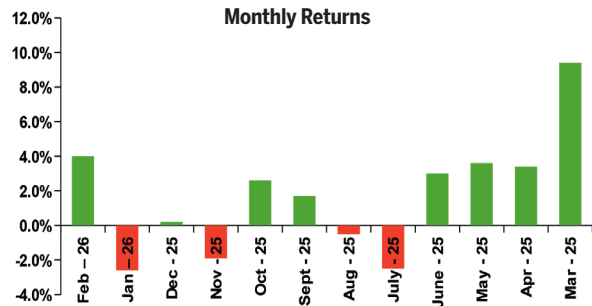
the top individual holdings, the portfolio has meaningful exposure to companies that are leaders or strong participants in their respective sectors. Vedanta Ltd. at 5.24 per cent is the largest holding, giving the fund exposure to metals and natural resources. TVS Motor Company Ltd. at 3.91 per cent adds a consumer and mobility growth angle. Divi's Laboratories Ltd. at 3.50 per cent brings in pharmaceutical strength. These holdings indicate that the fund is not just broadly diversified but also positioned in businesses that can benefit from domestic growth, industrialisation, consumption, and strategic sectors. Overall, UTI Nifty Next 50 Index Fund looks attractive for investors looking to build long-term wealth in a volatile environment.

Last One Year NAV (₹) Movement



The NAV graph is for the period of trailing one year.

Monthly Returns





Avoid irrational decisions while investing in MFs

Hemant Rustagi

Chief Executive Officer, Wiseinvest Pvt Ltd.

Market-linked investment options like mutual funds are helping long-term investors stay ahead of inflation and achieve their varied investment goals. While it is heartening to see an increasing number of investors building their core portfolio with the help of mutual funds, there is still a large section of the investing public that either remains sceptical about the role mutual funds can play in their wealth-building process or does not benefit from their true potential due to wrong investment strategies, haphazard decision-making, and allowing some of the myths to cloud their investment decisions.

Investors must know that mutual funds allow them to practise asset allocation by investing in different asset classes like equity, debt, gold, silver, REITs, and InvITs through a variety of funds. The fact that there are a variety of funds available for investing in these asset classes, wherein fund managers follow different investment philosophies and strategies, means there are opportunities for investors to build a well-balanced portfolio, as per their risk-taking ability.

However, the key for investors to get the best from mutual funds is to have a better understanding of what they offer, as well as not allow myths to influence their investment decisions. Here are some of these myths and how investors can tackle them:

Equity funds are meant only for risk-takers

While equity funds tend to be volatile over the short and medium term, they have proved their ability to outperform other asset classes for investors willing to stay committed to a pre-defined time horizon and follow a disciplined investment approach. Considering that earning positive real returns, that is, gross returns minus inflation and taxes, holds the key to building wealth over the longer term, it is essential for every investor to invest in equity funds, albeit with a clear understanding that they need to keep an eye on exposure level and stay committed to their defined time horizon.

Investing in top-performing funds guarantees higher returns

The problem here is that if you chase short-term performance, you may end up investing a significant part of your investments into some of the aggressive categories of funds. Remember, equity as an asset class is aggressive by nature. Hence, investing in these aggressive categories such as sector, thematic, smart beta, as well as micro-cap funds, can make your portfolio even more risky. Therefore, the mainstay of your portfolio should be well-diversified categories of equity funds like flexi-cap, large & midcap, and multi-cap, with some exposure to mid and small cap funds. More importantly, look to invest in funds that have a consistent performance track record vis-à-vis their peer group and the respective benchmarks.

Investing in a large number of funds can minimise risk

While diversification helps in mitigating the risk and volatility, investors need to realise that mutual funds themselves are a diversified investment option. Therefore, having too many funds may prove to be counter-productive, as it can create an overlap which may result in these funds behaving exactly in the same manner in different market situations. Needless to say, it defeats the purpose of diversification in the portfolio. A careful selection of a few funds can provide adequate diversification in the portfolio.

Investing through SIP protects against negative returns

SIP has emerged to be a powerful strategy to invest in market-linked funds, as it not only minimises the impact of volatility but also creates a large corpus through regular contributions over time. Besides, it brings the average cost down and helps in keeping emotions out of the investment process. However, it would be wrong to assume that if you invest through SIP, there will not be any negative or erratic returns in the portfolio. The fact is that SIP minimises losses in the short term and improves returns in the long term. Therefore, every investor who signs up for SIP must be prepared to tackle certain periods of uncertainty over the short or medium term and avoid making any abrupt decisions.



Life Cycle Funds: Investing That Evolves with You



Building wealth is not just about where you invest, but also about how your portfolio evolves over time. Maintaining the right balance in asset allocation remains a challenge for many investors. But what if your investment portfolio could automatically adjust itself as you move closer to your financial goals? Let's explore how investors can make the most of this new category of mutual funds

For years, investors have been told that successful investing is not just about choosing the right fund, but about choosing the right strategy at the right stage of life. Yet, in reality, very few investors actually follow this principle. When markets are rising, investors hesitate to reduce equity exposure. When markets fall sharply, they become reluctant to add risk even when valuations become attractive. The result is a portfolio that often remains misaligned with the investor's true financial goals.

This behavioural gap has been one of the biggest challenges in personal finance. The importance of asset allocation is well recognised, but remaining committed to that strategy through decades of market ups and downs is where many investors falter. The launch of Life Cycle funds attempts to address this long-standing problem. These funds introduce a structured framework where the portfolio automatically evolves as the investor moves closer to a financial goal.

Instead of expecting investors to continuously monitor markets and rebalance portfolios, the fund itself adjusts the asset allocation over time. For the mutual fund industry, the arrival of Life Cycle funds represents an important shift. It signals a move away from static, one-size-fits-all products toward investment solutions that adapt to the investor's life journey. Let us take a closer look at Life Cycle funds to understand how investors can make the most of this investment approach.

Bridging the Gap in Goal-Based Investing
India's mutual fund industry has made significant progress in

encouraging long-term investing. Over the past two decades, systematic investment plans (SIPs) have become a popular tool for building wealth gradually. Investors are increasingly aware that achieving major financial milestones such as retirement, children's education or home ownership requires disciplined long-term planning. To support this mindset, mutual funds earlier introduced retirement funds and children's funds under the 'solution-oriented' category.

These schemes were designed to help investors focus on specific financial goals. However, many of these funds did not fully incorporate a dynamic asset allocation strategy that changed meaningfully with time. In practice, investors often remained exposed to similar asset mixes regardless of how far they were from their financial goals. A young investor in their thirties and another investor approaching retirement could end up holding portfolios with comparable risk levels. This is where Life Cycle funds come into the picture.

The Entry of Life Cycle Funds

SEBI has introduced a new category of mutual funds called 'Life Cycle Funds', which are open-ended schemes with a predetermined maturity (tenure) and a structured glide path strategy designed to facilitate goal-based investing. The idea behind the category is straightforward. An investor's portfolio should evolve as the timeline of the goal shortens. Growth should dominate in the early years, while stability should gradually take priority as the goal approaches. According to SEBI's framework, the tenure of Life Cycle funds can range from 5 years to 30 years.

These schemes can be launched in multiples of five years, and at any given point in time, an asset management company (AMC) is permitted to keep a maximum of six Life Cycle funds open for subscription. Further, as a Life Cycle fund approaches its maturity and the remaining tenure falls below one year, the scheme may be merged with the nearest maturity Life Cycle fund, subject to obtaining positive consent from the unitholders. This provision is intended to ensure smoother fund management while maintaining continuity for investors.

The Mechanics of the Glide Path

At its core, a Life Cycle fund is designed around a clearly defined investment horizon. Each scheme carries a specific maturity year that reflects the intended financial timeline. Investors select a fund based on the year in which they expect to require the money. The defining element of the strategy is the 'glide path', a structured roadmap that determines how the portfolio's asset allocation changes over time. In the early phase of the investment journey, the fund typically maintains a higher allocation to equities in order to capture long-term growth opportunities.

Equities have historically delivered superior returns over long horizons, but they also come with higher short-term volatility. Younger investors can afford this volatility because they have time to ride out market fluctuations. As the target maturity year approaches, the portfolio gradually reduces its exposure to equities and increases allocation to debt instruments and other relatively stable assets. The objective of this shift is to protect the accumulated corpus from large market swings just when the investor is about to use the funds.

In addition to equities and debt securities, Life Cycle funds may also allocate a portion of the portfolio to alternative assets such as gold, silver or infrastructure investment vehicles. This multi-asset framework helps diversify risk and enhance portfolio stability. The glide path ensures that the transition from growth to stability happens gradually rather than abruptly. Investors do not need to manually switch funds or constantly monitor the portfolio. The adjustment happens automatically as part of the scheme's investment mandate.

Illustrative Glide Path of a 30-Year Life Cycle Fund

Years to Target Maturity	Equity Allocation (%)	Debt Allocation (%)	Alternative Assets (%)
15-30 Years	65-95	5-25	0-10
10-15 Years	65-80	5-25	0-10
5-10 Years	50-65	5-25	0-10
3-5 Years	35-50	25-50	0-10
1-3 Years	20-35	25-65*	0-10
Less than 1 Year	5-20	25-65*	0-10

*Note: For the final three years, debt exposure is restricted to AA and above-rated instruments, with a residual maturity not exceeding the target maturity of the scheme to ensure capital preservation.

Rohan, Age 30 - Planning for Retirement

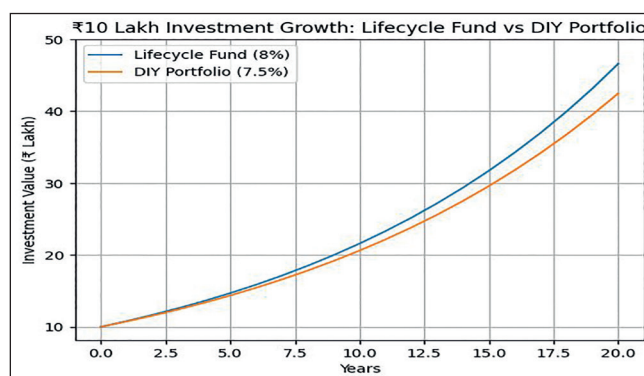
To understand this in a simple way, let us consider an example. Rohan has recently started investing through monthly SIPs with the goal of building a retirement corpus by the time he turns sixty. Instead of creating a portfolio of multiple funds and

adjusting allocations every few years, he chooses a Life Cycle fund with a maturity year around 2055. During the first fifteen to twenty years of his investment journey, the fund remains heavily invested in equities, allowing his investments to benefit from long-term market growth. As Rohan enters his late forties and early fifties, the fund gradually increases exposure to debt instruments and reduces equity risk. By the time he approaches retirement, the portfolio has become significantly more conservative. Without needing to actively rebalance his investments, Rohan has followed a disciplined strategy that evolves with his life stage.

Automatic Rebalancing, Tax Efficiency & Long-term Discipline

In a traditional do-it-yourself portfolio, investors often begin with a higher exposure to equities and gradually shift towards debt instruments as their financial goal approaches. However, this process usually involves redeeming units from one mutual fund and investing the proceeds into another. Each such transaction may attract capital gains tax depending on the holding period and prevailing tax rules, which can reduce the effective return over time.

Life Cycle funds address this challenge through an inbuilt rebalancing mechanism. The scheme itself follows a predetermined glide path that gradually alters the mix between equity, debt, and other permitted assets as the target date approaches. The fund manager carries out these adjustments within the portfolio, without requiring investors to redeem units or make fresh allocation decisions. Since these shifts occur internally at the scheme level, investors avoid the need for multiple buy and sell transactions across different funds.



- Both investments start at ₹10 lakh in Year 1.
- The Life Cycle Fund line grows faster because the portfolio is rebalanced internally, avoiding frequent tax events.
- The DIY portfolio line grows slightly slower because periodic switching between equity and debt funds leads to tax outflows, reducing the effective return to 7.5 per cent.
- Over 20 years, this seemingly small 0.5 per cent return difference results in a meaningful wealth gap:
 - Life Cycle Fund (8 per cent): ₹46.6 lakh
 - DIY Portfolio (7.5 per cent): ₹42.5 lakh

Key visual takeaway: The two curves start together but gradually diverge, clearly illustrating how tax efficiency and compounding can significantly influence long-term wealth creation. This difference becomes more significant as the investment amount increases.

One of the most practical strengths of Life Cycle funds lies in their automatic portfolio rebalancing, which enhances overall tax efficiency for long-term investors. By managing asset allocation internally, these funds minimise the need for frequent investor-driven switches that could trigger tax liabilities. This built-in mechanism not only helps preserve returns but also encourages long-term investment discipline, allowing investors to stay focused on their financial goals without the need for constant portfolio adjustments.

To reach any long-term financial destination, investors must also understand the cost of exiting the journey too early. Recognising the long-term nature of Life Cycle funds, SEBI has introduced a structured exit load framework to discourage impulsive redemptions during periods of market volatility. Under this rule, investors who redeem their units within the first year of investment will attract an exit load of 3 per cent.

If the redemption occurs during the second year, the exit load reduces to 2 per cent, and further declines to 1 per cent if the units are redeemed within the third year. This graded structure is designed to encourage investors to remain committed to their investment plan rather than reacting to short-term market movements. By imposing a higher cost on early withdrawals, the framework nudges investors to stay invested for the intended time horizon, allowing the fund's glide path strategy and long-term asset allocation to work effectively in building wealth over time.

Understanding the Limitations

While Life Cycle funds offer several advantages, they are not without certain limitations. One of the most notable constraints is the standardised glide path that determines how the fund's asset allocation shifts between equity and debt over time. In reality, every investor's financial circumstances, risk tolerance and investment objectives are different. Some investors may prefer to maintain a higher allocation to equities even as they approach retirement, especially if they have additional sources of income.

Others, on the contrary, may wish to adopt a more conservative stance much earlier in their investment journey to reduce market volatility. Since the glide path in Life Cycle funds follows a predetermined schedule, it may not fully reflect these individual preferences or changing financial situations. The asset allocation adjustments are rule-based rather than customised to each investor's specific needs. Therefore, investors must carefully select a Life Cycle scheme whose structure broadly aligns with their financial goals, time horizon and comfort with risk.

Who Should Consider Life Cycle Funds

Life Cycle funds can be particularly appealing to investors who

prefer a structured and simplified approach to long-term investing. For young professionals at the beginning of their investment journey, these funds offer a convenient starting point, as they eliminate the need to constantly review and adjust asset allocation. The fund automatically shifts the portfolio mix over time, allowing investors to stay invested without worrying about timing market cycles.

Investors who value convenience over active portfolio management may also find Life Cycle funds well suited to their needs. Instead of monitoring multiple equity and debt schemes and periodically rebalancing their portfolios, they can rely on a single investment solution that gradually evolves in line with the investor's life stage and risk profile. These funds are particularly relevant for long-term financial goals such as retirement planning, children's higher education, or other milestone-based objectives.

The maturity-oriented structure provides a clear investment path, aligning the portfolio's risk profile with the investor's time horizon. However, Life Cycle funds may not appeal to everyone. Experienced investors who prefer greater control over their portfolios and enjoy actively managing asset allocation may choose to build their own strategies using a combination of equity and debt funds, tailoring allocations according to market opportunities and personal preferences.

Concluding Thoughts

In many ways, Life Cycle funds attempt to solve one of the most persistent challenges in investing: not the lack of opportunities, but the difficulty of staying disciplined over long periods. Markets will inevitably go through cycles of optimism and uncertainty. During these phases, even well-informed investors may struggle to maintain the right balance between growth and stability. By embedding this transition directly into the investment structure, Life Cycle funds offer a framework that quietly manages this shift in the background.

For investors juggling careers, family responsibilities and long-term financial goals, this simplicity can be a meaningful advantage. Instead of constantly reviewing allocations or worrying about the "right time" to rebalance, they can remain focused on the broader objective of building wealth steadily over time. The fund's glide path acts as a built-in guide, gradually aligning the portfolio with the investor's changing life stage. That said, the effectiveness of Life Cycle funds ultimately depends on choosing the right maturity horizon and staying committed to the plan.

Like any investment strategy, the real benefit emerges through patience and consistency rather than short-term expectations. As the mutual fund industry continues to evolve, products that combine discipline, automation and goal-based investing are likely to play a larger role in portfolio construction. For many investors, Life Cycle funds could represent a practical step toward making long-term financial planning simpler, more structured and easier to sustain.



Mutual Funds Revolution: From a Single Scheme to a ₹80 Lakh Crore Industry

In the early 1990s, investing in equities in India was largely a specialist activity. Direct stock picking, fixed deposits and gold dominated household savings. Mutual funds existed, but they were hardly a mainstream financial product. Three decades later, the picture is dramatically different. Today, the mutual fund industry manages over ₹80 lakh crore and receives more than ₹30,000 crore every month through systematic investment plans (SIPs) alone.

The journey from a single government-run fund house to a nationwide savings movement reflects not just financial innovation but also a structural shift in how Indians invest. The industry's evolution mirrors India's economic liberalisation, regulatory strengthening, financialization of savings and technological adoption. Let us take a closer look at the evolution of the mutual fund industry in India, its various phases of development, the rise of SIP investing and the key milestones that have shaped its growth.

Phase I: The UTI Era (1963-1987)

The Indian mutual fund story began in 1963 with the establishment of the Unit Trust of India (UTI) under an Act of Parliament, promoted by the Reserve Bank of India. For nearly 25 years, UTI remained the only mutual fund in the country. The flagship product, Unit Scheme 1964 (US-64), became one of the most widely held investment instruments in middle-class households. At a time when capital markets were shallow and disclosure standards were minimal; investors trusted the government-backed structure more than listed equities.

Key features of this era:

- Monopoly structure
- Assured returns mindset
- Limited market-linked investing
- Strong retail acceptance despite low financial literacy

Mutual funds were not yet a portfolio allocation tool. They were perceived as a safe savings scheme similar to a bank deposit.

Phase II: Entry of Public Sector Funds (1987-1993)

The second phase began in 1987 when public sector banks and insurance companies were allowed to launch mutual funds. SBI Mutual Fund became the first non-UTI fund house, followed by Canbank Mutual Fund, LIC Mutual Fund and others. For the first time, investors had choice. However, the structure was still state-dominated. Products were conservative and

marketing was limited. The industry remained small, but an important behavioural shift occurred: investors began associating mutual funds with the capital market rather than just guaranteed income. This phase laid the groundwork for the biggest turning point in the industry.

Phase III: Liberalisation and SEBI Regulation (1993-2003)

The real transformation started after economic liberalisation. In 1993, private sector mutual funds were permitted and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) introduced comprehensive mutual fund regulations. This single step fundamentally changed the industry. Private players like Kothari Pioneer (later acquired by Franklin Templeton), HDFC Mutual Fund, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund and Birla Mutual Fund entered the market. Transparency improved and Net Asset Value disclosure became standard.

Important regulatory milestones:

- 1993: SEBI Mutual Fund Regulations
- Daily NAV disclosure
- Independent trustees and custodians
- Segregation of AMC and sponsor

Investors now began seeing mutual funds as market-linked investment vehicles rather than quasi-government schemes. However, the industry also went through its first crisis. The US-64 collapse in 2001 shook investor confidence and forced a major restructuring of UTI. Ironically, this crisis strengthened regulation and accelerated the shift toward professionally managed asset management companies.

Phase IV: Rise of Equity Culture and SIP (2003-2013)

The next decade saw rapid growth in equity markets and, with it, mutual funds gained traction. The introduction and popularisation of Systematic Investment Plans (SIP) was the turning point. Instead of timing the market, investors could invest a fixed amount every month. This aligned perfectly with salaried income patterns.

SIP changed investing behaviour in three ways:

- It removed the fear of market volatility
- It created long-term investing discipline
- It democratized equity participation

As markets rallied between 2003 and 2008, equity funds

delivered strong returns and retail participation increased significantly. Even after the 2008 global financial crisis, SIP investors continued investing, reinforcing the compounding advantage. SIP gradually became the backbone of the industry.

Phase V: Direct Plans, Digitalisation and Financialization (2013-2020)

Another major structural reform came in 2013 when SEBI introduced direct plans. Investors could now invest without distributor commissions, lowering costs and improving transparency. Around the same time, several developments converged:

- Online investment platforms
- Aadhaar-based KYC
- Mobile apps and fintech distribution
- Investor awareness campaigns such as “Mutual Funds Sahi Hai”

These changes expanded the industry beyond metropolitan cities. Smaller towns began contributing significantly to assets. The shift from physical forms to digital onboarding reduced entry barriers and accelerated investor participation. The growth was visible in AUM expansion. The industry crossed ₹10 lakh crore for the first time in May 2014 and doubled to ₹20 lakh crore by August 2017.

Phase VI: Retail Participation Explosion (2020-Present)

The post-pandemic period marked the most dramatic phase in the industry's history. Improving macroeconomic conditions, RBI interest rate cuts as inflation moderated, higher disposable incomes, easy mobile access and growing financial awareness together sparked a surge in new investors. Between December 2015 and December 2025, the industry's assets expanded from ₹12.75 lakh crore to ₹80 lakh crore, marking more than a sixfold rise in ten years.

The industry also crossed 10 crore investor folios in 2021 and reached 26 crore folios by December 2025. This was no longer a niche financial product. It had become a mass participation investment avenue.

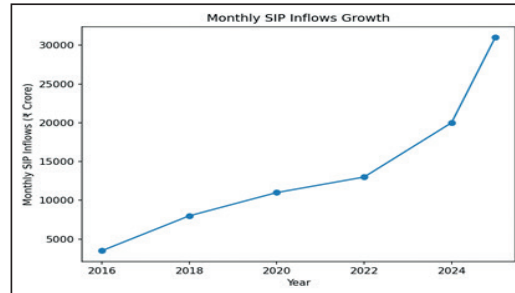
The SIP Revolution

The most influential development in the mutual fund industry has arguably been the rise of the Systematic Investment Plan (SIP). It changed investing from a one-time decision into a disciplined monthly habit, aligning perfectly with the cash-flow patterns of salaried households. Instead of waiting for the “right time” to enter the market, investors could commit small amounts regularly and participate across market cycles. Monthly SIP contributions have now crossed ₹31,000 crore, reflecting steady retail participation and growing confidence in market-linked products.

By January 2026, SIP assets stood at about ₹16.36 lakh crore,

contributing more than one-fifth of the industry's total assets. The scale itself highlights how central SIPs have become to the industry's growth. The popularity of SIPs lies in their simplicity and behavioural advantage. Regular investing reduces the psychological pressure of market timing and encourages long-term discipline. Through rupee cost averaging, investors

buy more units during market declines and fewer during rallies, lowering the average



cost of acquisition over time.

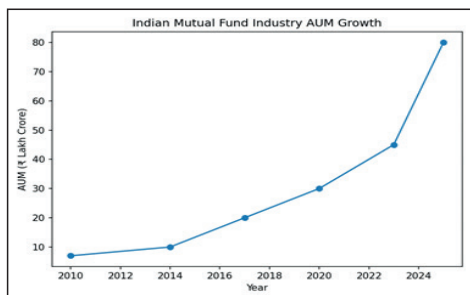
This approach converts volatility from a perceived threat into a potential benefit, particularly for long-term wealth creation. SIPs also provide accessibility. With small starting amounts, even first-time investors and young earners can participate in equity markets without committing large capital upfront. Over time, the power of compounding makes these small contributions meaningful. Importantly, the steady inflow from SIPs has stabilised the broader market. Consistent domestic flows now partly offset volatile foreign institutional investor movements, making the Indian equity market structurally more resilient than in earlier decades.

The Changing Investor Profile

The profile of the Indian mutual fund investor has undergone a visible transformation over the past decade. Earlier, participation was largely concentrated among urban, middle-aged savers in major cities who entered markets occasionally, often during bull phases. Today the investor base is far more diverse and geographically spread. A growing number of young earners are beginning their investment journey early in their careers, viewing mutual funds as a primary savings avenue rather than an alternative to fixed deposits.

Participation has also expanded steadily, supported by digital onboarding, online platforms and simplified KYC processes. This shift is also visible in flows from the top 30 cities (T30) and beyond the top 30 cities (B30). While metros (T30) continue to anchor assets, the growth momentum is increasingly coming from B30 locations. Rising SIP penetration in smaller towns highlights broader geographic participation and reflects the deepening reach of mutual funds beyond traditional urban investor bases.

Another notable shift is the rising presence of women investors, reflecting improving financial awareness and independent financial planning. Investor objectives have also evolved. The focus is gradually moving away from short-term gains toward long-term wealth creation and goal-based planning such as



retirement, children's education and home ownership. Perhaps the most significant change is behavioural. Investing

earlier tended to be event driven and return chasing. Now it is increasingly periodic and disciplined. SIPs have turned investing into a monthly financial commitment, much like paying a utility bill. This habit-forming approach may prove to be the industry's most lasting contribution to household finance.

Not Without Challenges

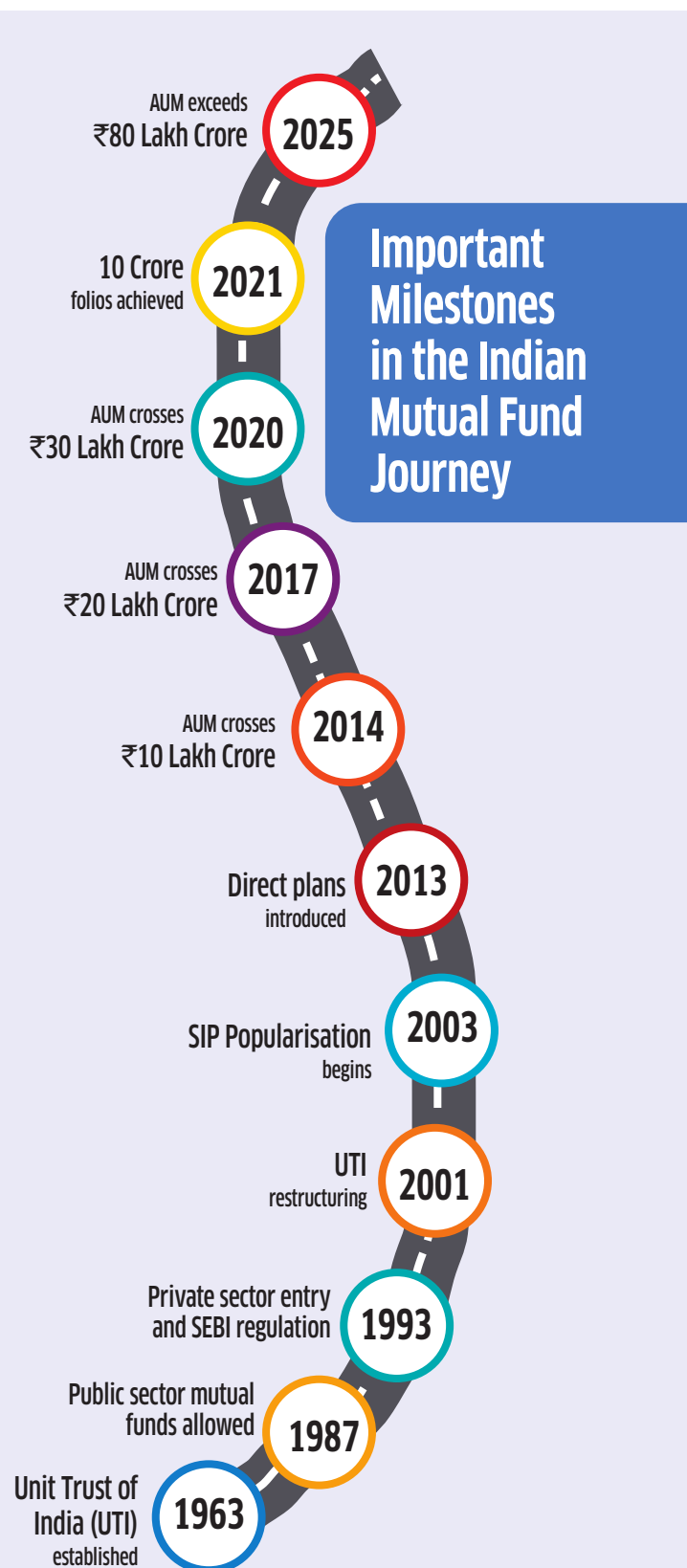
Despite strong growth, the mutual fund industry continues to face several structural challenges. Penetration remains modest relative to India's large population, indicating that a significant portion of household savings still flows into traditional avenues such as deposits, gold and real estate. The industry is also heavily dependent on equity market performance, which means prolonged market weakness can slow inflows and test investor confidence.

Geographical concentration is another concern, with a large share of assets still originating from major cities even though participation from smaller towns is improving. In addition, many investors continue to expect assured returns, reflecting the legacy of fixed income savings products. Market volatility often exposes this mismatch in expectations, and corrections tend to trigger redemptions among first-time investors. Strengthening financial literacy and encouraging long-term discipline will remain essential for sustainable growth.

The Road Ahead

The mutual fund industry now appears to be entering its next phase of development. Future growth is likely to be supported by the rising acceptance of passive investing, which offers low-cost market exposure, and by greater demand for retirement and pension-oriented products as investors begin planning for long-term financial security. Goal-based investing is also gaining importance, with investors aligning portfolios to specific life objectives rather than chasing short-term returns.

Opportunities in international funds are gradually attracting attention as investors look to diversify beyond domestic markets. At the same time, digital advisory platforms and technology-driven distribution are simplifying portfolio selection and improving access for smaller investors. As India's economy grows and savings shift toward financial assets, mutual funds are becoming a mainstream household investment, fostering disciplined investing and emerging as a key wealth-building avenue for the middle-class.



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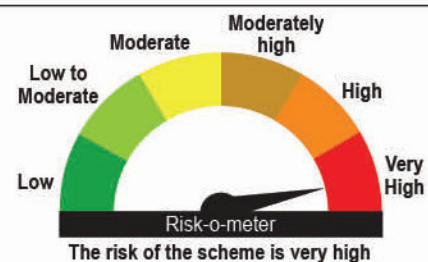


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